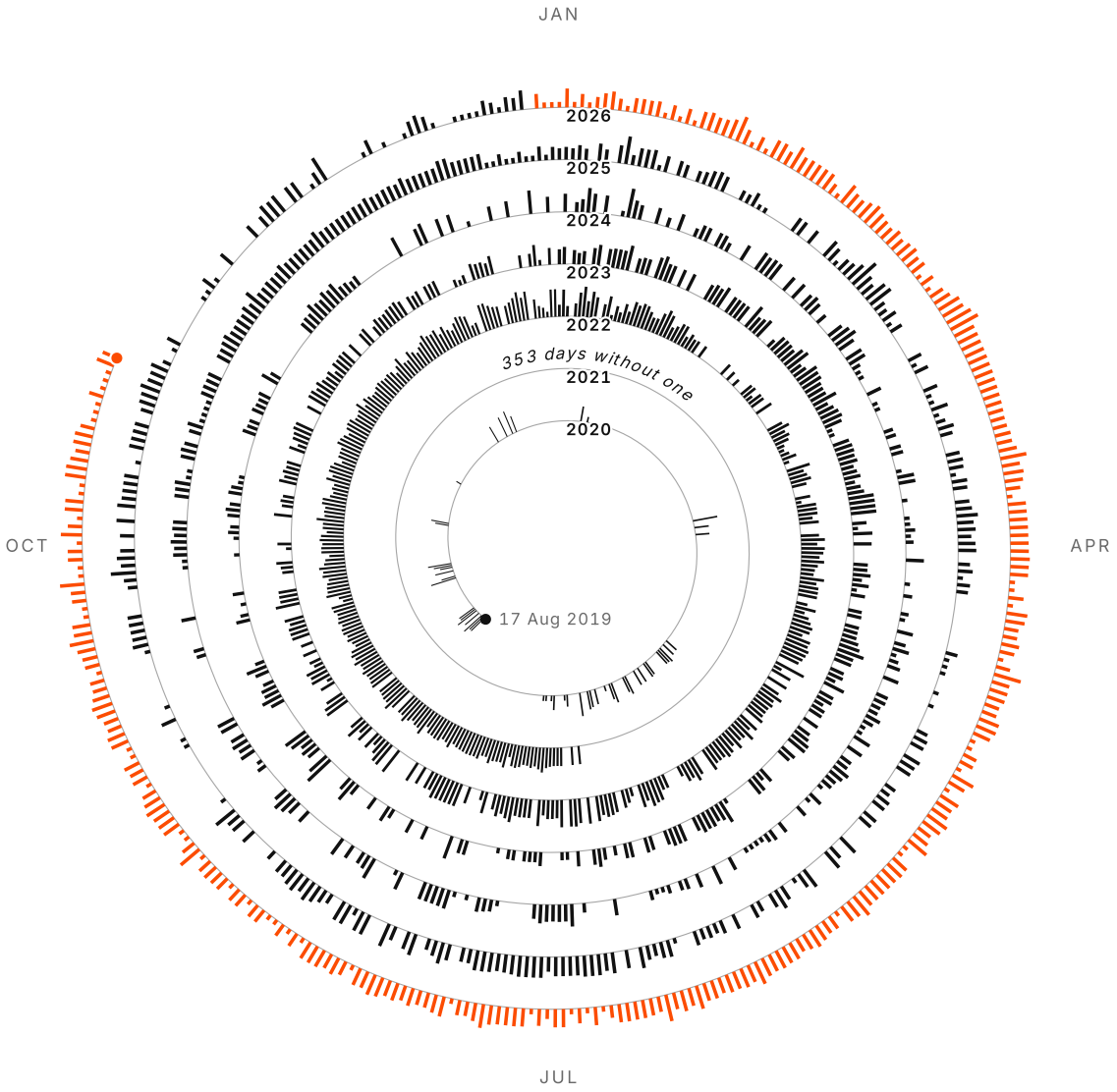
Gerald Tesha

A DATA-DRIVEN MEMOIR



Every day since my first upload, one turn per year. A mark is a day out, longer for more km on foot. Orange: the 301 days in a row still going.

Showing Up.

17 AUG 2019 TO 25 OCT 2026

2,061
OUTINGS

13,237
KM ON FOOT

84,367
METRES CLIMBED

301
DAYS IN A ROW

MY STRAVA JOURNEY

Showing Up

Seven years on foot, from my own log

Gerald Tesha

This edition covers every activity I logged on Strava from 17 August 2019 to 25 October 2026: 2,061 of them.

Every number in this book comes from that log, and every chart is drawn from it. Distance and climb only count my four sports on foot: runs, walks, trail runs and hikes. I took out activity names and exact locations before publishing.

The book is my website, My Strava Journey, put together as one volume. I print a new edition each time the data is refreshed.

Annex A explains how I made it, and my contact details are on the page before the back cover.

Contents

Prologue

I The habit

01 The Journey

II Year by year

02 Year in Sport

III The work

03 Sports
04 Records
05 Where

IV The long view

06 Timeline
07 Goals

V The lessons

08 What It Means

Epilogue

ANNEX A How this book was made

ANNEX B About the data

Get in touch

Prologue

This habit nearly ended before it started. In my first months I logged 62 outings, most of them runs on a treadmill. Then I stopped for 353 days, from July 2020 to June 2021.

When I started again, I did not stop. Since June 2021 I have been out on 1,435 of 1,947 days, and my longest break has been ten days. As I finish this edition, I am on 301 days in a row.

This book is me going back through that record, all 2,061 activities of it.

There are five parts: the habit as a whole, each year on its own, my sports, records and places, the timeline and my goals, and last, what I think it all means. To everyone who gave me kudos along the way, asanteni sana, thank you very much.



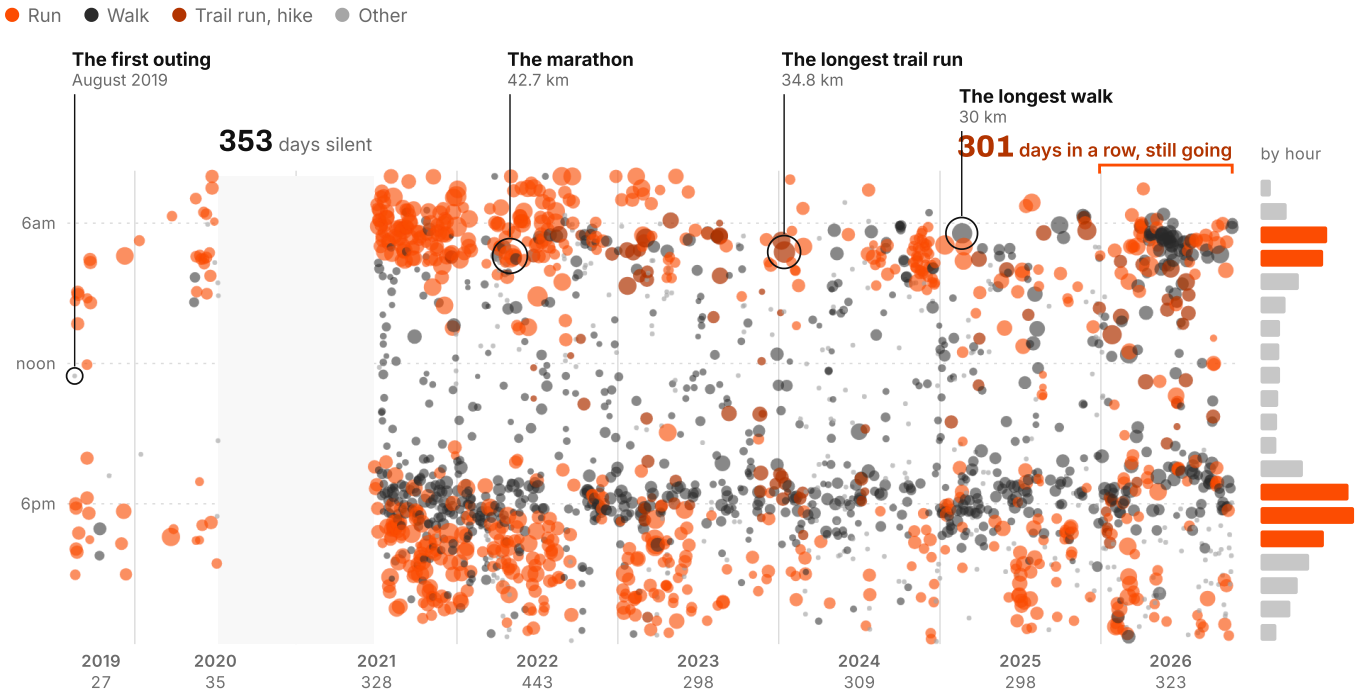
The habit

The whole record at once: how often I go out, when, where, and what I do.

CHAPTER 1

01 The Journey

Seven years of one habit



2,061
ACTIVITIES

13,237 km
ON FOOT

84,367 m
CLIMBED

301 days
CURRENT STREAK

Going often has done more for me than going far. In 2019, my first year, I went out 27 times. Now I do that in a month. Most days are a walk or an easy run of about an hour, and those ordinary days are where nearly all of this comes from.

OPEN A YEAR

2019 →

A small beginning

Mostly the treadmill. 85% of my outings were runs, many of them on weekends.

2020 →

The pause

Most outings were early, before 10 in the morning. Then I stopped logging for almost a year.

2021 →

Coming back

I started again. On 57% of my days out, I went out more than once.

2022 →

The busiest

Many short outings, about 56 minutes each.

2023 →

The hills

More hills. I climbed 12 m for every km and ran 303 km on trails.

2024 →

Travelling

I went out in five countries. Half my outings were done in under 35 minutes.

2025 →

Walking

Walks were 47% of my outings, and I did my longest walk, 30 km.

2026 →

Every day

Usually one outing a day, a longer one, about 98 minutes.

HOW THE STREAK HOLDS

One day leads to the next.

The hardest day to go out is the day after a break. One missed day once grew into almost a year without going out. Now, after a week in a row, I almost never skip the next day. On a tired day, a short walk is enough to keep the chain.

CHANCE THE NEXT DAY IS ACTIVE

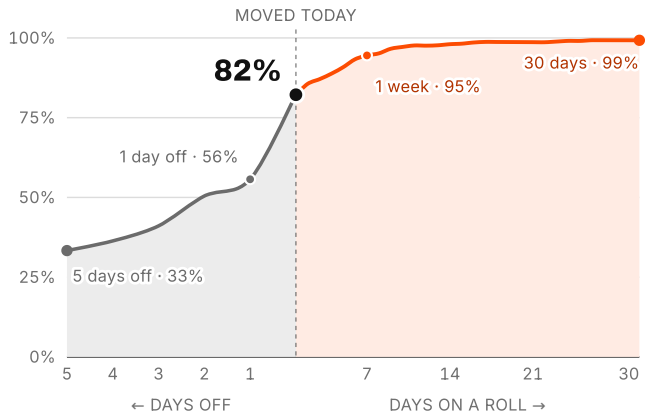
33%
after five days off

56%
after one day off

82%
after a day out

95%
after a week on a roll

THE ODDS, DAY BY DAY



GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

	TOMORROW YOU MOVE	TOMORROW YOU REST
If you moved today	82%	18%
If you rested today	50%	50%

BIG DAYS AND SMALL DAYS

The long days carry a lot.

A big day feels good, but the ordinary days make the total. My marathon, the longest day I have, is less than half of one percent of all my distance. Most of it came from plain days of 10 km or more, and the short days in between kept the habit going.

SHARE OF ALL DISTANCE ON FOOT

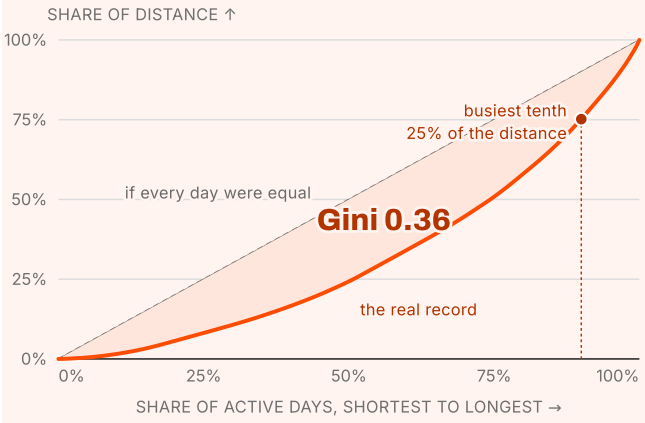
24% the quietest half of days

42% the busiest fifth of days

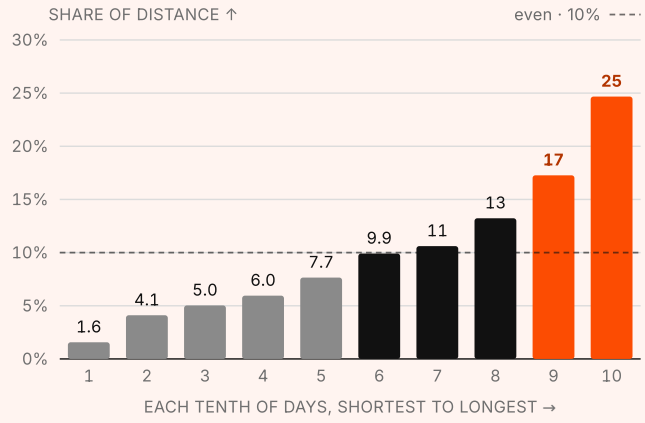
25% the busiest tenth of days

4% the 13 biggest days

EVERY DAY, ADDED UP



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



Same time, fewer outings.

My time each day has stayed the same. I just use it differently now. A day out has always been about 79 to 106 minutes. In the early years I split it, a run in the morning and a walk in the evening. Now it is usually one longer outing.

HOW THE DAYS WERE SPLIT

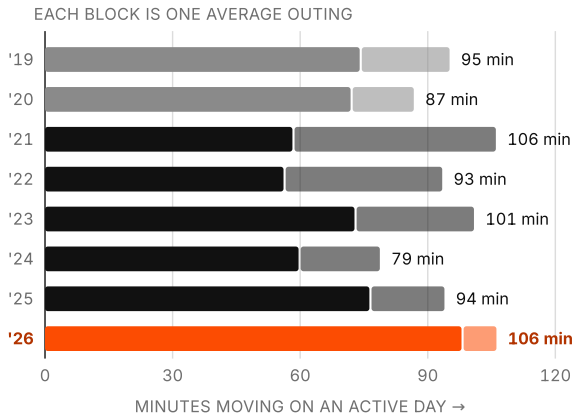
57%
of active days doubled up in 2021

8%
of active days doubled up in 2026

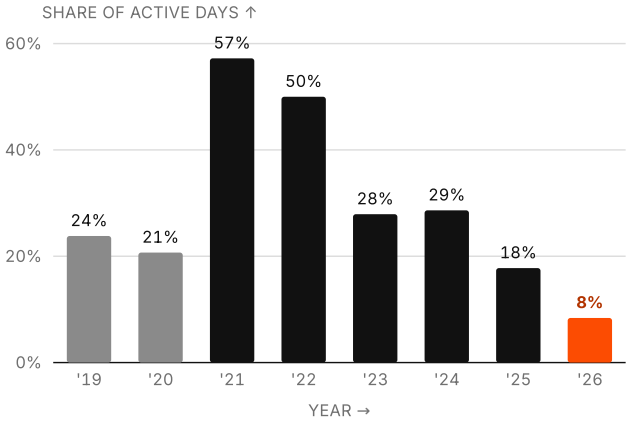
58 min
the average outing in 2021

98 min
the average outing in 2026

A TYPICAL ACTIVE DAY, YEAR BY YEAR



DAYS WITH TWO OR MORE OUTINGS



The climbing is in two regions.

If I want to climb, I have to travel. Where I live, the ground is flat. One hike in Morogoro climbed almost 2,000 m, and in Dodoma, where I go out most, it would take me about sixty outings to climb that much.

WHERE THE OUTINGS HAPPEN

94%
of located outings are in Tanzania

6%
outside Tanzania

29%
of Tanzania's outings are in Kilimanjaro and Morogoro

63%
of Tanzania's climbing is there

HOME AGAINST AWAY

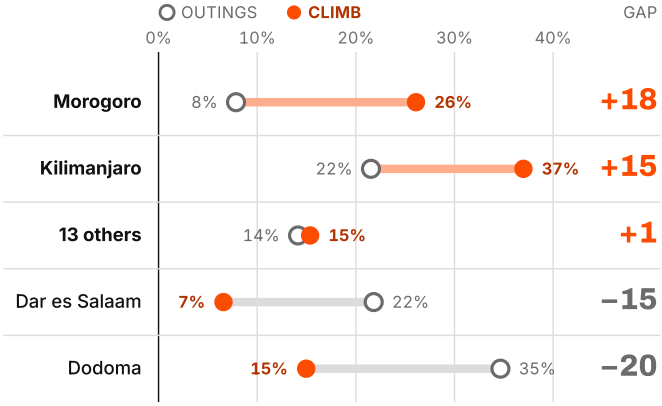


Tanzania · 1,082 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 73 OUTINGS

Kenya	32	2020
Malawi	23	2024
South Africa	13	2024
Rwanda	2	2024
Others	3	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



Walks took over.

I did not plan to become a walker. It happened slowly. In 2021 my usual walk was under 3 km, and this year it is about 9 km. Since 2022 I have walked more often than I have run, every year.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

41% walks

38% runs

5% trail runs and hikes

16% other activities

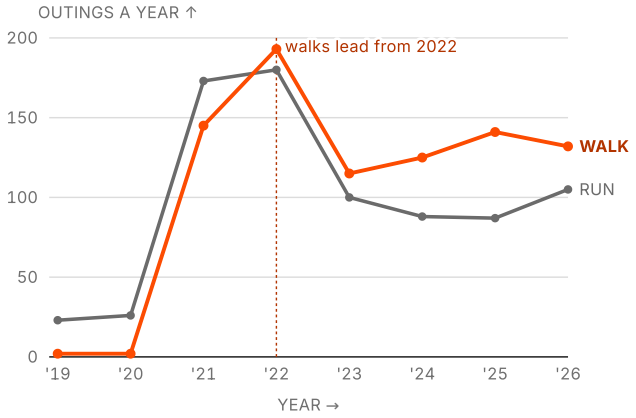
EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

84% of all my outings are on foot.



ON FOOT EVERYTHING ELSE

WALKS AGAINST RUNS, YEAR BY YEAR



Mornings and evenings.

The habit fits around my work, so it does not wait for the weekend. Most outings start early in the morning or in the evening, with 6pm the busiest hour, and every day of the week gets about the same share. Once in a while it is very early or very late: one walk started just before two in the morning, and one run almost at midnight.

WHEN OUTINGS START

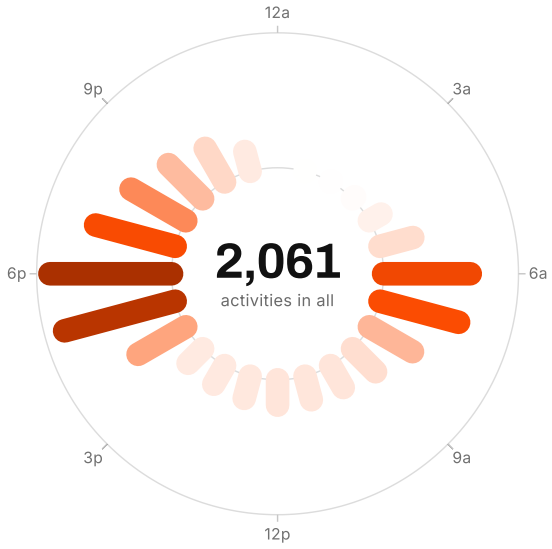
31% before 10 in the morning

14% between 10am and 4pm

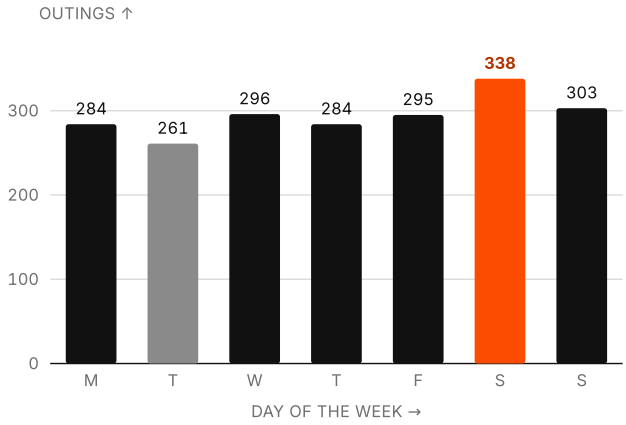
44% between 4 and 9pm

11% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Two quieter months.

Every year has a soft spot, and mine is August and September. They have been my weakest months every year, and the quietest of all was September 2024, with only eight days out. In 2026 I went out on every day of both.

SHARE OF DAYS ACTIVE, 2022 TO 2025

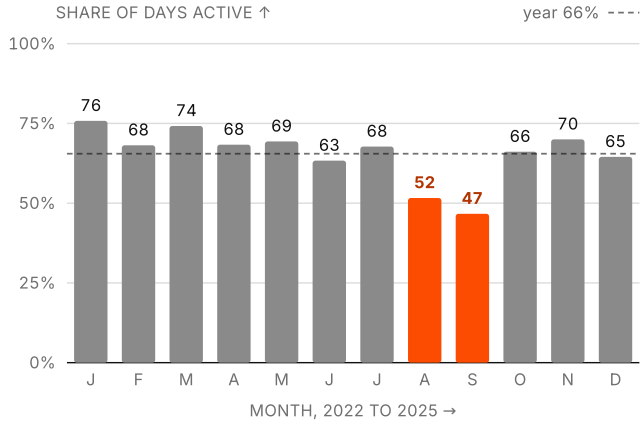
76%
in January, the strongest month

68%
in a typical month

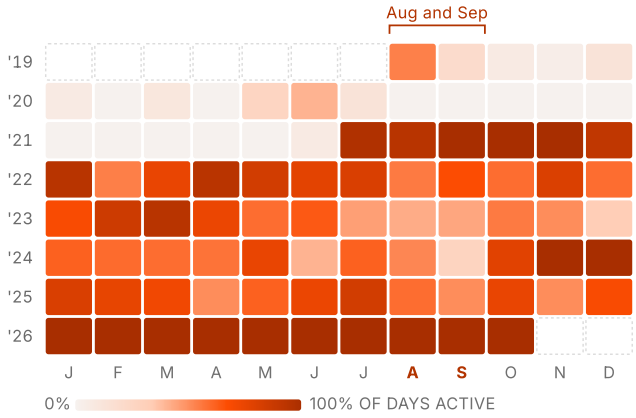
52%
in August

47%
in September

SHARE OF DAYS ACTIVE, BY MONTH



EVERY MONTH OF THE RECORD



Less treadmill every year.

The treadmill is where I learned to run. Of the 8,288 km I have run, 6,905 km were on it, and my only full marathon too. Only recently has more of my running moved outside.

SHARE OF SESSIONS INDOORS

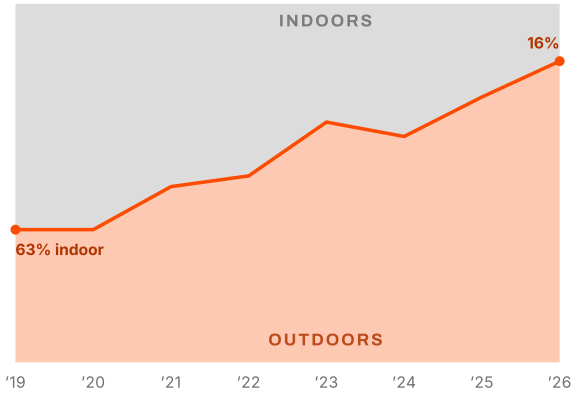
63%
of sessions in 2019

16%
of sessions in 2026

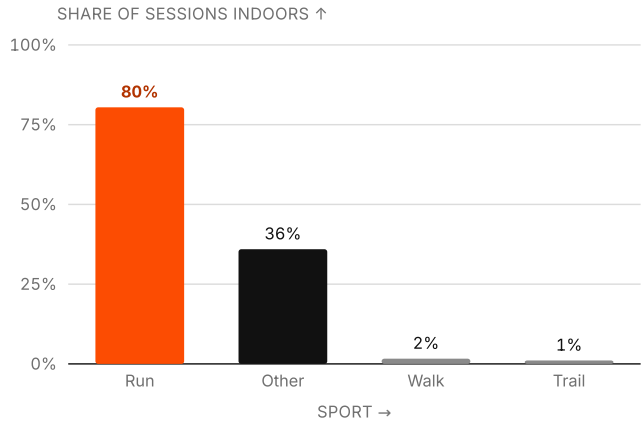
80%
of all runs

2%
of all walks

INDOORS AND OUTDOORS, YEAR BY YEAR



SHARE INDOORS, BY SPORT



Where the height comes from.

Running gives me the kilometres, and walking and the hills give me the height. I climb about 1.4 m for every kilometre I run. At that rate I would need to run more than 1,400 km to match my biggest hike, almost 2,000 m in Morogoro.

SHARE OF DISTANCE AND CLIMB ON FOOT

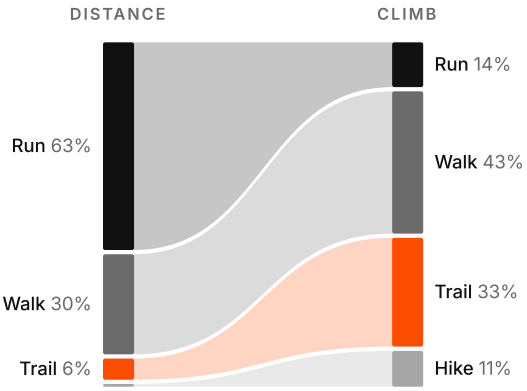
63%
of the distance is running

14%
of the climb is running

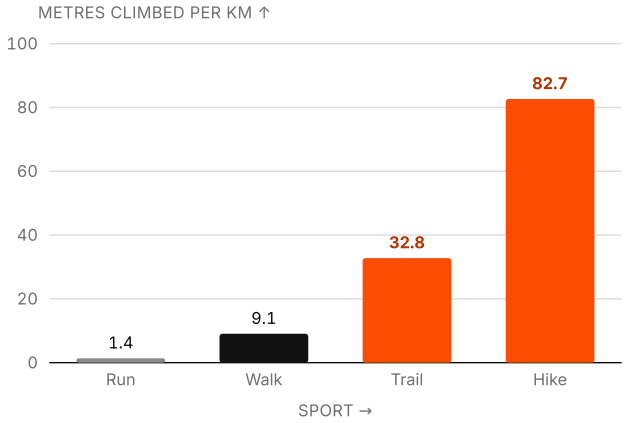
43%
of the climb is walking

44%
of the climb is trail runs and hikes

DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, BY SPORT



METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE



FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Train, train, train. And when you think you have trained enough, keep training.”

JODY MITIC

II

Year by year

Each year on its own, from the quiet first months to the year with no day off.

CHAPTER 2

02 Year in Sport

One year at a time

2019

A small beginning.

Every habit starts small. By the end of my first year I had 27 activities, most of them runs on a treadmill, and the most days I managed in a row was 4.

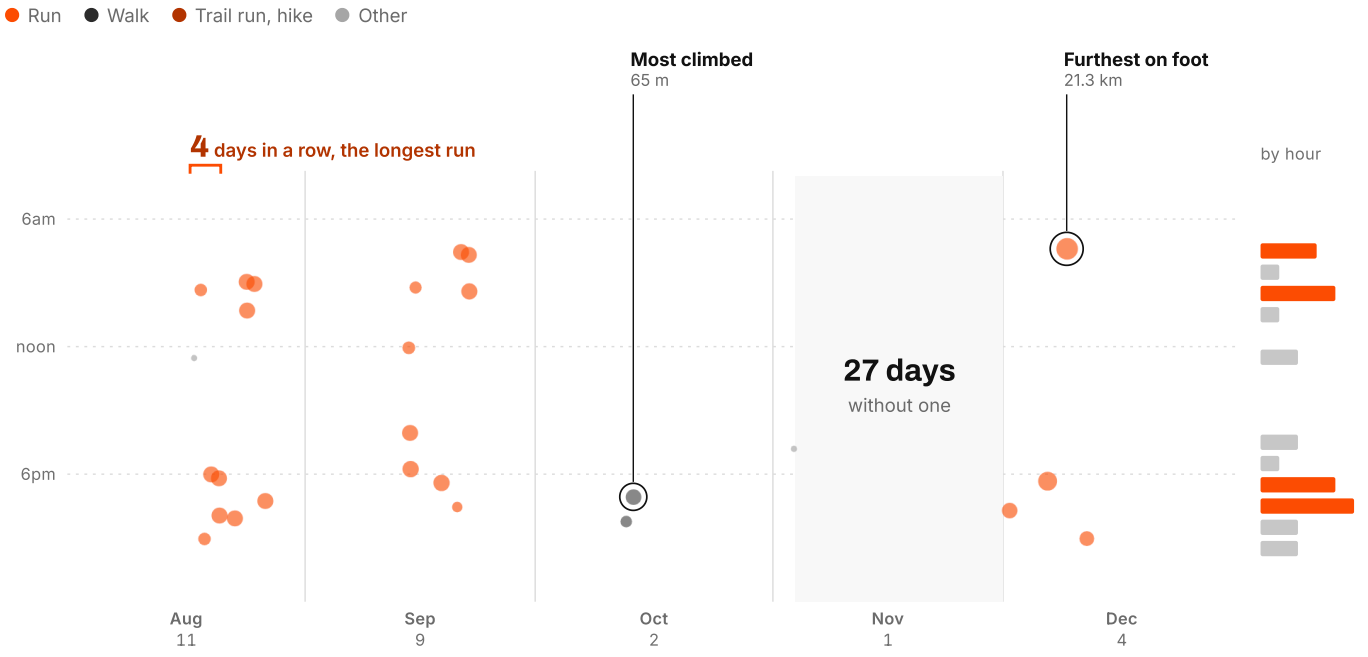
2019 IN FOUR NUMBERS

27
outings

231 km
on foot

85 m
climbed

33 h
moving



August was the busiest.

August was my biggest month for distance too, with 90 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2019 BY THE MONTH

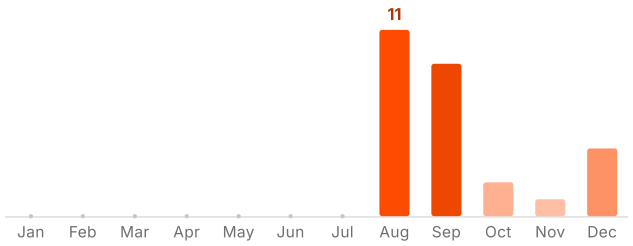
11
outings in August

1
in November, the quietest

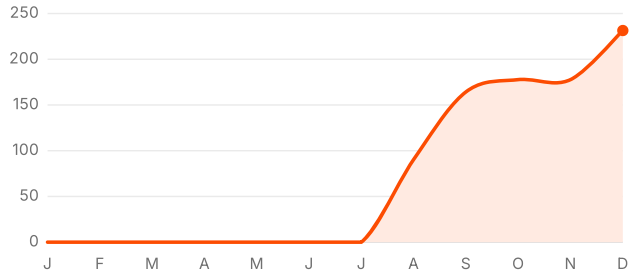
5
outings in an average month

46 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Runs led 2019.

Runs led the year, 23 of my 27 outings, against 2 walks. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

7%
walks

85%
runs

0%
trail runs and hikes

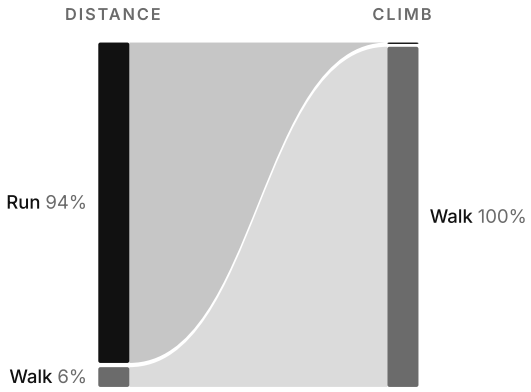
7%
other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

93% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2019, and 7pm was the busiest hour. Sunday was my busiest day and Thursday the quietest. 63% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, more than an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

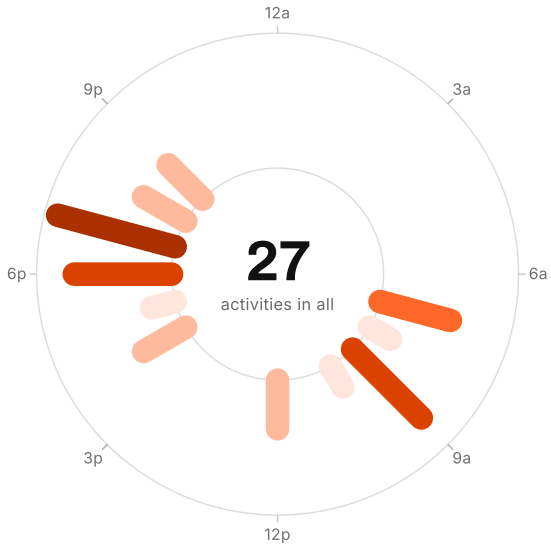
30%
before 10am

11%
between 10am and 4pm

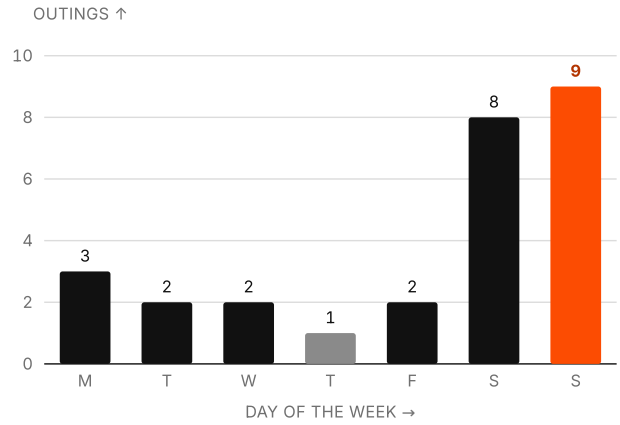
52%
between 4 and 9pm

7%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 15% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 17 Aug to 20 Aug. My longest break ended on 1 Dec.

THE DAYS OF 2019

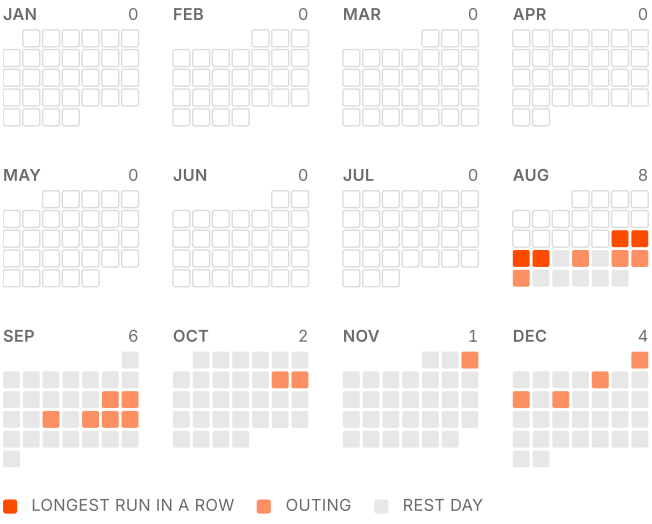
21 days
with an outing, of 137

4 days
the longest run in a row

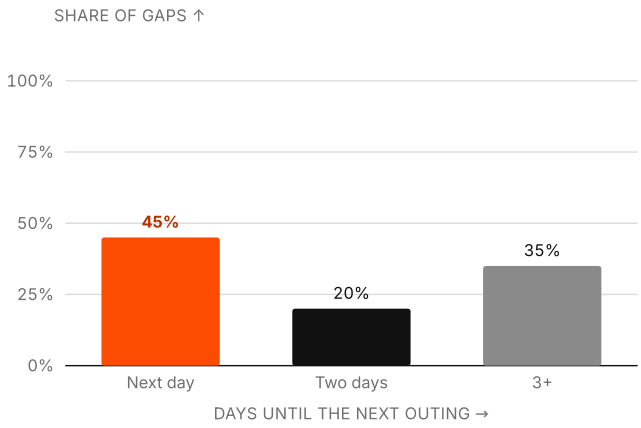
27 days
the longest break

45%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2019



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in Dec 2019.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

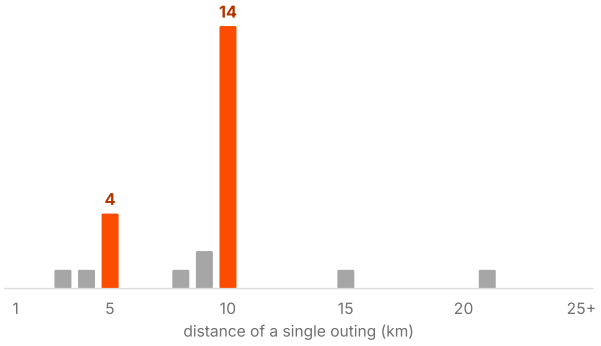
10.0 km
the middle outing

9.3 km
the average outing

21.3 km
the longest

20%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

Too few days on foot to split into tenths.

The biggest days of 2019.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

21.3 km
in a single outing
DEC 2019

LONGEST ON FOOT

2 h 23 min
of moving time in one outing
OCT 2019

MOST CLIMBED

65 m
of climb in one outing
OCT 2019

HARDEST EFFORT

270
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
AUG 2019

PERSONAL RECORDS

0
best times on Strava segments
2019

MOST CHEERED

1
kudos on one other activity
AUG 2019

EVERESTS

0.0 ×
the height of Everest, from 85 m climbed
2019

DAR TO DODOMA

0.5 ×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
231 KM ON FOOT

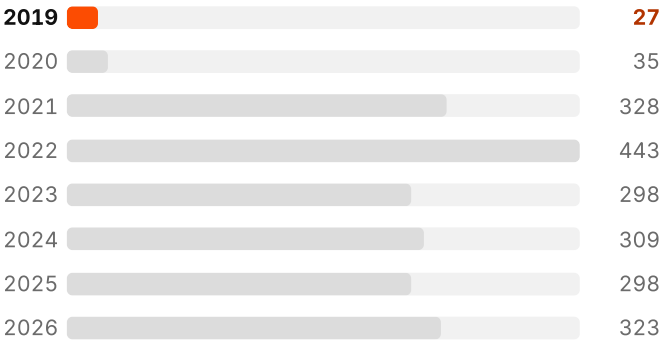
Eighth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes seventh, and for climbing seventh.

2019 AMONG THE YEARS

8	7	7	8
rank by outings	rank by distance	rank by climb	years on record

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



THE FIRST YEAR

2019 is where my record starts.

FIRST STEPS

Where it began.

Looking at it now, nothing there looked like the start of a habit.

27	21	231
ACTIVITIES	ACTIVE DAYS	KILOMETRES ON FOOT

2020

The long pause.

A habit can stop very easily. In July I went out in Kenya, my first outing outside Tanzania, and the next day once more, in Arusha. Then I stopped, and it stayed like that for almost a year.

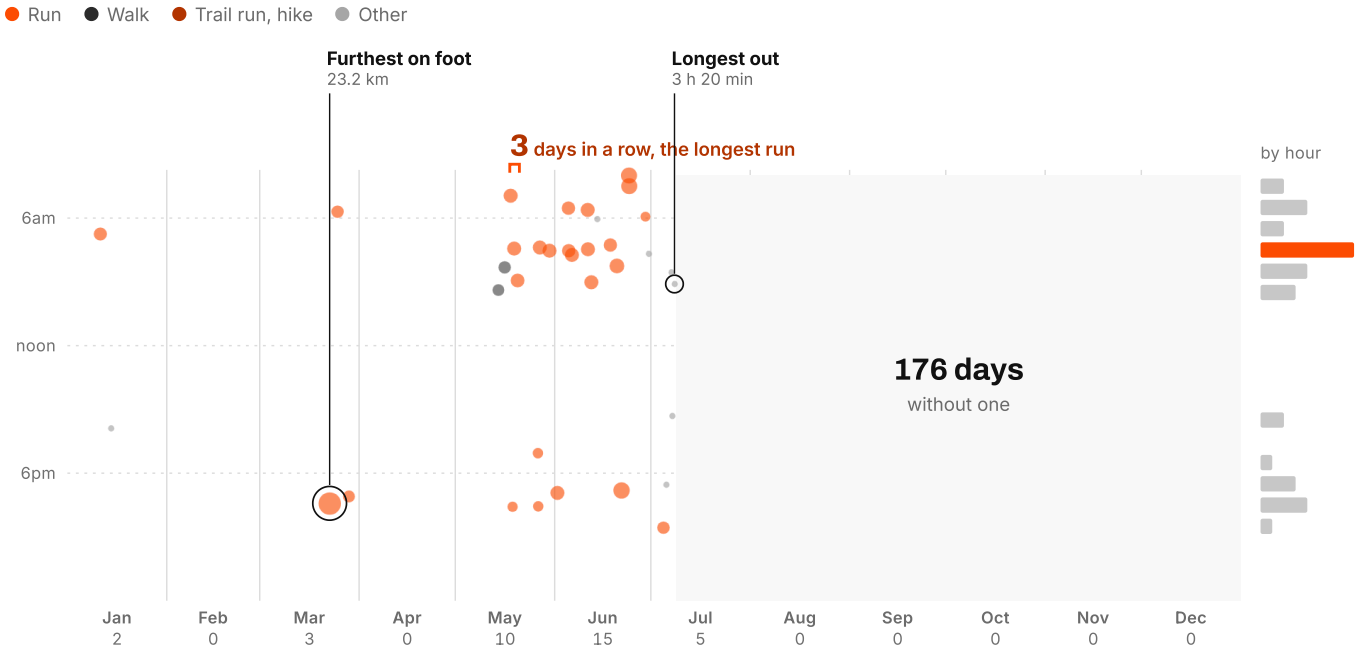
2020 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2019

35
outings, up 30%

191 km
on foot, down 17%

25 m
climbed, down 70%

42 h
moving, up 26%



June was the busiest.

June was my biggest month for distance too, with 95 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. I went out in only five of the twelve months.

2020 BY THE MONTH

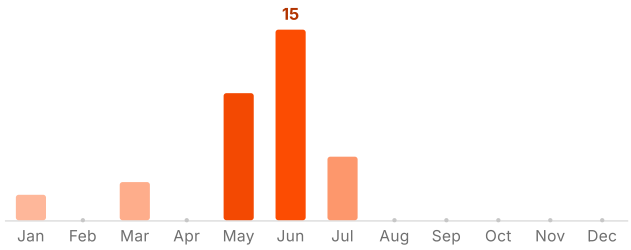
15
outings in June

2
in January, the quietest

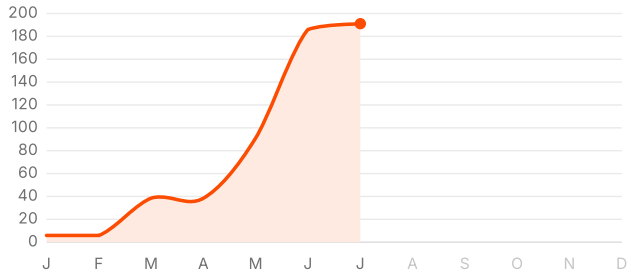
3
outings in an average month

16 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Runs led 2020.

Runs led the year, 26 of my 35 outings, against 2 walks. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

6%
walks

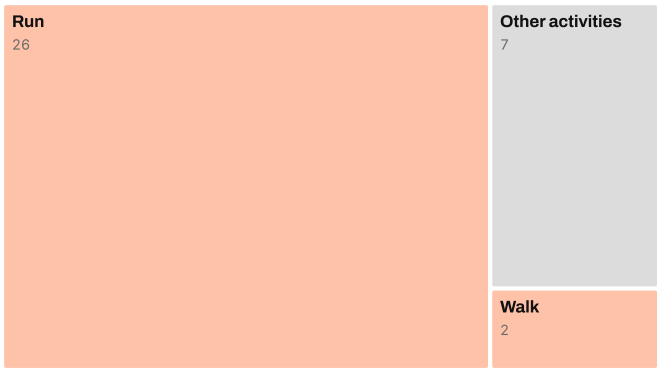
74%
runs

0%
trail runs and hikes

20%
other activities

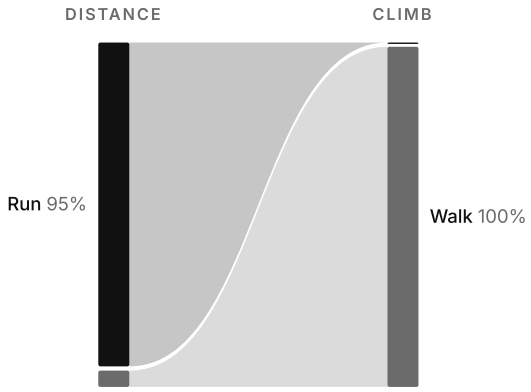
EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

80% of all my outings are on foot.



ON FOOT EVERYTHING ELSE

DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The mornings led.

The mornings were my time in 2020, and 7am was the busiest hour. Tuesday was my busiest day and Friday the quietest. 31% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

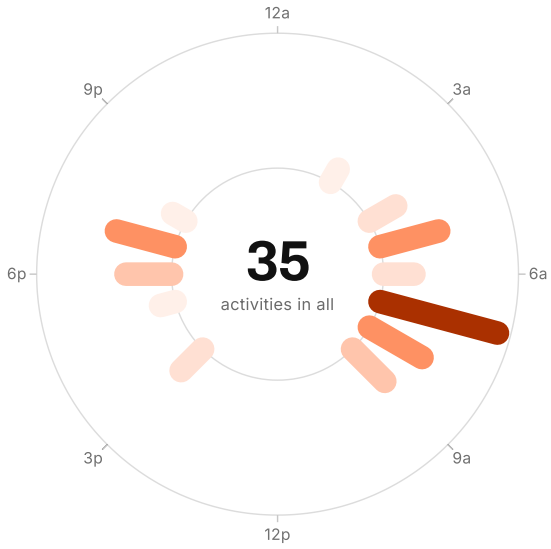
69%
before 10am

6%
between 10am and 4pm

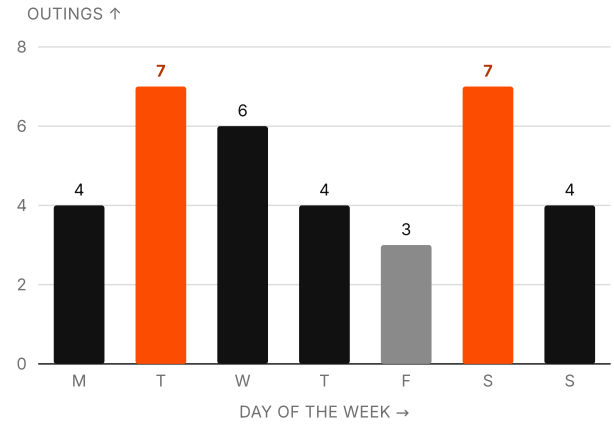
26%
between 4 and 9pm

0%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 8% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 18 May to 20 May. My longest break ended on 22 Mar.

THE DAYS OF 2020

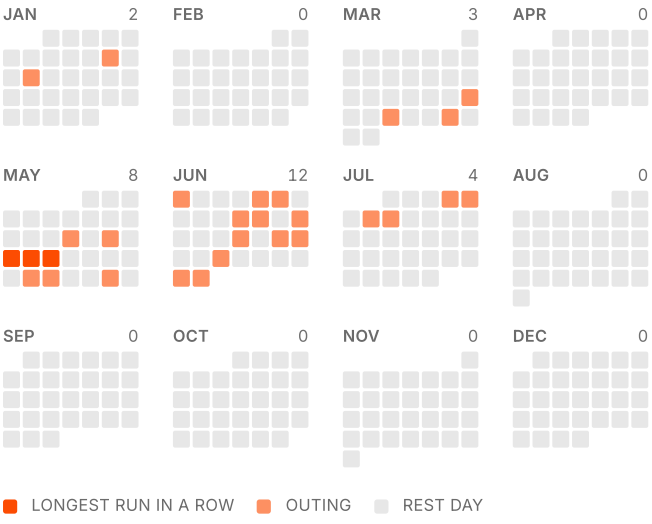
29 days
with an outing, of 366

3 days
the longest run in a row

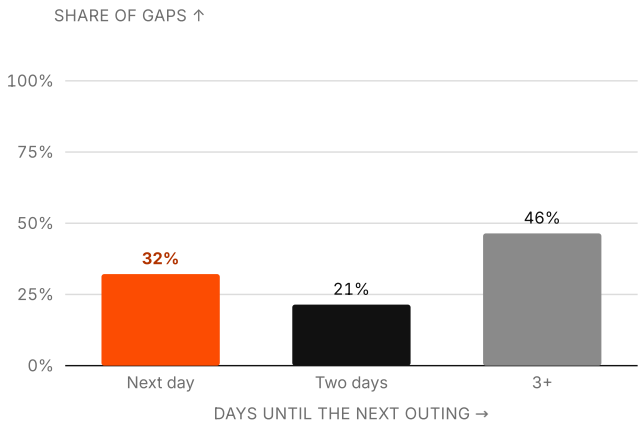
67 days
the longest break

32%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2020



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 6 km or 7 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in Mar 2020.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

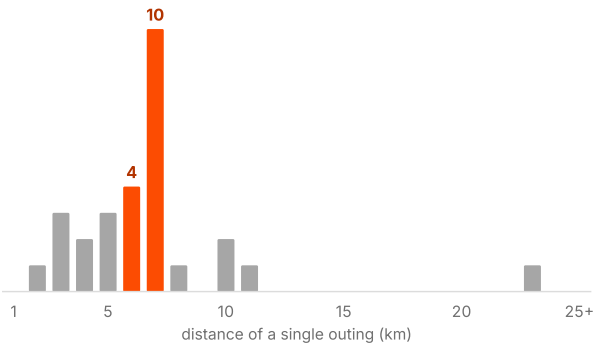
6.8 km
the middle outing

6.8 km
the average outing

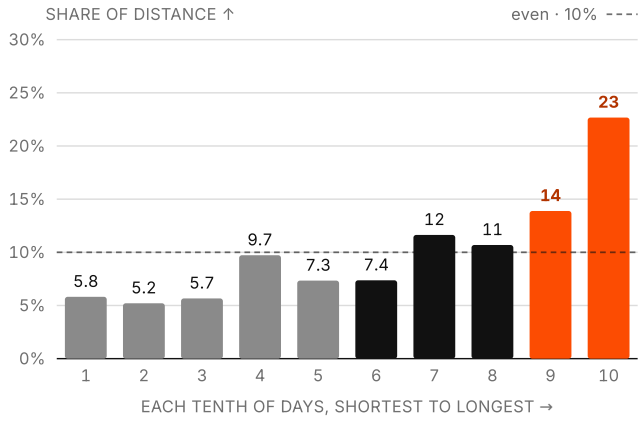
23.2 km
the longest

23%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



The biggest days of 2020.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

23.2 km
in a single outing
MAR 2020

LONGEST ON FOOT

1 h 57 min
of moving time in one outing
MAR 2020

MOST CLIMBED

15 m
of climb in one outing
MAY 2020

HARDEST EFFORT

181
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
JAN 2020

PERSONAL RECORDS

0
best times on Strava segments
2020

MOST CHEERED

5
kudos on one other activity
JUL 2020

EVERESTS

0.0 ×
the height of Everest, from 25 m climbed
2020

DAR TO DODOMA

0.4 ×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
191 KM ON FOOT

Seventh of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes eighth, and for climbing eighth.

2020 AGAINST 2019

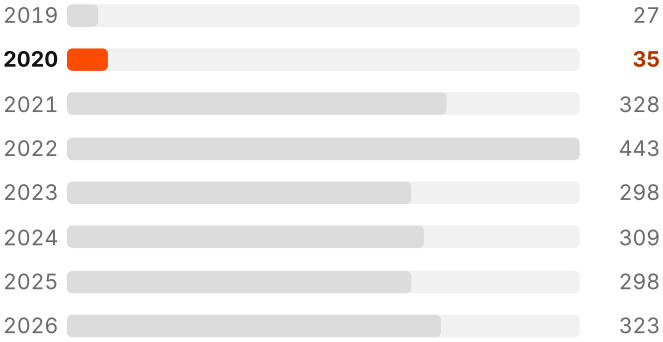
+30%
outings

−17%
distance on foot

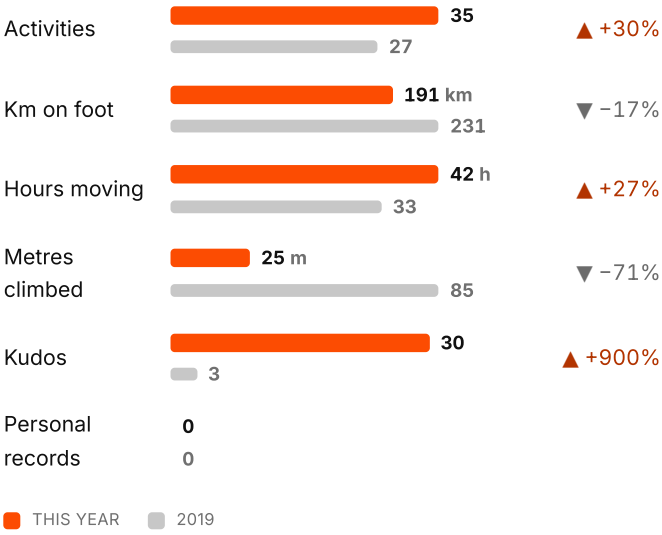
−70%
metres climbed

0%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2020 BESIDE 2019



THE QUIET YEAR

Then I stopped.

After the middle of the year I stopped logging, and it stayed like that for months.

35
ACTIVITIES

29
ACTIVE DAYS

3
LONGEST STREAK

2021

The year I came back.

Kawia ufike, it is better to arrive late than not to arrive. I came back in June with a 10 km run, after 353 days away. Within weeks I was going out almost every day, and on 57% of my days out I went out more than once. Everything after grew from this year.

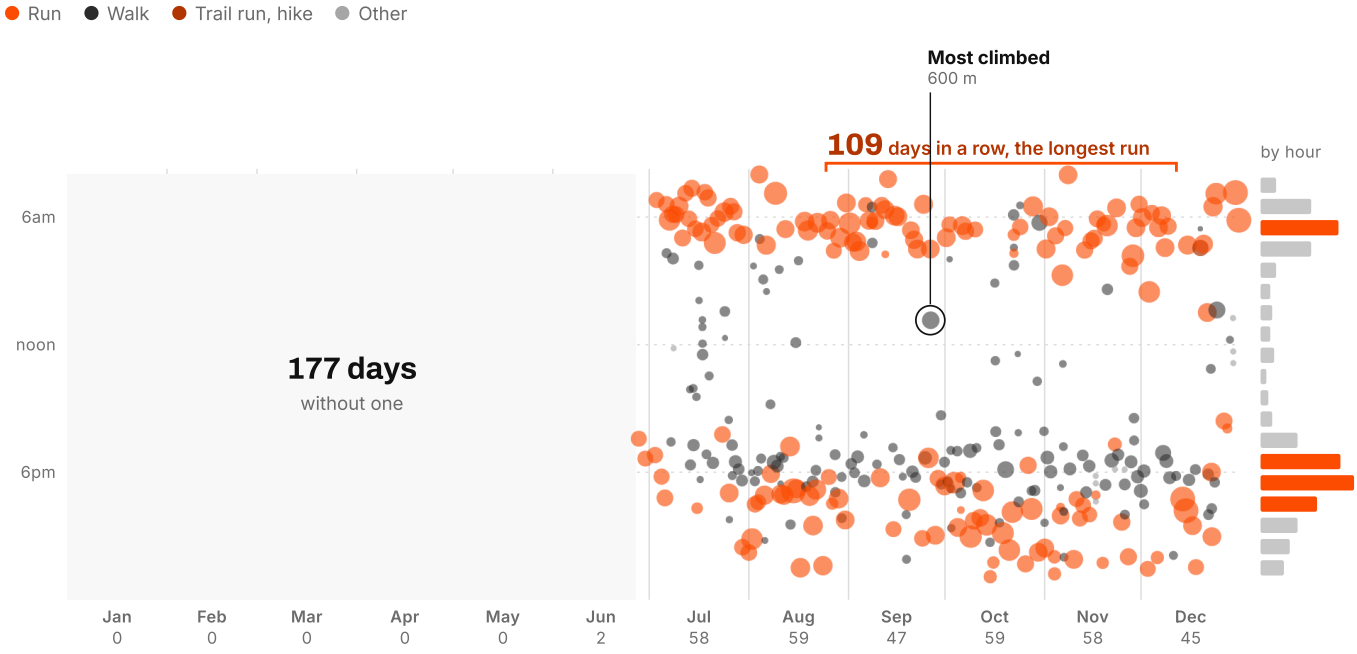
2021 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2020

328
outings, up 837%

2,885 km
on foot, up 1410%

6,560 m
climbed, up 25726%

318 h
moving, up 659%



August was the busiest.

August was my biggest month for distance too, with 559 km on foot. The year started slowly and grew stronger as it went. I went out in only seven of the twelve months.

2021 BY THE MONTH

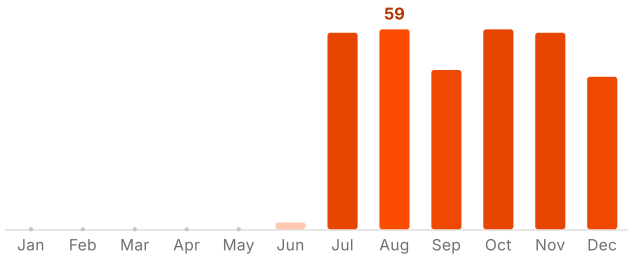
59
outings in August

2
in June, the quietest

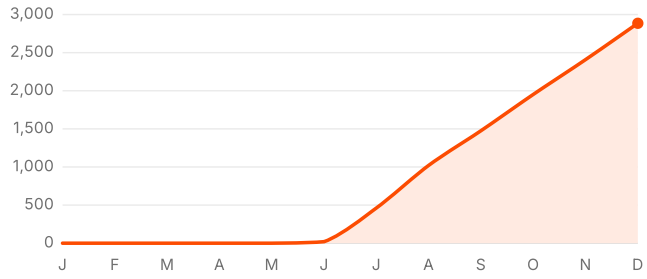
27
outings in an average month

240 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Runs led 2021.

Runs led the year, 173 of my 328 outings, against 145 walks and one trail run or hike. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 11 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

44%
walks

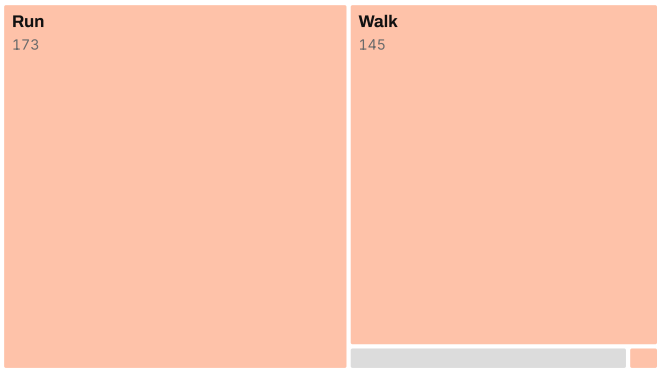
53%
runs

0%
trail runs and hikes

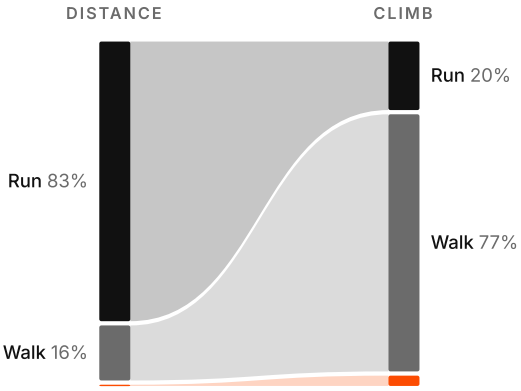
3%
other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

97% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2021, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Wednesday was my busiest day and Monday the quietest, but not by much. 29% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

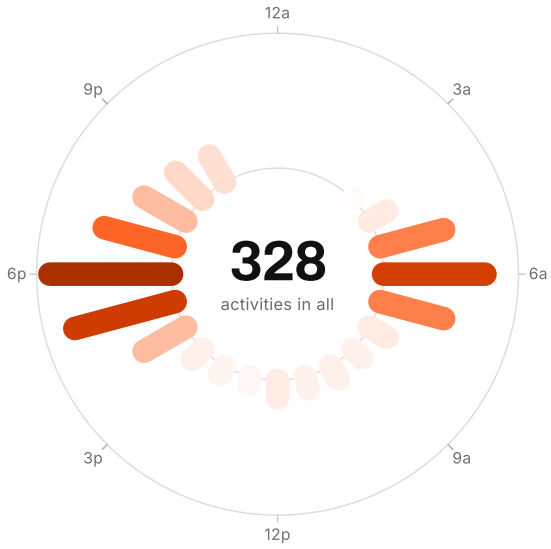
35%
before 10am

9%
between 10am and 4pm

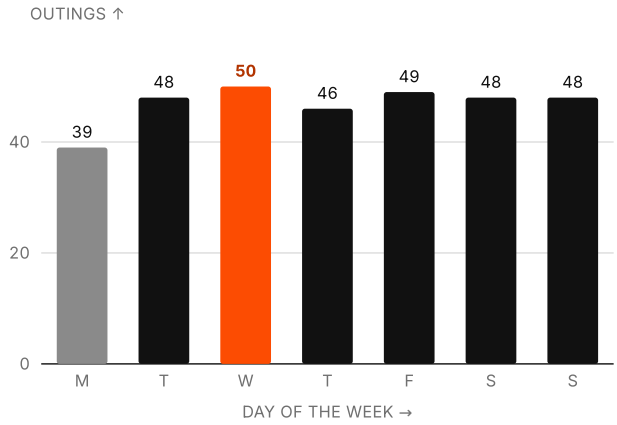
48%
between 4 and 9pm

8%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 49% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 25 Aug to 11 Dec. My longest break ended on 2 Jul.

THE DAYS OF 2021

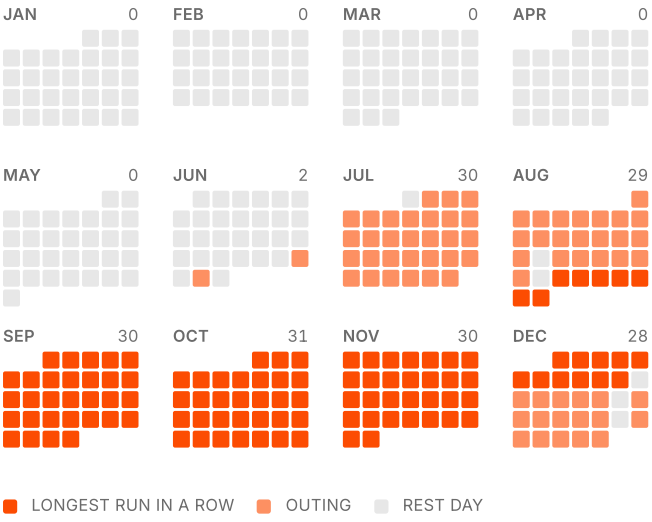
180 days
with an outing, of 365

109 days
the longest run in a row

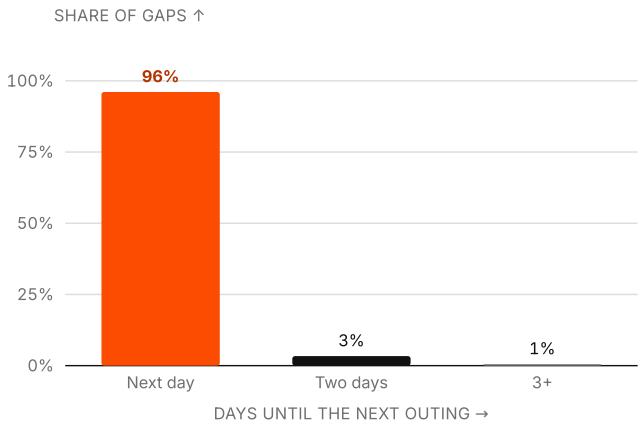
2 days
the longest break

96%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2021



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 2 km or 3 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in Dec 2021.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

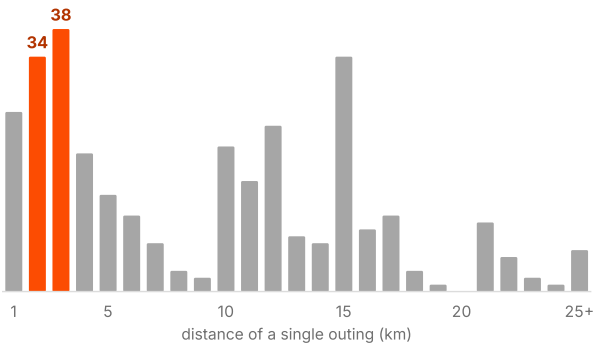
9.9 km
the middle outing

9.2 km
the average outing

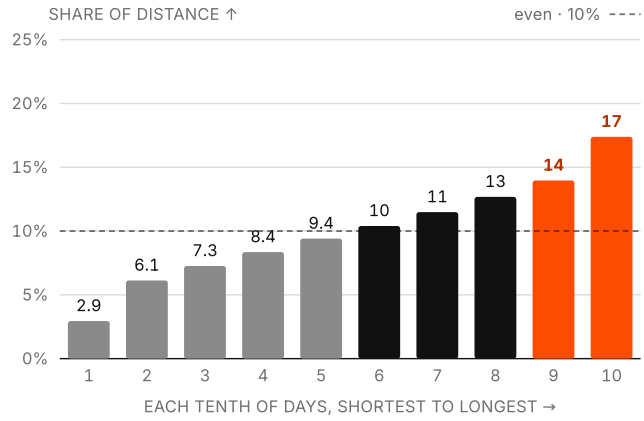
30.1 km
the longest

18%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a rest day, I usually rested again. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 151 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

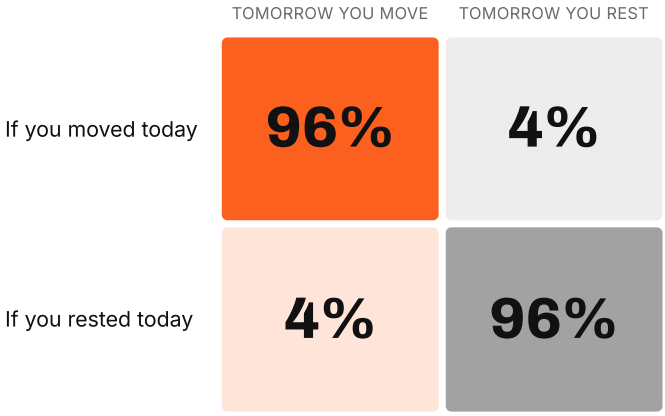
96%
went out again the day after a day out

4%
went out the day after a rest day

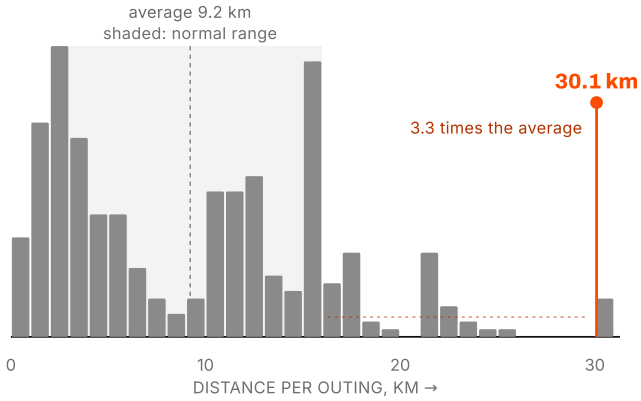
0.23
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.3×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



7 · BIGGEST DAYS

The biggest days of 2021.

FURTHEST ON FOOT
30.1 km
in a single outing
DEC 2021

LONGEST ON FOOT
3 h 5 min
of moving time in one outing
DEC 2021

MOST CLIMBED
600 m
of climb in one outing
SEP 2021

HARDEST EFFORT
377
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
OCT 2021

PERSONAL RECORDS
36
best times on Strava segments
2021

MOST CHEERED
74
kudos on one run
NOV 2021

EVERESTS
0.7×
the height of Everest, from 6,560 m climbed
2021

DAR TO DODOMA
6.4×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
2,885 KM ON FOOT

Mostly at home.

All of them were in Tanzania. The climbing was mostly in Dodoma.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

160
outings with a GPS start point

1
country

7
regions of Tanzania

65%
of outings in Dodoma

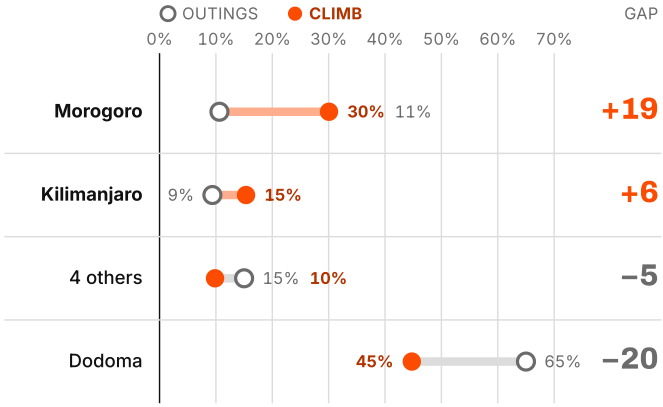
HOME AGAINST AWAY



Tanzania · 160 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 0 OUTINGS

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



Second of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes second, and for climbing sixth.

2021 AGAINST 2020

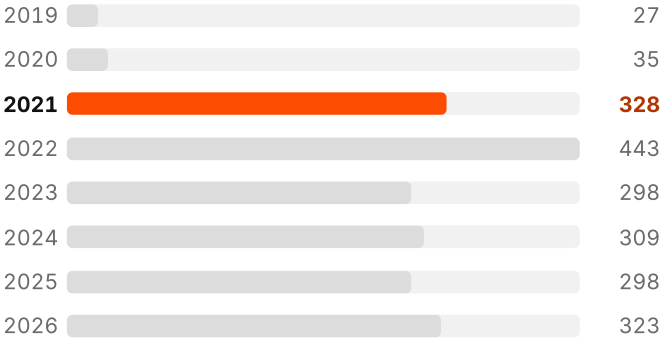
+837%
outings

+1,410%
distance on foot

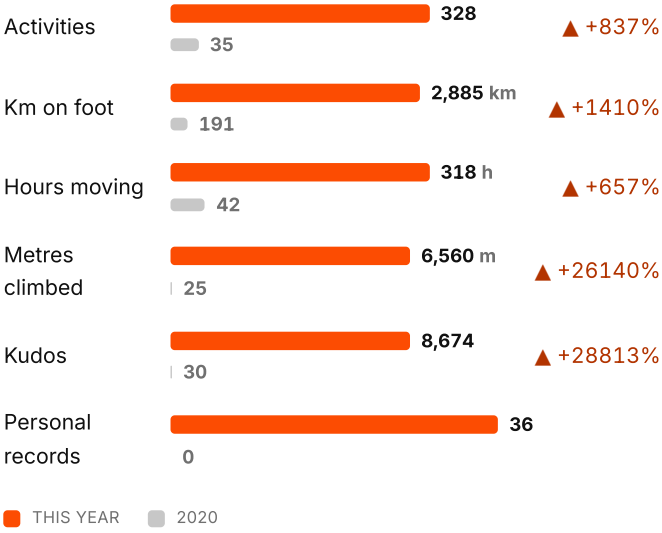
+25,726%
metres climbed

0%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



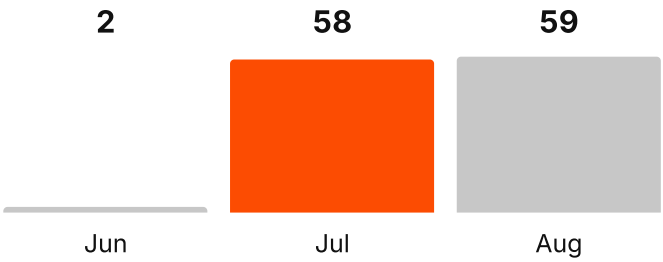
2021 BESIDE 2020



COMING BACK

The year it caught.

For the first half of the year there is almost nothing. Then, in the middle of the year, a few outings a month became dozens, and before the year ended I had gone out 109 days in a row.



2022

The busiest year.

When the habit is strong, the big days come. This was my busiest year, and I ran a full marathon on the treadmill, the longest outing in my log. It was also the first year I walked more often than I ran, 193 walks to 180 runs.

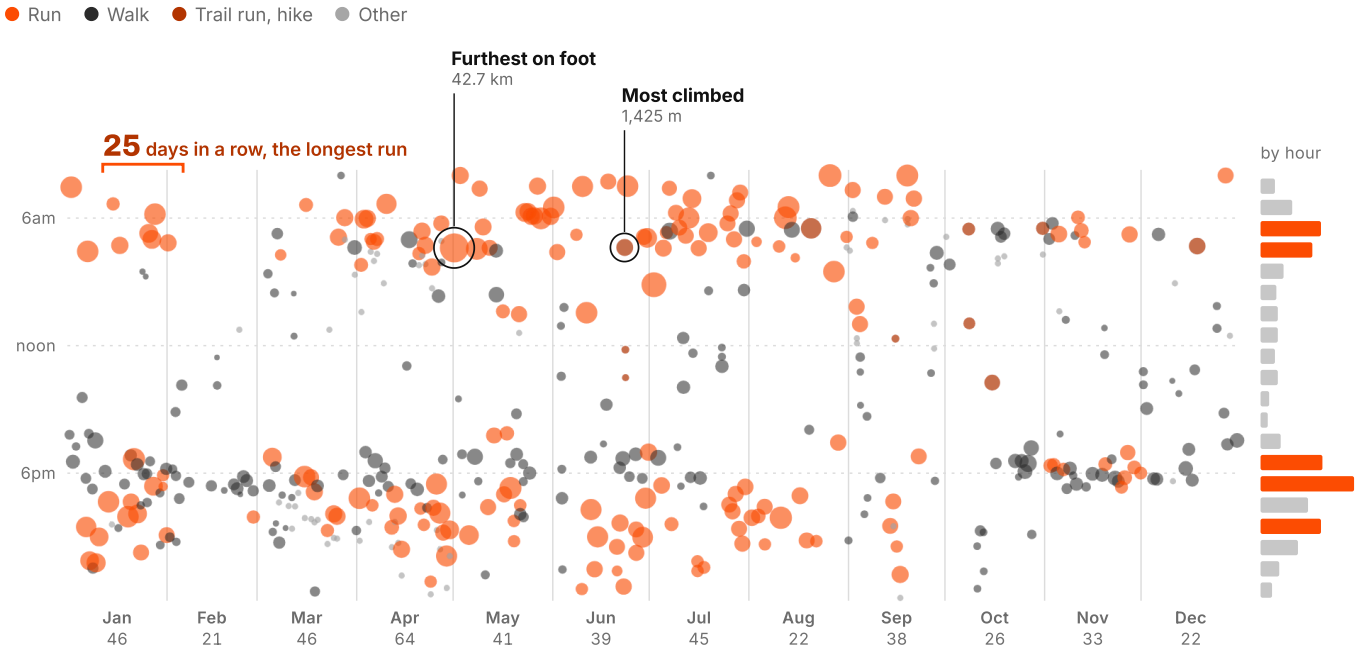
2022 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2021

443
outings, up 35%

2,907 km
on foot, up 1%

12,623 m
climbed, up 92%

414 h
moving, up 30%



April was the busiest.

The most distance came in January, with 392 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2022 BY THE MONTH

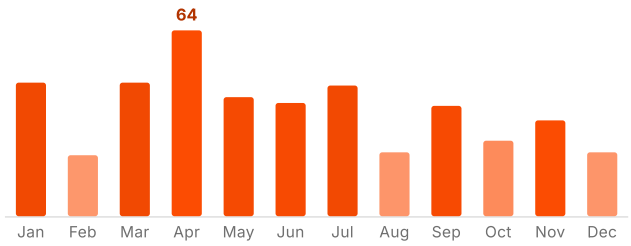
64
outings in April

21
in February, the quietest

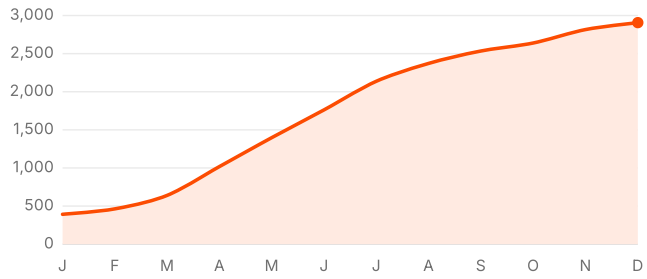
37
outings in an average month

242 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Walks led 2022.

Walks led the year, 193 of my 443 outings, against 180 runs and 10 trail runs or hikes. Running still gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 56 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

44%
walks

41%
runs

2%
trail runs and hikes

14%
other activities

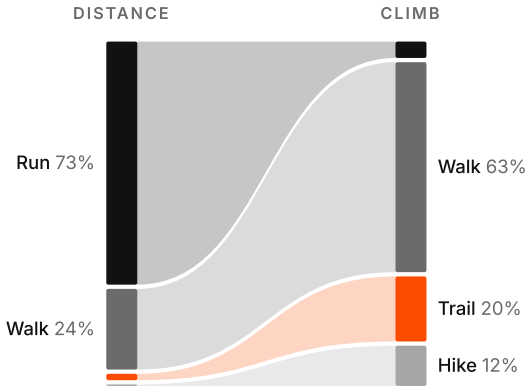
EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

86% of all my outings are on foot.



ON FOOT EVERYTHING ELSE

DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2022, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest, but not by much. 30% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

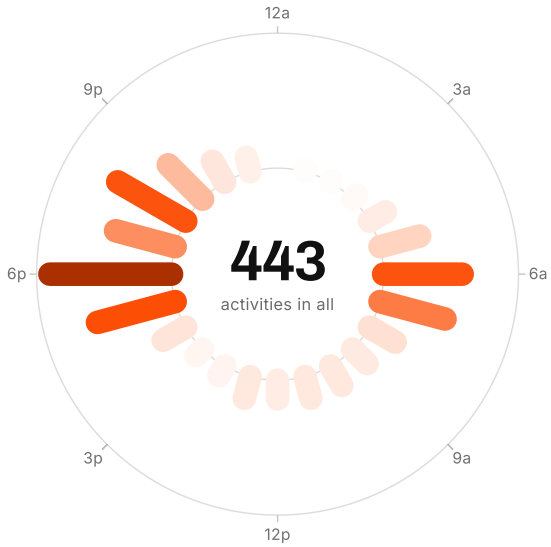
32%
before 10am

13%
between 10am and 4pm

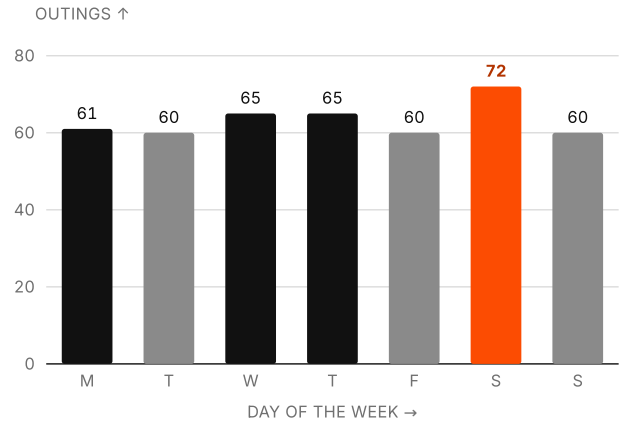
44%
between 4 and 9pm

11%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 73% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 12 Jan to 5 Feb. My longest break ended on 14 Feb.

THE DAYS OF 2022

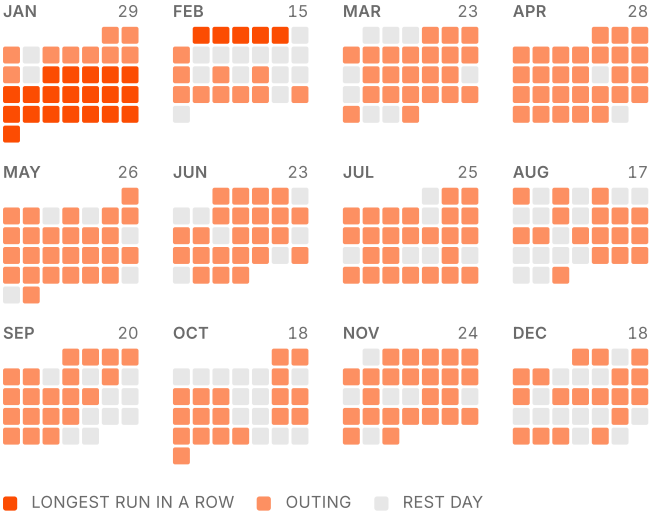
266 days
with an outing, of 365

25 days
the longest run in a row

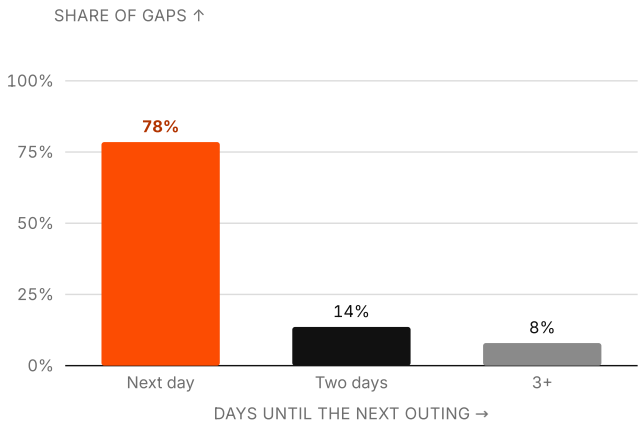
6 days
the longest break

78%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2022



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 1 km or 10 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in May 2022.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

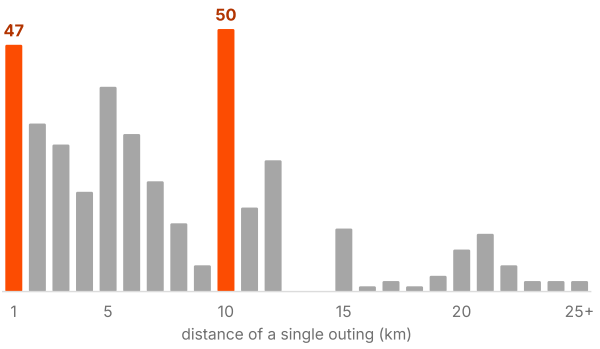
6.1 km
the middle outing

7.8 km
the average outing

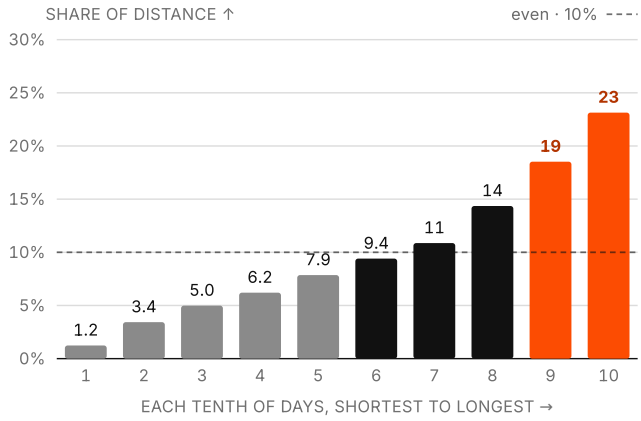
42.7 km
the longest

24%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a rest day, it could go either way. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 148 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

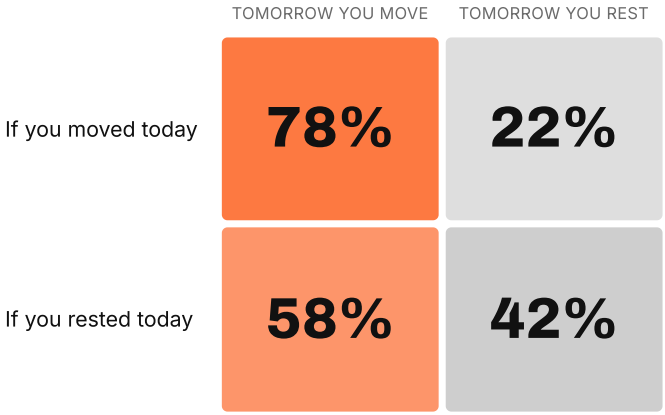
78%
went out again the day after a day out

58%
went out the day after a rest day

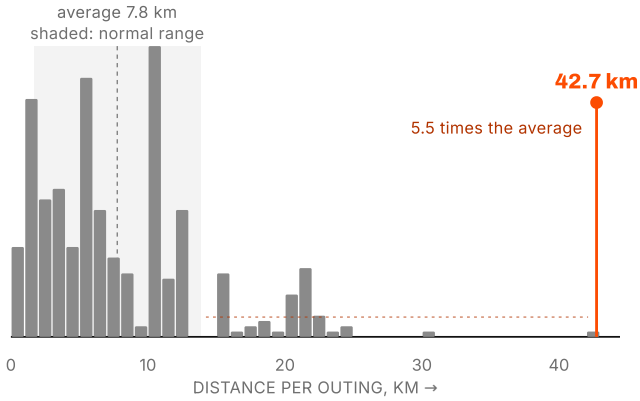
0.37
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

5.5×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



The biggest days of 2022.

FURTHEST ON FOOT
42.7 km
in a single outing
MAY 2022

LONGEST ON FOOT
3 h 25 min
of moving time in one outing
JUN 2022

MOST CLIMBED
1,425 m
of climb in one outing
JUN 2022

HARDEST EFFORT
705
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
MAY 2022

PERSONAL RECORDS
40
best times on Strava segments
2022

MOST CHEERED
92
kudos on one trail run
AUG 2022

EVERESTS
1.4×
the height of Everest, from 12,623 m climbed
2022

DAR TO DODOMA
6.5×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
2,907 KM ON FOOT

Mostly at home.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in Kenya. The climbing was mostly in Morogoro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

216
outings with a GPS start point

2
countries

9
regions of Tanzania

39%
of outings in Dodoma

HOME AGAINST AWAY

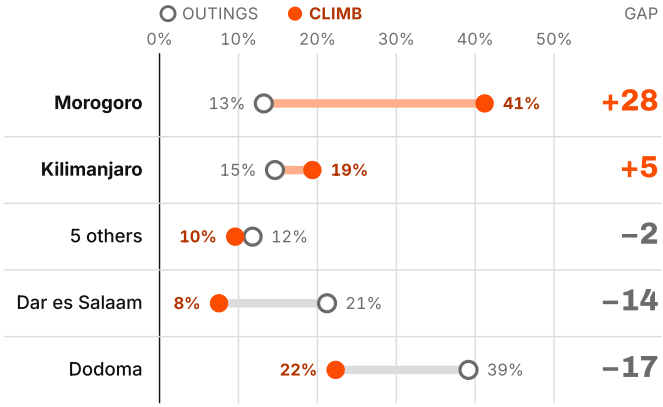


Tanzania · 212 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 4 OUTINGS

Kenya	4	2022

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



First of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes first, and for climbing fourth.

2022 AGAINST 2021

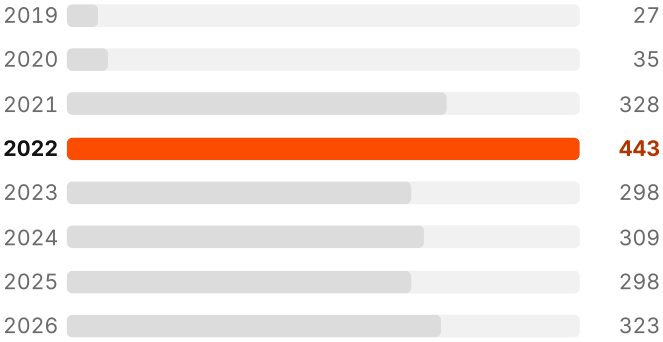
+35%
outings

+1%
distance on foot

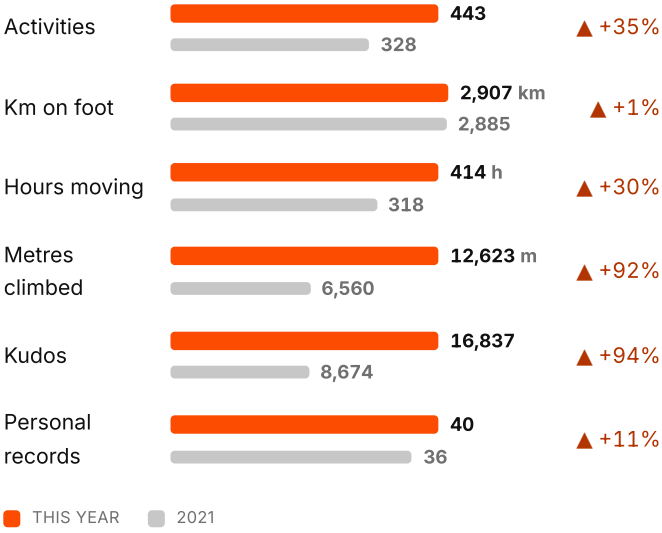
+92%
metres climbed

+11%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2022 BESIDE 2021



THE BUSIEST

My busiest year.

More activities than any other year. It was also the first year I walked more often than I ran.



2023

The year of the hills.

Fewer outings can still mean more. I went out a bit less than in 2022, but I went to the hills more. In March alone I climbed more than 5,000 m, most of it in Kilimanjaro, and over the year I ran 303 km on trails.

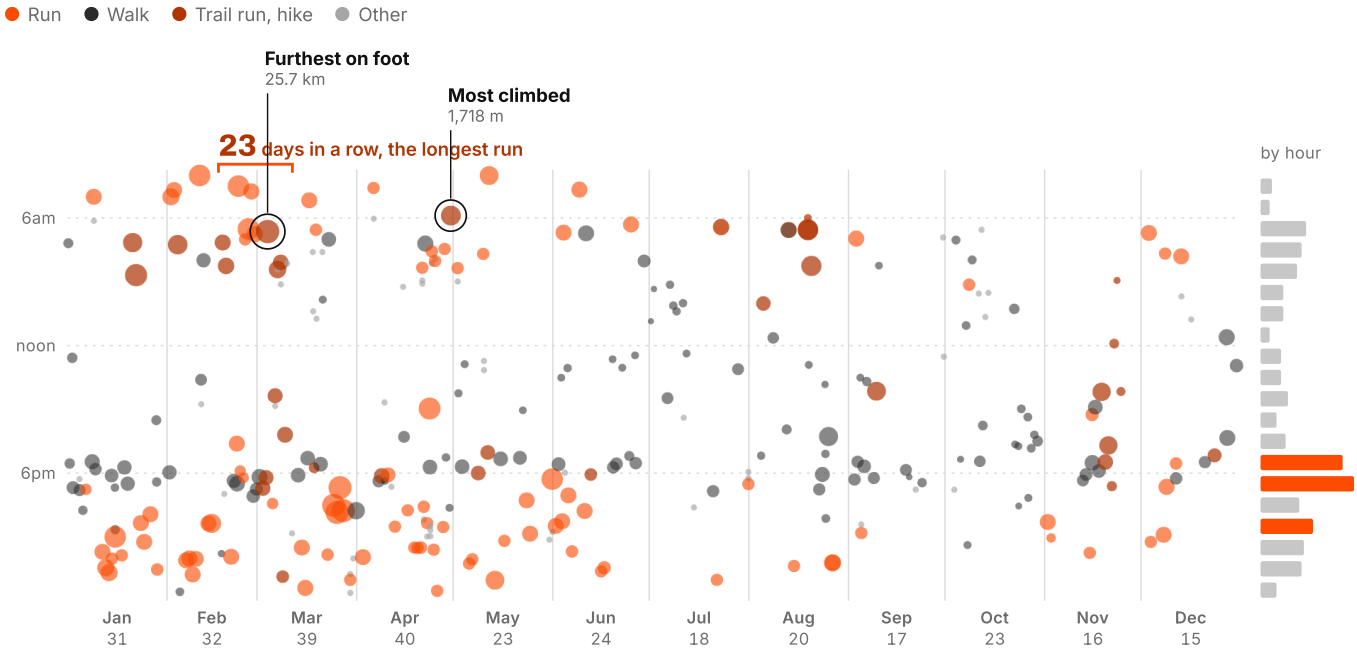
2023 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2022

298
outings, down 33%

1,769 km
on foot, down 39%

21,490 m
climbed, up 70%

361 h
moving, down 13%



April was the busiest.

The most distance came in March, with 297 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2023 BY THE MONTH

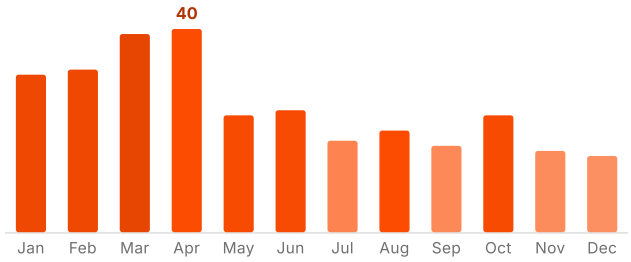
40
outings in April

15
in December, the quietest

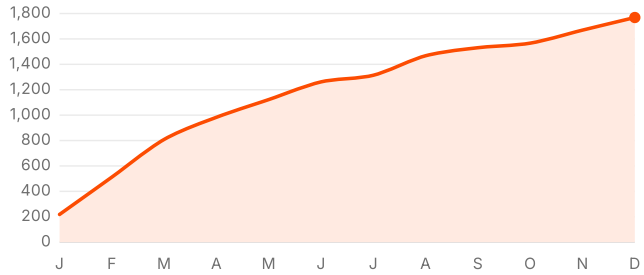
25
outings in an average month

147 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Walks led 2023.

Walks led the year, 115 of my 298 outings, against 100 runs and 33 trail runs or hikes. Running still gave me most of my distance, and trail running gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 303 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

39%
walks

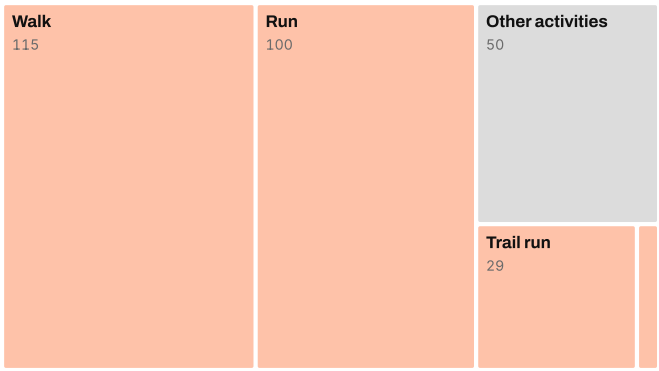
34%
runs

11%
trail runs and hikes

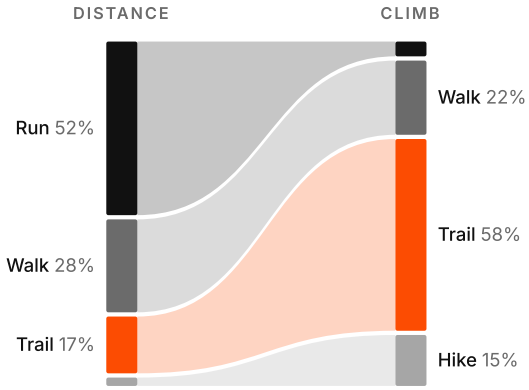
17%
other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

83% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2023, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest. 35% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

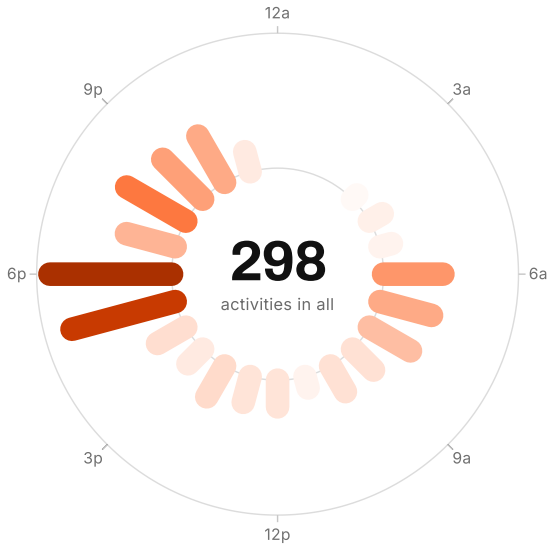
25%
before 10am

17%
between 10am and 4pm

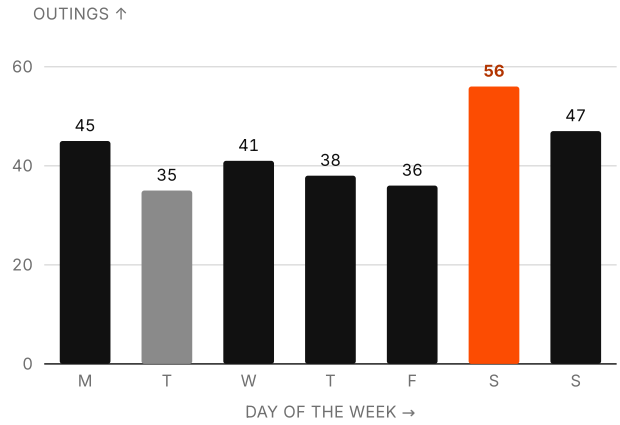
43%
between 4 and 9pm

15%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 59% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 17 Feb to 11 Mar. My longest break ended on 12 Nov.

THE DAYS OF 2023

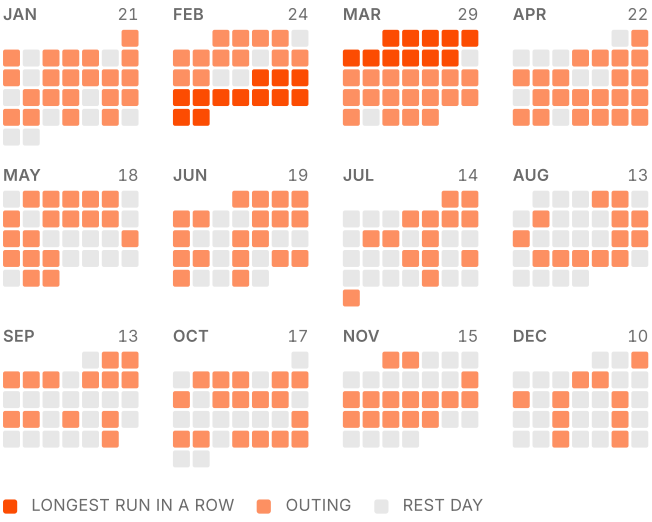
215 days
with an outing, of 365

23 days
the longest run in a row

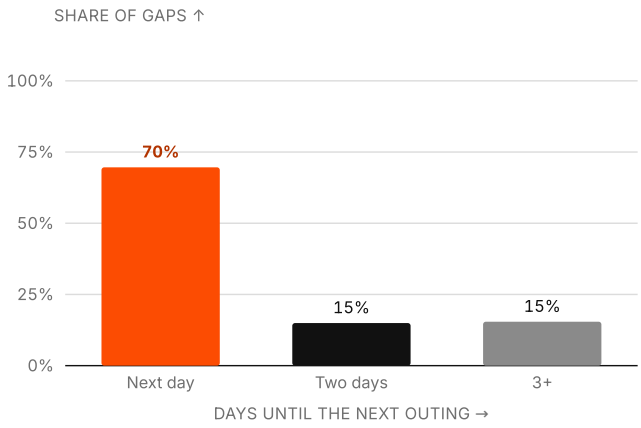
9 days
the longest break

70%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2023



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in Mar 2023.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

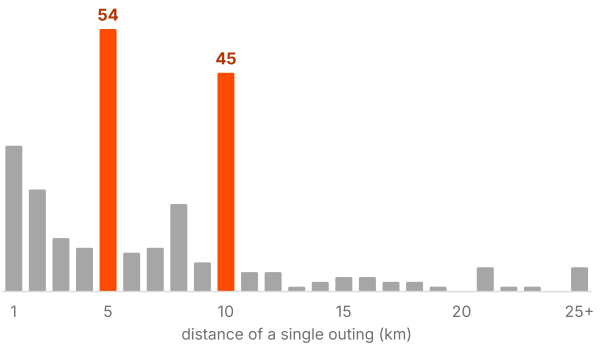
5.3 km
the middle outing

7.2 km
the average outing

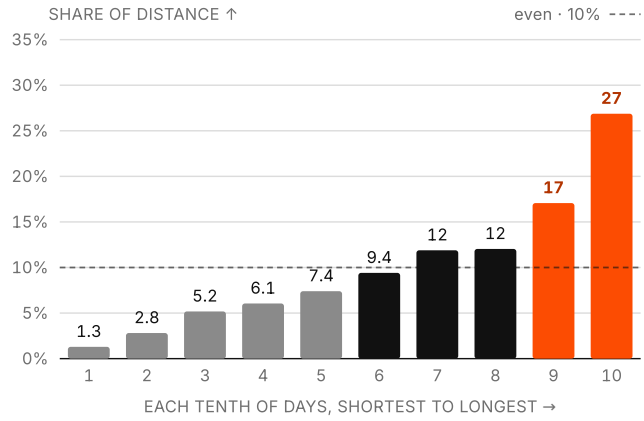
25.7 km
the longest

27%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a rest day, I usually rested again. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 98 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

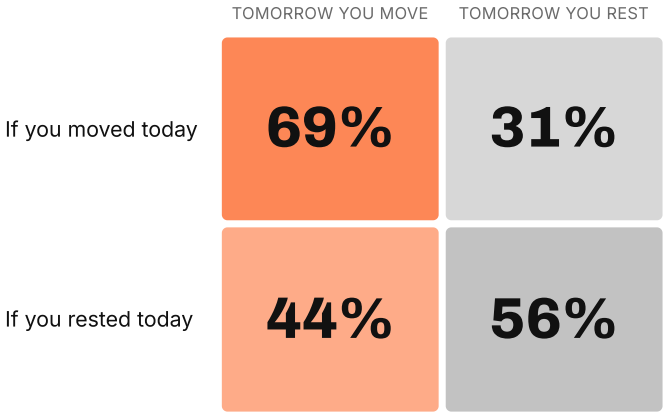
69%
went out again the day after a day out

44%
went out the day after a rest day

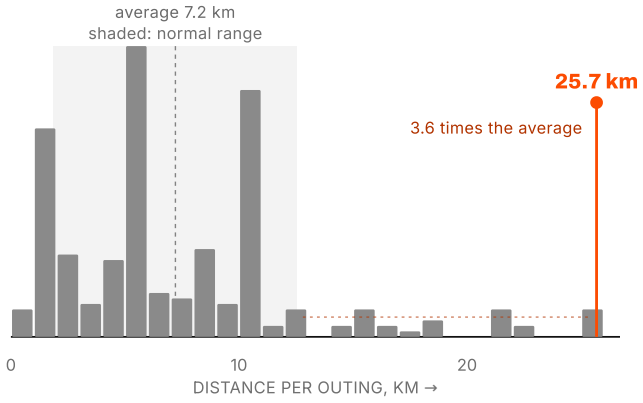
0.39
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.6×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



The biggest days of 2023.

FURTHEST ON FOOT
25.7 km
in a single outing
MAR 2023

LONGEST ON FOOT
8 h 38 min
of moving time in one outing
APR 2023

MOST CLIMBED
1,718 m
of climb in one outing
APR 2023

HARDEST EFFORT
644
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
AUG 2023

PERSONAL RECORDS
96
best times on Strava segments
2023

MOST CHEERED
125
kudos on one run
FEB 2023

EVERESTS
2.4×
the height of Everest, from 21,490 m climbed
2023

DAR TO DODOMA
3.9×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
1,769 KM ON FOOT

Mostly at home.

All of them were in Tanzania. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

175
outings with a GPS start point

1
country

12
regions of Tanzania

33%
of outings in Dodoma

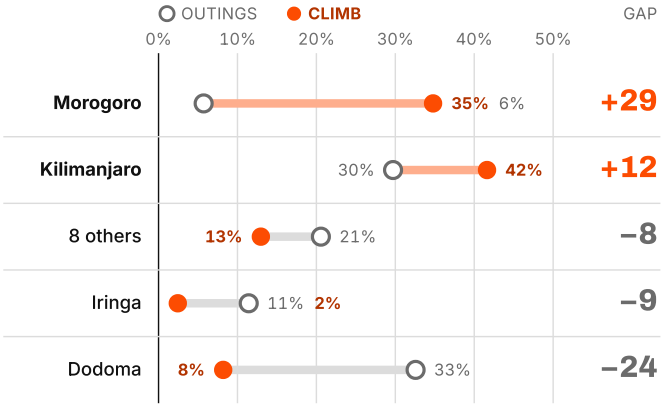
HOME AGAINST AWAY



Tanzania · 175 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 0 OUTINGS

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



Fifth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes fourth, and for climbing first.

2023 AGAINST 2022

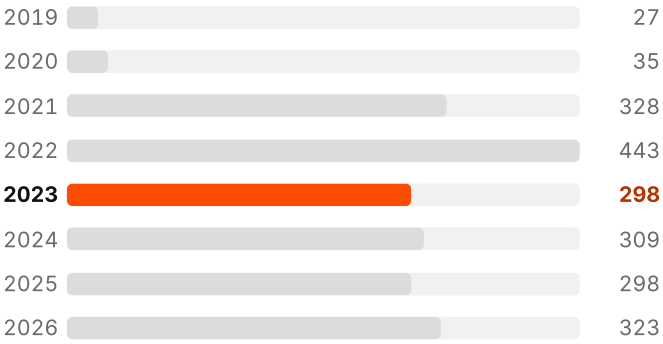
−33%
outings

−39%
distance on foot

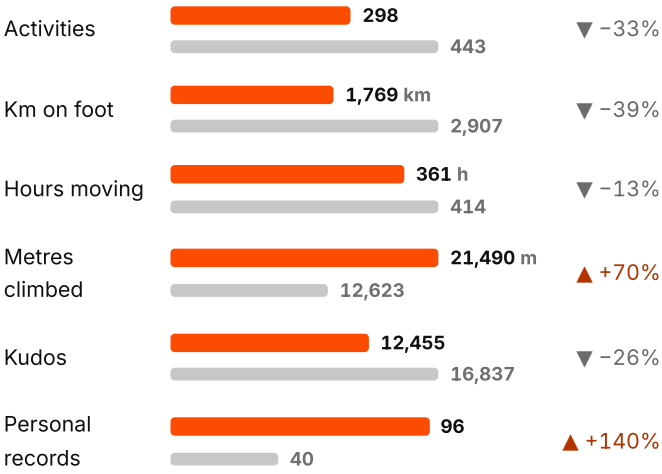
+70%
metres climbed

+140%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2023 BESIDE 2022



THE HILLS

A year in the hills.

I went to the hills more than ever. In March I also ran a 100 km stage race, over four evenings in a row.

21,490
METRES CLIMBED

303
KM ON TRAILS

My biggest month for climbing was **Mar**, with 5,279 m.

2024

The travel year.

Even in a low year, the days can hold. It was my travel year, with outings in five countries, and my lowest distance since the habit started. Still, I went out on 234 days.

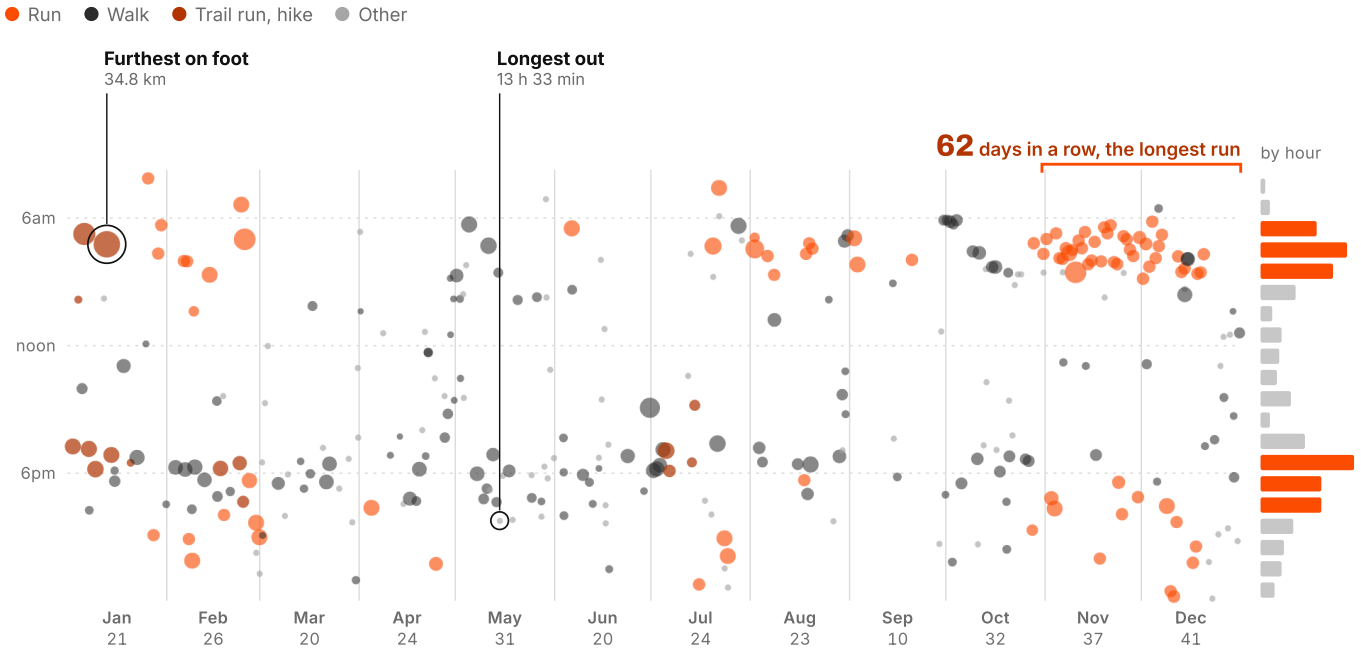
2024 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2023

309
outings, up 4%

1,214 km
on foot, down 31%

8,117 m
climbed, down 62%

307 h
moving, down 15%



December was the busiest.

The most distance came in November, with 194 km on foot. The year started slowly and grew stronger as it went. There was no empty month.

2024 BY THE MONTH

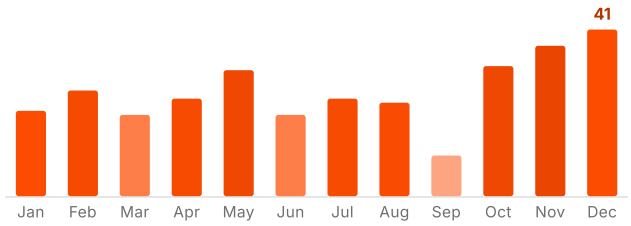
41
outings in December

10
in September, the quietest

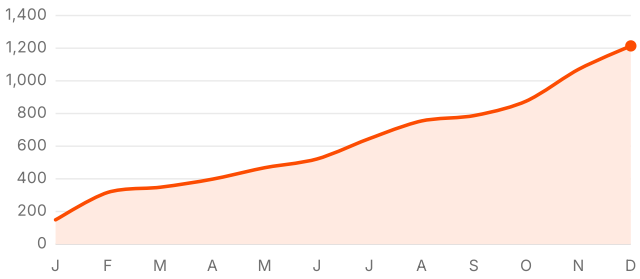
26
outings in an average month

101 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Walks led 2024.

Walks led the year, 125 of my 309 outings, against 88 runs and 15 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance and the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 138 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

40%
walks

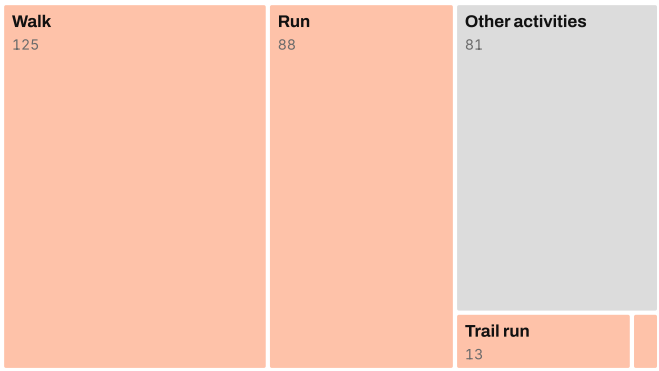
28%
runs

5%
trail runs and hikes

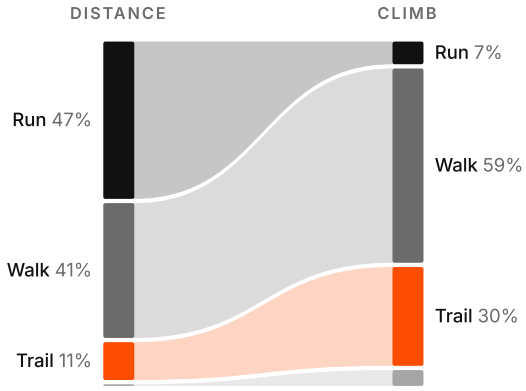
26%
other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

74% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2024, and 5pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest. 33% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

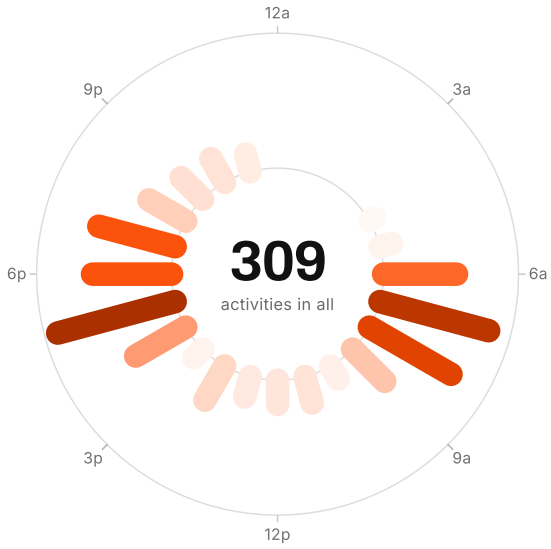
37%
before 10am

15%
between 10am and 4pm

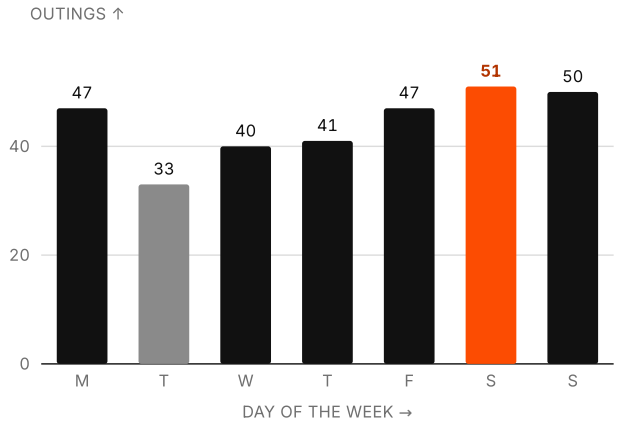
40%
between 4 and 9pm

8%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 64% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 31 Oct to 31 Dec. My longest break ended on 14 Sep.

THE DAYS OF 2024

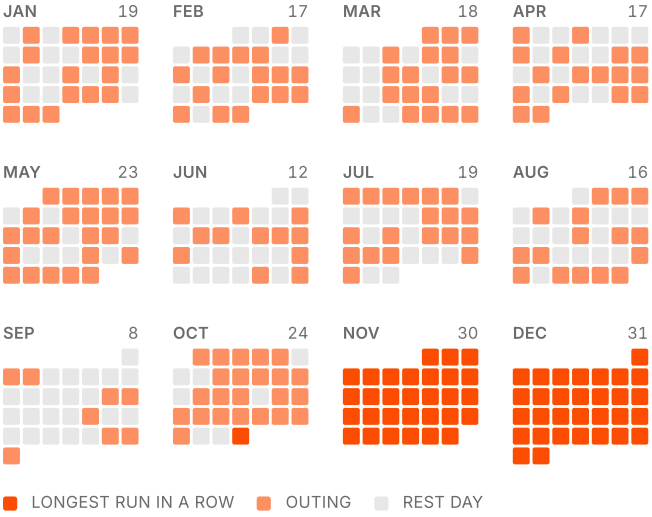
234 days
with an outing, of 366

62 days
the longest run in a row

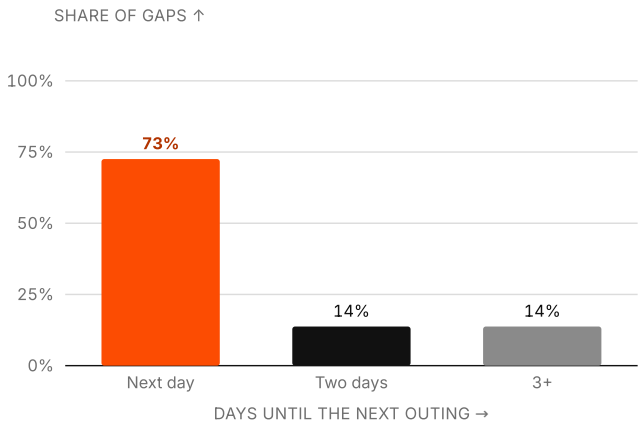
10 days
the longest break

73%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2024



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 1 km or 5 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in Jan 2024.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

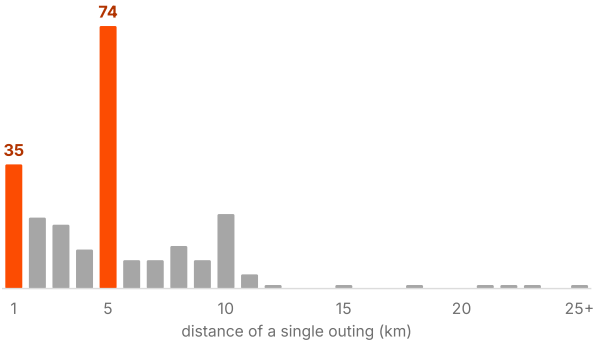
5.0 km
the middle outing

5.4 km
the average outing

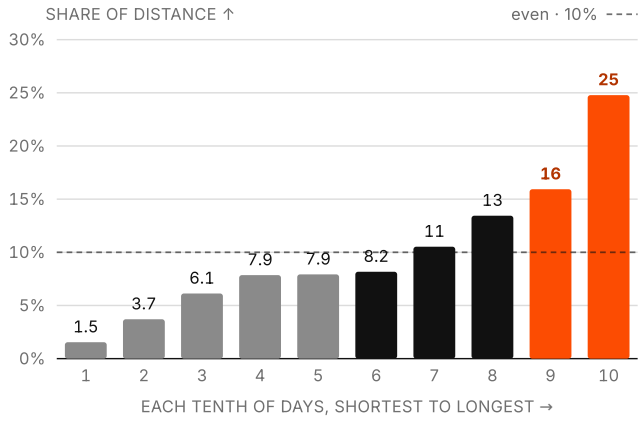
34.8 km
the longest

25%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a rest day, I usually rested again. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 58 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

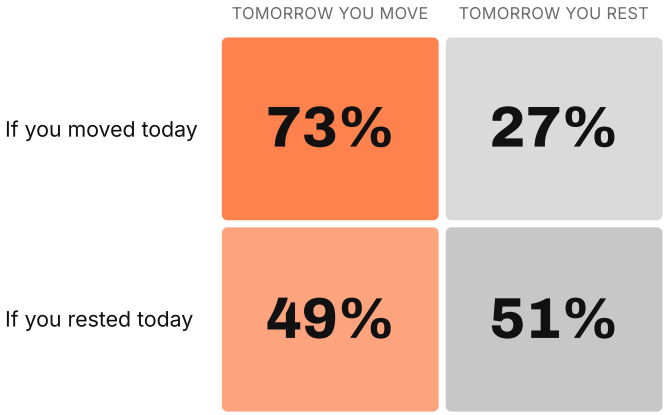
73%
went out again the day after a day out

49%
went out the day after a rest day

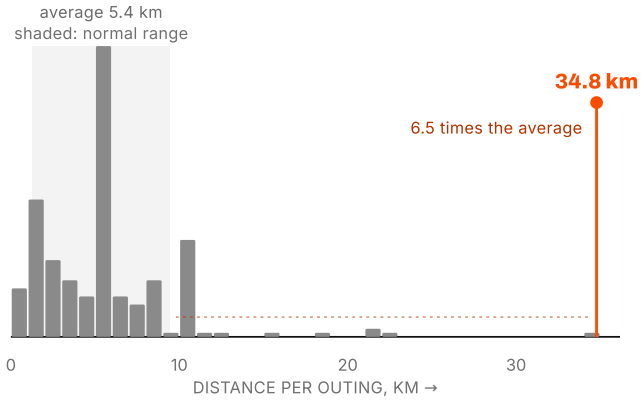
0.35
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

6.5×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



The biggest days of 2024.

FURTHEST ON FOOT
34.8 km
in a single outing
JAN 2024

LONGEST ON FOOT
7 h 41 min
of moving time in one outing
JAN 2024

MOST CLIMBED
841 m
of climb in one outing
JAN 2024

HARDEST EFFORT
387
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
JUL 2024

PERSONAL RECORDS
46
best times on Strava segments
2024

MOST CHEERED
90
kudos on one run
FEB 2024

EVERESTS
0.9×
the height of Everest, from 8,117 m climbed
2024

DAR TO DODOMA
2.7×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
1,214 KM ON FOOT

Across the border.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in South Africa, Kenya, Rwanda and Malawi, plus one outing I count as others. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

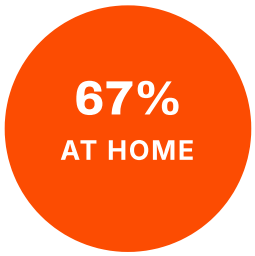
187
outings with a GPS start point

5
countries

7
regions of Tanzania

44%
of outings in Dodoma

HOME AGAINST AWAY

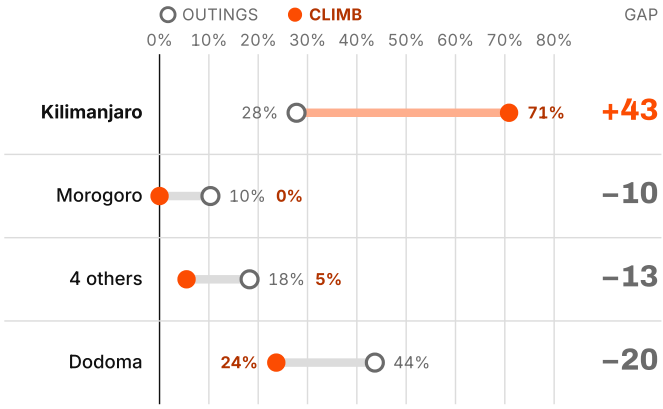


Tanzania · 126 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 61 OUTINGS

Malawi	23	2024
Kenya	22	2024
South Africa	13	2024
Rwanda	2	2024
Others	1	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



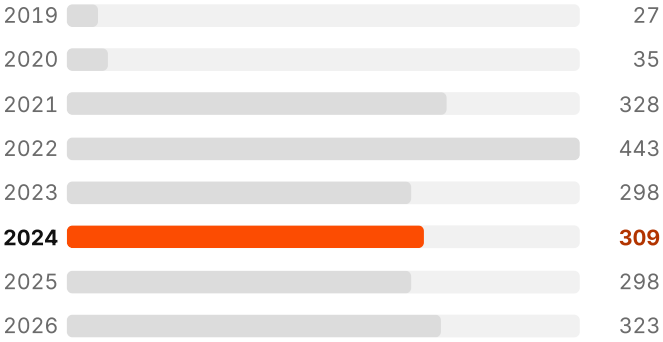
Fourth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes sixth, and for climbing fifth.

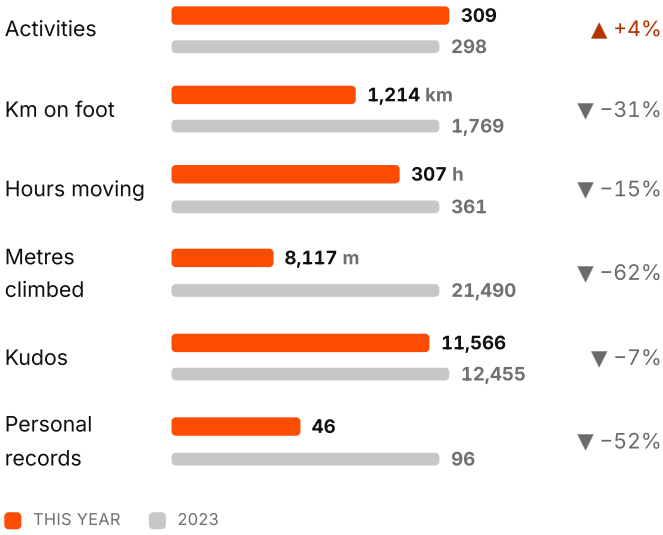
2024 AGAINST 2023

+4%	−31%	−62%	−52%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2024 BESIDE 2023



TRAVELLING

The map at its widest.

Most outings were at home in Tanzania. The rest were across the border.

Tanzania 126	Malawi 23	Kenya 22
South Africa 13	Rwanda 2	Others 1

2025

The year of walking.

Walking became my main thing. It was 47% of my outings, and in February I walked 30 km in one go, my longest walk. For the third year in a row I logged about three hundred activities.

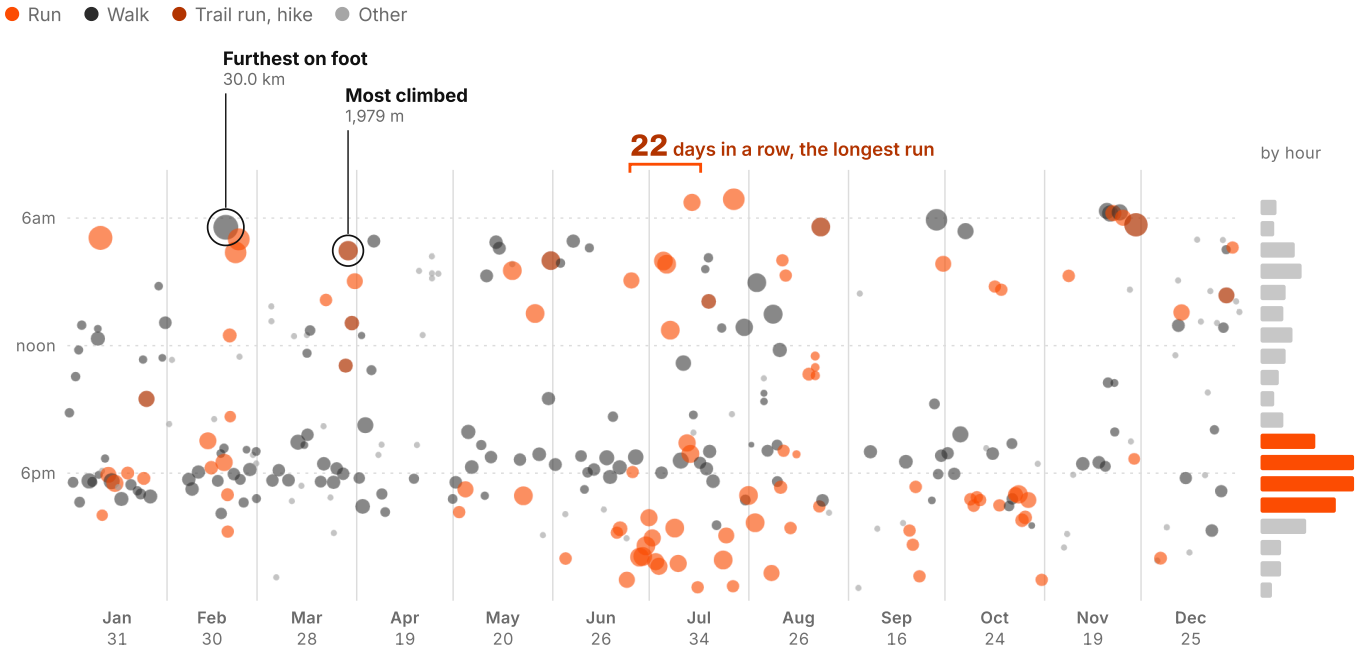
2025 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2024

298
outings, down 4%

1,609 km
on foot, up 33%

16,218 m
climbed, up 100%

379 h
moving, up 23%



July was the busiest.

July was my biggest month for distance too, with 299 km on foot. The months stayed fairly even from start to end. There was no empty month.

2025 BY THE MONTH

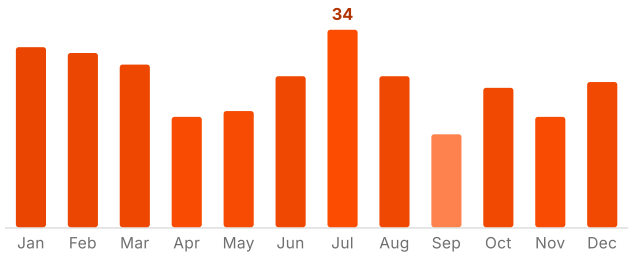
34
outings in July

16
in September, the quietest

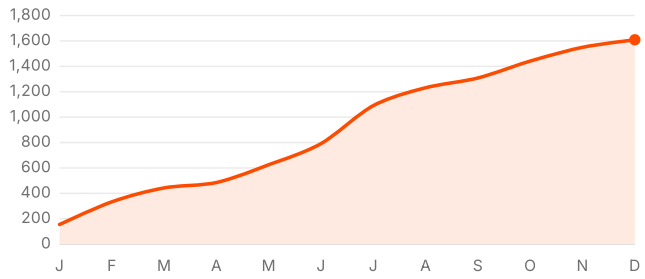
25
outings in an average month

134 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Walks led 2025.

Walks led the year, 141 of my 298 outings, against 87 runs and 9 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance and the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 69 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

47%
walks

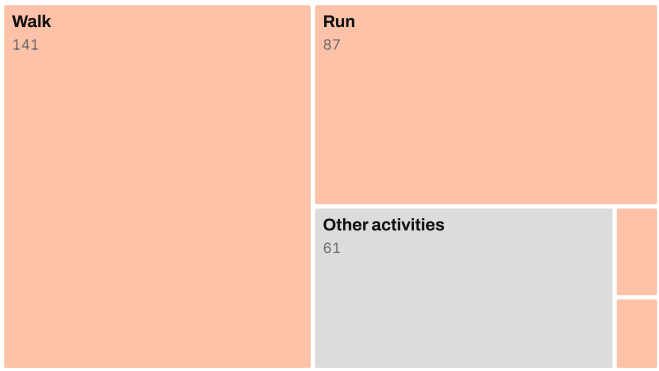
29%
runs

3%
trail runs and hikes

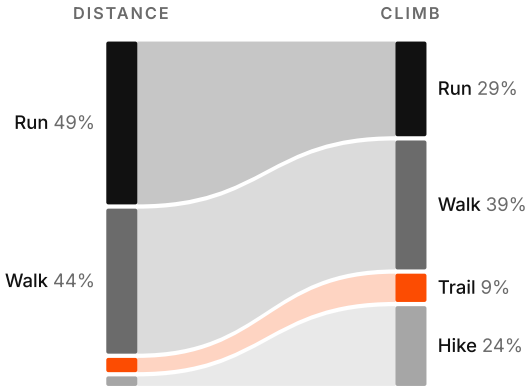
20%
other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

80% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2025, and 5pm was the busiest hour. Friday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest. 29% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

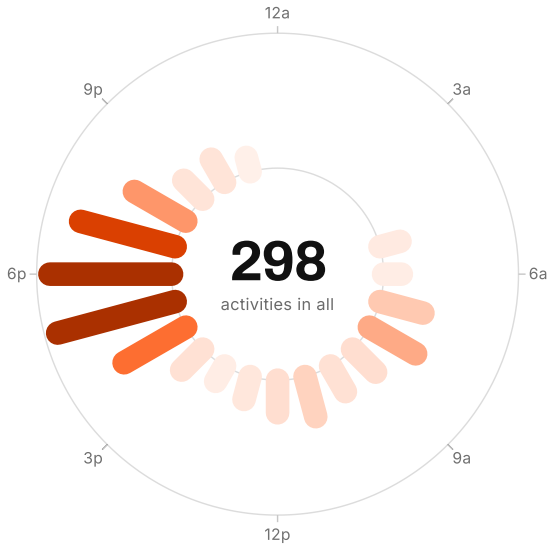
19% before 10am

20% between 10am and 4pm

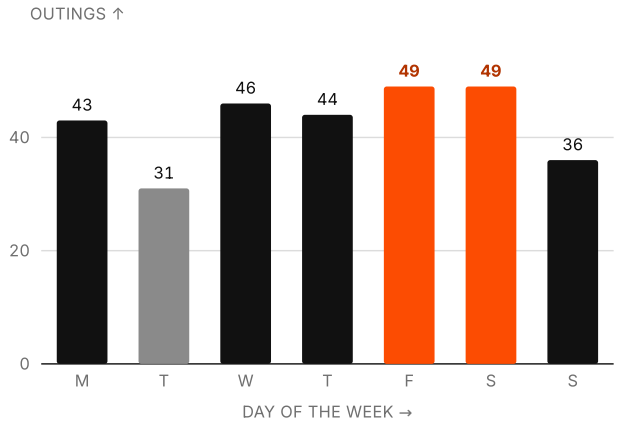
53% between 4 and 9pm

8% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Out on 66% of days.

My longest run of days in a row went from 25 Jun to 16 Jul. My longest break ended on 18 Apr.

THE DAYS OF 2025

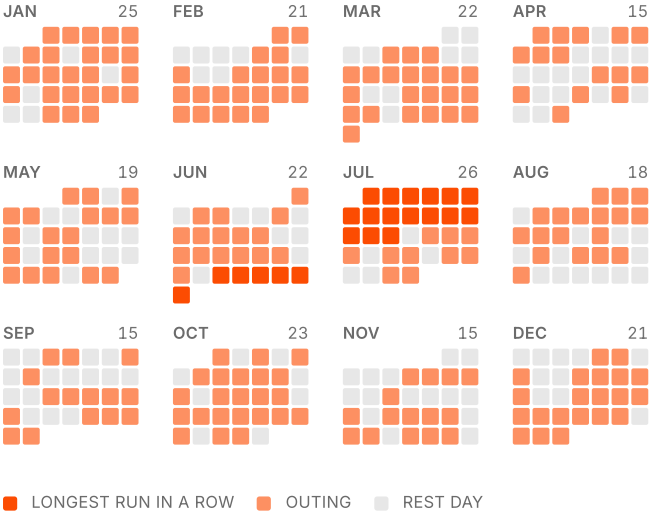
242 days
with an outing, of 365

22 days
the longest run in a row

8 days
the longest break

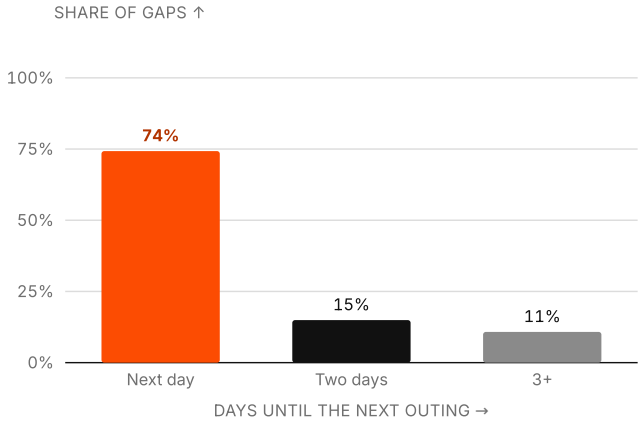
74%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2025



LONGEST RUN IN A ROW · OUTING · REST DAY

HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 2 km or 5 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in Feb 2025.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

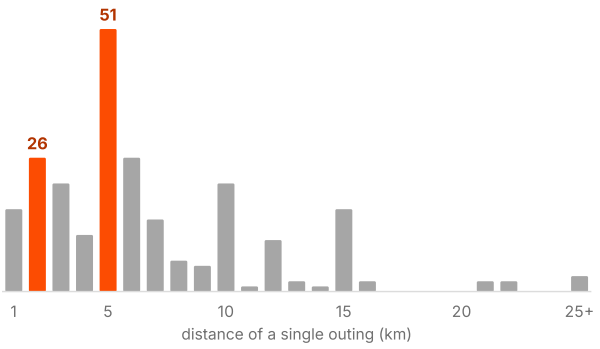
5.3 km
the middle outing

6.8 km
the average outing

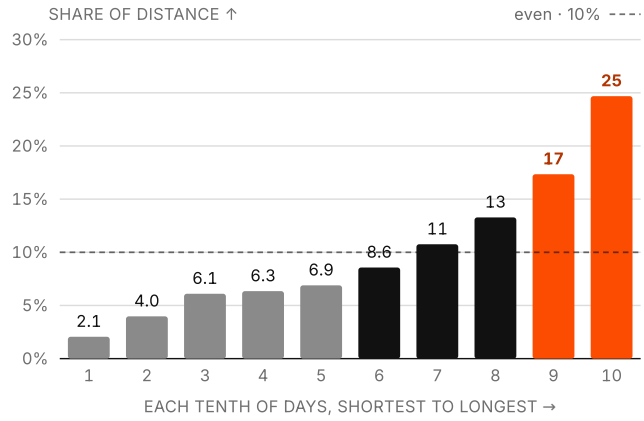
30.0 km
the longest

25%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a rest day, it could go either way. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 123 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

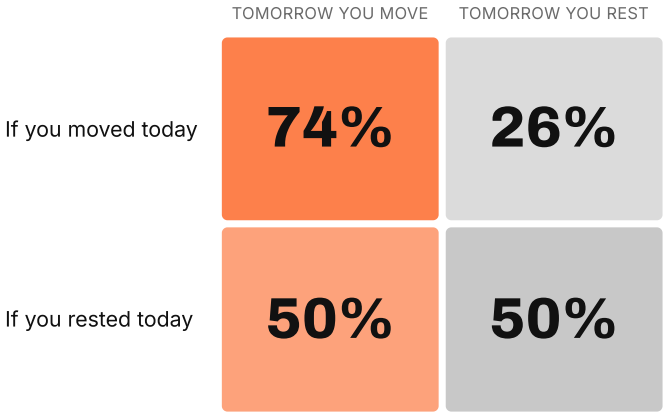
74%
went out again the day after a day out

50%
went out the day after a rest day

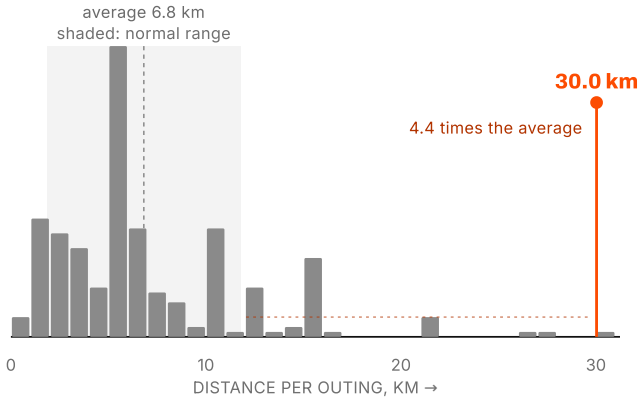
0.36
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

4.4×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



The biggest days of 2025.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

30.0 km

in a single outing

FEB 2025

LONGEST ON FOOT

10 h 59 min

of moving time in one outing

NOV 2025

MOST CLIMBED

1,979 m

of climb in one outing

MAR 2025

HARDEST EFFORT

211

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

NOV 2025

PERSONAL RECORDS

48

best times on Strava segments

2025

MOST CHEERED

96

kudos on one run

FEB 2025

EVERESTS

1.8×

the height of Everest, from 16,218 m climbed

2025

DAR TO DODOMA

3.6×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

1,609 KM ON FOOT

Mostly at home.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in Kenya, plus one outing I count as others. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

192
outings with a GPS start point

2
countries

12
regions of Tanzania

34%
of outings in Kilimanjaro

HOME AGAINST AWAY

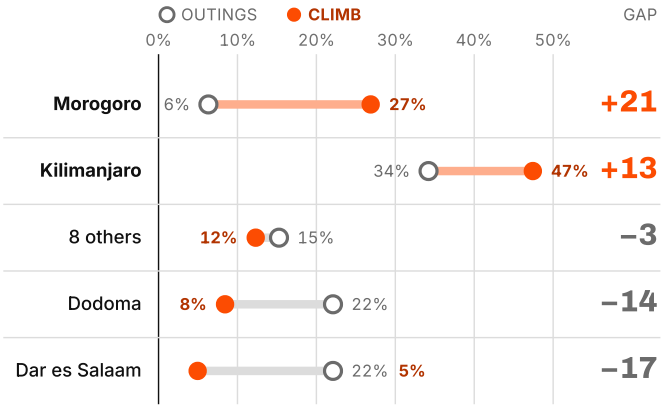


Tanzania · 190 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 2 OUTINGS



INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



Fifth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes fifth, and for climbing third.

2025 AGAINST 2024

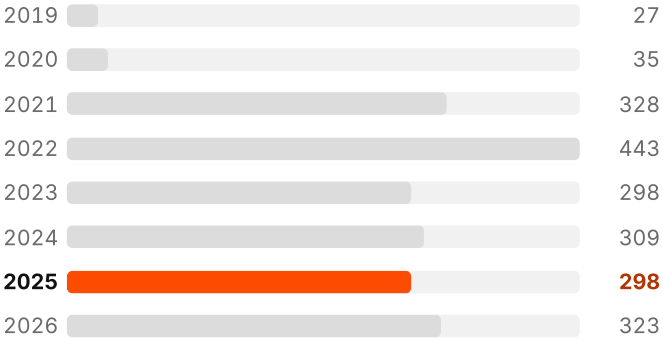
−4%
outings

+33%
distance on foot

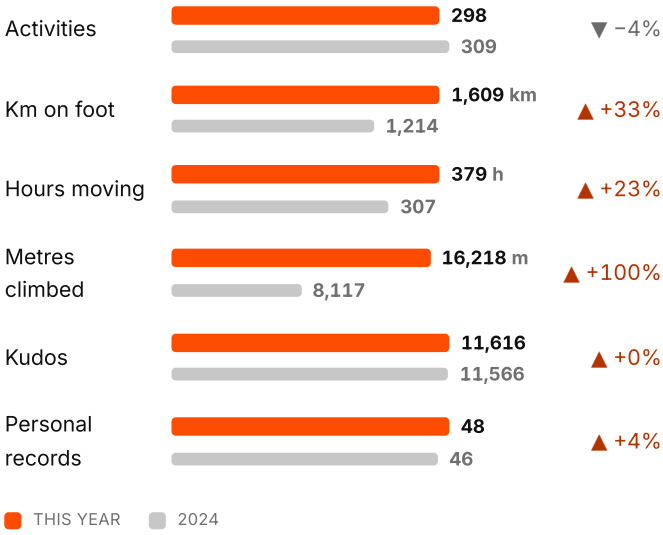
+100%
metres climbed

+4%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2025 BESIDE 2024



THE HIGHEST POINT

My biggest climb.

One hike that year climbed more than any other single outing I have done.

1,979
METRES IN A DAY

16,218
METRES IN THE YEAR

2026 still running

Every day so far.

Going every day has made it simpler. I have not missed a day this year, and in August my fiftieth trip to Ras Kilomoni was also my 2,000th outing. The year is not over yet. I am thankful the body has carried me this far.

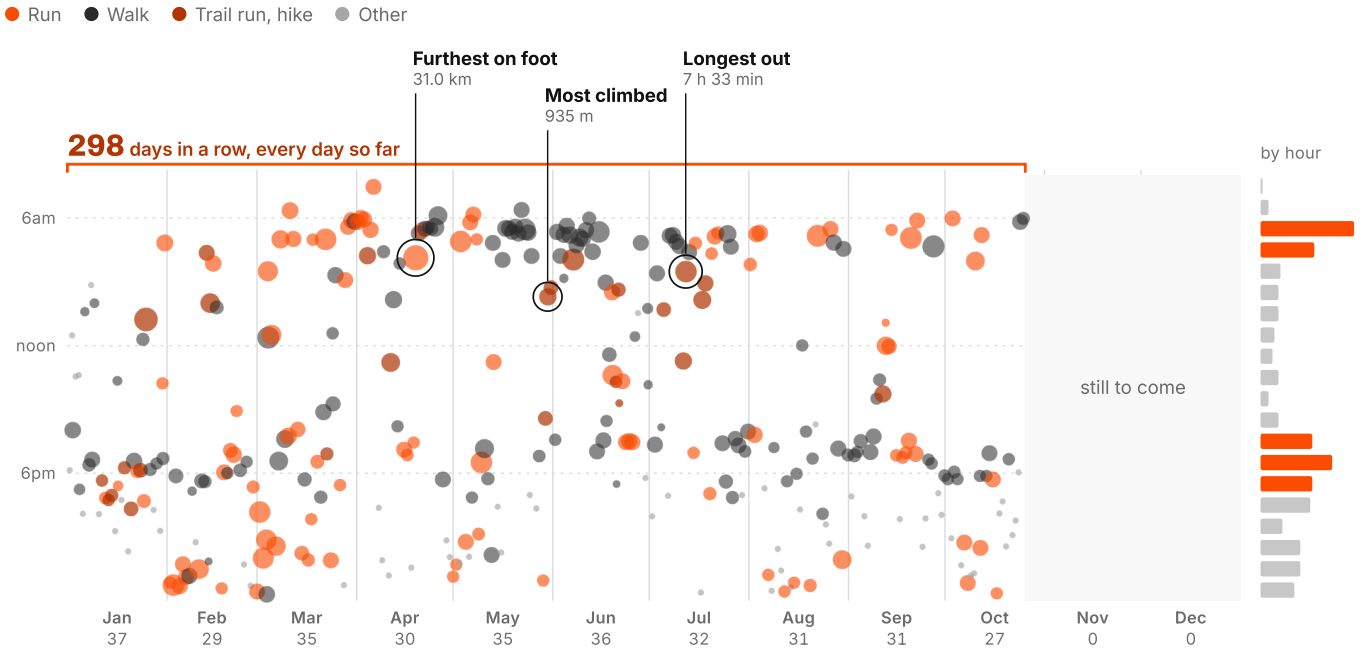
2026 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2025

323
outings, up 8%

2,430 km
on foot, up 51%

19,248 m
climbed, up 19%

527 h
moving, up 39%



January was the busiest.

The most distance came in March, with 393 km on foot. The months stayed fairly even from start to end. There was no empty month. October is not finished yet.

2026 BY THE MONTH

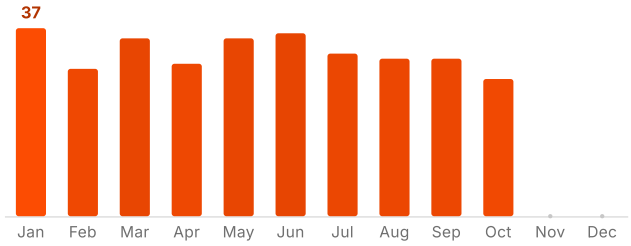
37
outings in January

27
in October, the quietest

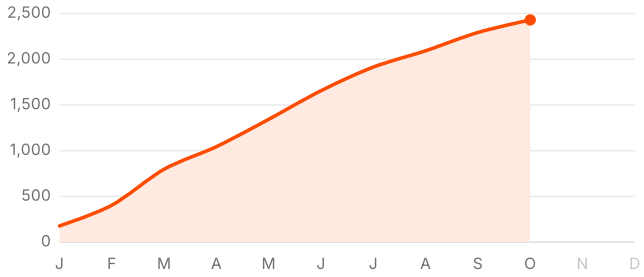
32
outings in an average month

243 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



Walks led 2026.

Walks led the year, 132 of my 323 outings so far, against 105 runs and 25 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance, and trail running gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 267 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

41%
walks

33%
runs

8%
trail runs and hikes

19%
other activities

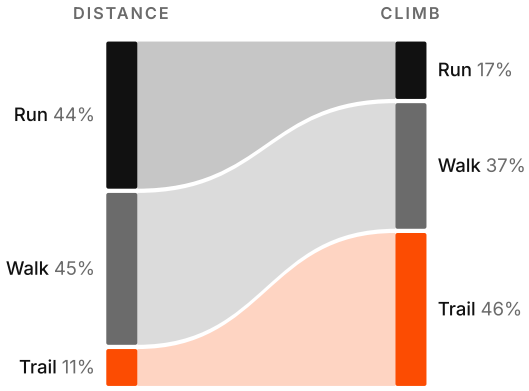
EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

81% of all my outings are on foot.



ON FOOT EVERYTHING ELSE

DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2026, though the single busiest hour was 6am. Friday was my busiest day and Monday the quietest, but not by much. 30% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

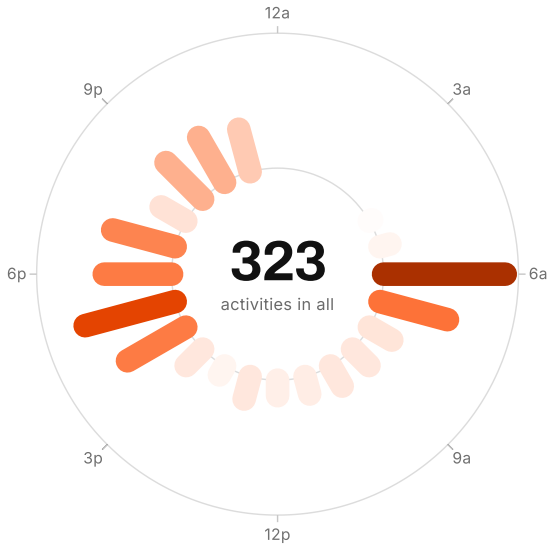
30%
before 10am

14%
between 10am and 4pm

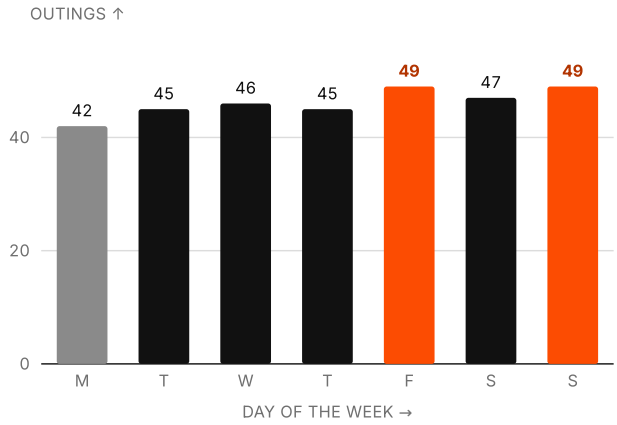
38%
between 4 and 9pm

18%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



Not one day missed so far.

Not one day was skipped. Some days it was only something small, but it was something, and the days add up when none of them is skipped.

THE DAYS OF 2026

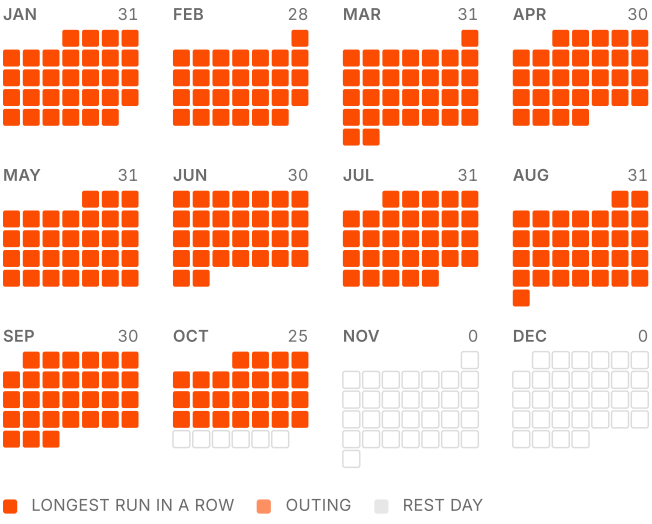
298 days
with an outing, of 298

298 days
the longest run in a row

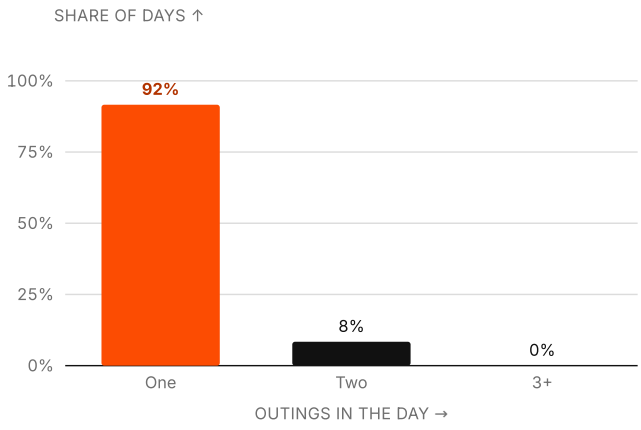
0 days
the longest break

8%
of days held two outings or more

EVERY DAY OF 2026



HOW MANY OUTINGS EACH DAY HELD



The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in Apr 2026.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

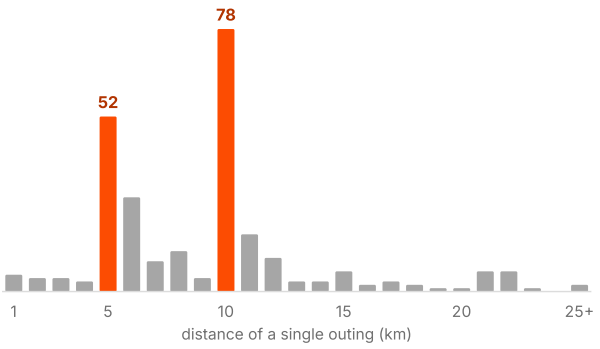
10.0 km
the middle outing

9.3 km
the average outing

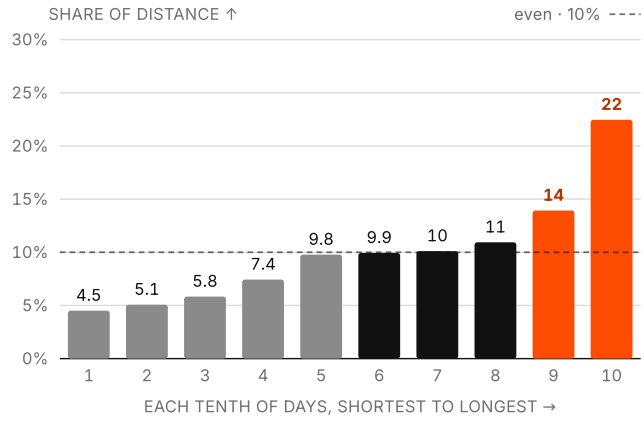
31.0 km
the longest

22%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



6 · HOW STEADY IT WAS

No rest day in 2026 so far.

My weeks were fairly steady. My biggest week was 153 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN FOUR NUMBERS

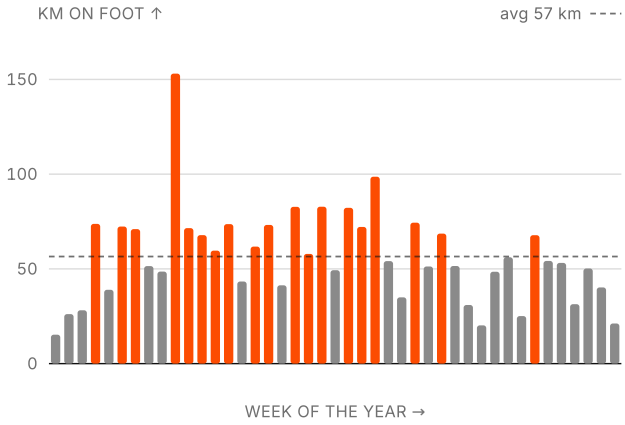
100%
went out again the day after a day out

57 km
in an average week

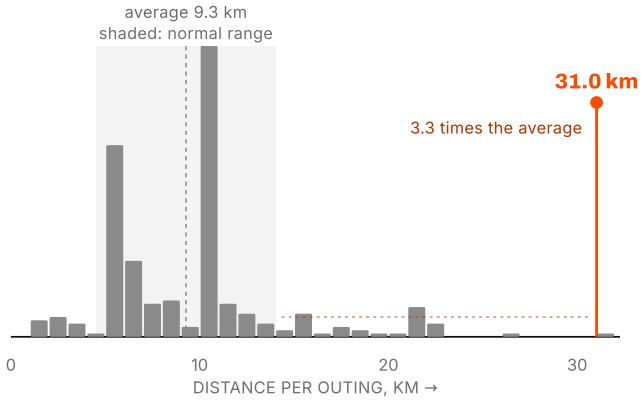
0.27
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.3×
my longest outing against the average one

DISTANCE ON FOOT, WEEK BY WEEK



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



7 · BIGGEST DAYS

The biggest days of 2026.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

31.0 km
in a single outing
APR 2026

LONGEST ON FOOT

7 h 33 min
of moving time in one outing
JUL 2026

MOST CLIMBED

935 m
of climb in one outing
MAY 2026

HARDEST EFFORT

729
relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was
MAR 2026

PERSONAL RECORDS

121
best times on Strava segments
2026

MOST CHEERED

94
kudos on one run
MAR 2026

EVERESTS

2.2×
the height of Everest, from 19,248 m climbed
2026

DAR TO DODOMA

5.4×
the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot
2,430 KM ON FOOT

Mostly at home.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in Kenya, plus one outing I count as others. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

212
outings with a GPS start point

2
countries

11
regions of Tanzania

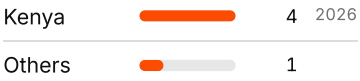
52%
of outings in Dar es Salaam

HOME AGAINST AWAY

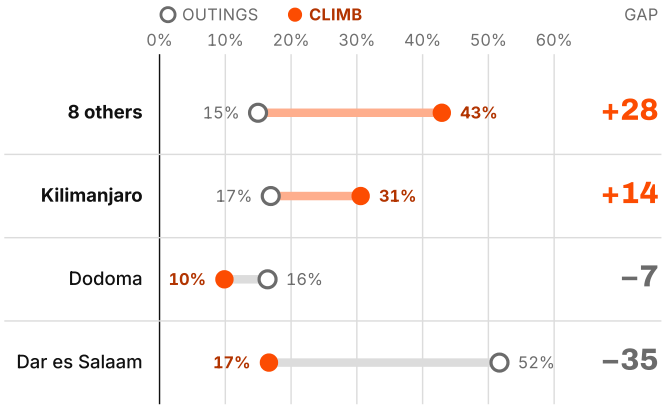


Tanzania · 207 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 5 OUTINGS



INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



Third of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes third, and for climbing second, and it is not finished yet.

2026 AGAINST 2025

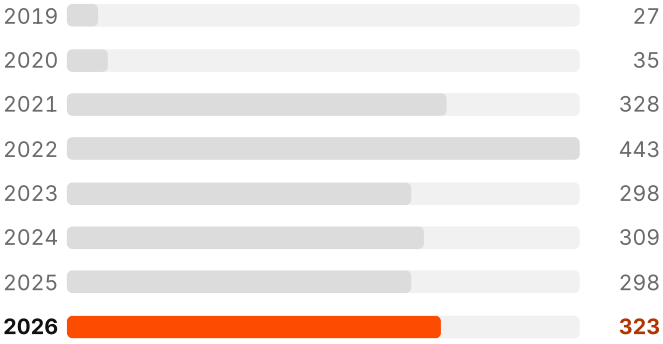
+8%
outings

+51%
distance on foot

+19%
metres climbed

+152%
personal records

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



2026 BESIDE 2025



EVERY DAY

One day at a time.

Every day of the year so far, at home and away.

298
DAYS IN A ROW

527
HOURS MOVING

III

The work

My sports on foot, the records I set and the places I went.

03 **Sports** 04 **Records** 05 **Where**

CHAPTER 3

03 Sports

My four sports on foot

THE WHOLE PICTURE

Runs cover the ground.

The treadmill is almost its own sport for me. It is flat, quick and always the same. My very first outing on foot was a treadmill run of 5.1 km, and since then 122 more of my treadmill runs have ended within 100 m of 5 km. So on this page I keep it apart, and in the chart below it sits alone on the left.

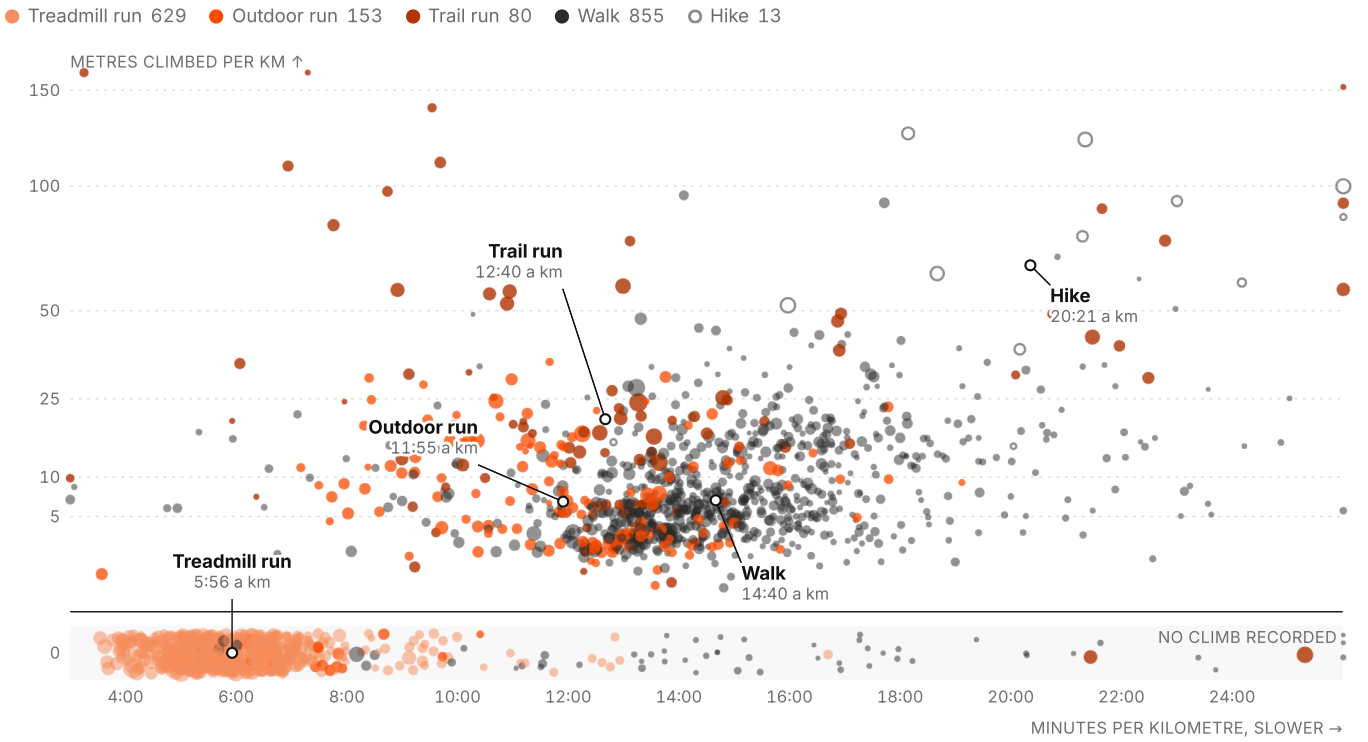
THE FOUR SPORTS ON FOOT

1,730
outings on foot, of 2,061 in all

13,237 km
covered on foot

84,367 m
climbed on foot

2,105 h
moving on foot



Walks took more hours.

Each sport does its own job. Runs and walks share my time almost equally, and a run takes me further, about 10.1 km against 4.0 km. The hills belong to the few trail runs and hikes: one hike in Morogoro climbed as much as all my running climbs in a whole year.

EACH SPORT'S BIGGEST SHARE

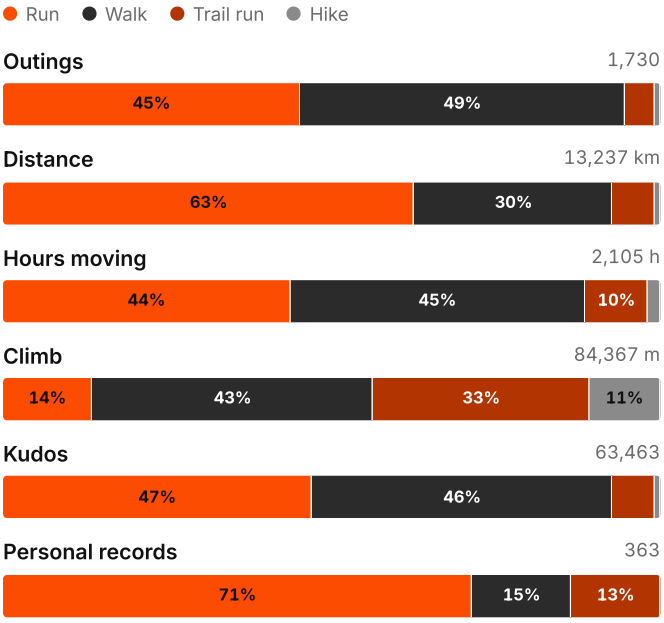
63%
of the distance was run

45%
of the hours were walked

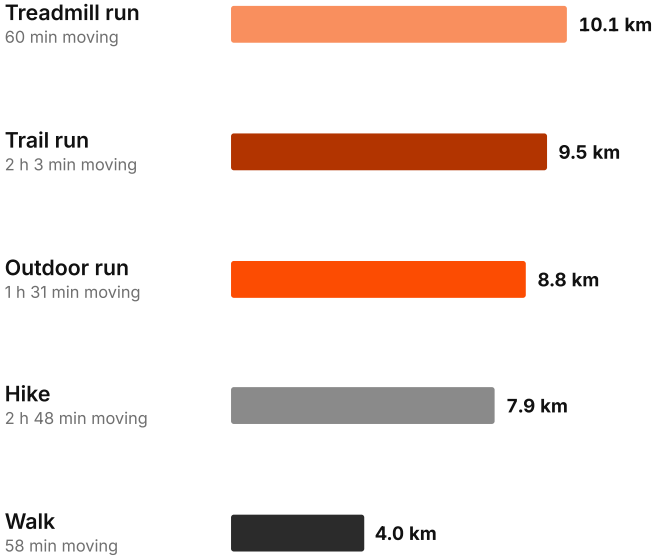
33%
of the climb came on trail runs

11%
of the climb came on 13 hikes

EACH SPORT'S SHARE OF THE RECORD



THE TYPICAL OUTING OF EACH



In 2026, walks went further.

Walking took over slowly, little by little, year after year. In 2021 I walked only 473 km against more than 2,000 km of running. This year my walking passed my running two days into January, and it never fell behind again. Trail running came in from the end of 2021, when I started going to the hills.

2026 SO FAR, AGAINST THE RUNNING PEAK

1,099 km
walked in 2026 so far

1,065 km
run in 2026 so far

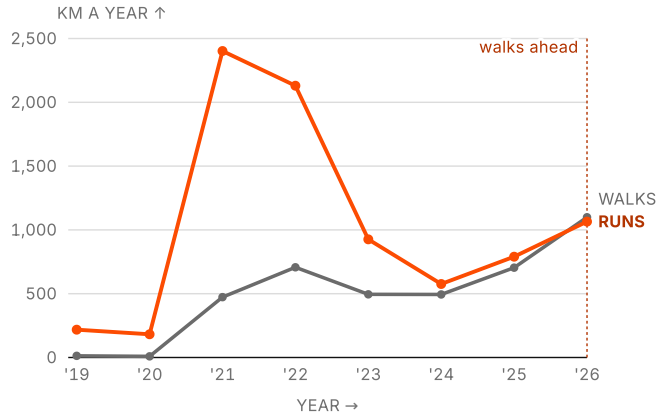
2,402 km
run in 2021

303 km
on trails in 2023, the trail peak

KILOMETRES ON FOOT, YEAR BY YEAR



WALKING AGAINST RUNNING



83% of running was indoors.

More of my running is outside every year. My treadmill years peaked with a full marathon in one room, 42.7 km. Since then the share outside has grown, and in 2026, for the first time, more than half of my running was on the roads and trails. The treadmill still shows in my habits: I tend to stop when the screen shows a round number.

RUNNING INDOORS

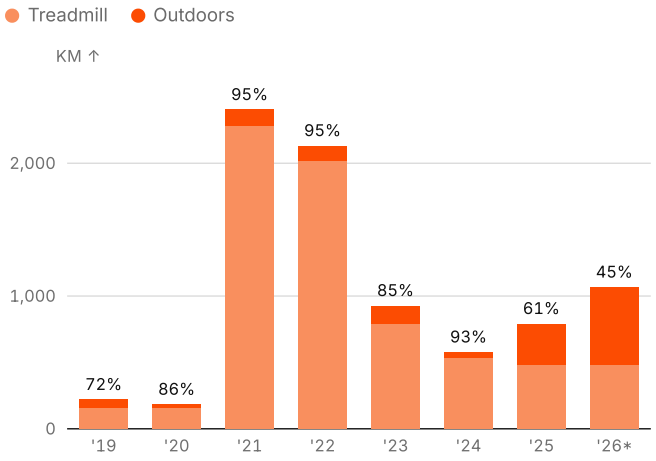
629
treadmill runs

95%
of running km indoors in 2021

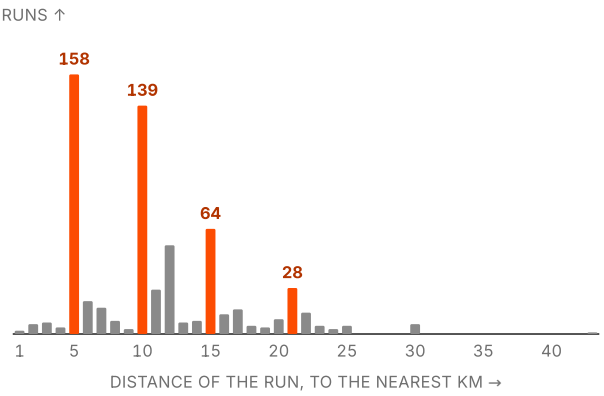
45%
indoors in 2026 so far

45%
of treadmill runs stopped on a whole 5 km

RUNNING KILOMETRES, INDOORS AND OUT



WHERE THE TREADMILL STOPPED



Each sport has its pace.

The treadmill makes me look faster than I am. On it my usual kilometre takes under six minutes. When I ran the Kilimanjaro Half in 2026, each kilometre took me about ten minutes of moving time, closer to my walking pace than to my treadmill pace. Pace here is the minutes I take for one kilometre.

MEDIAN MINUTES PER KILOMETRE

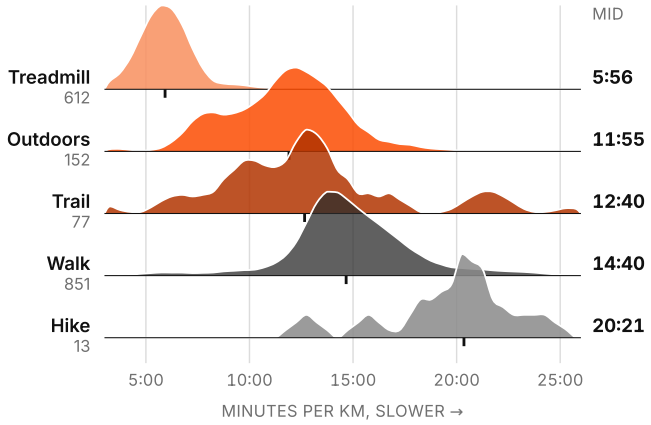
5.9 min
a treadmill km

11.9 min
an outdoor run km

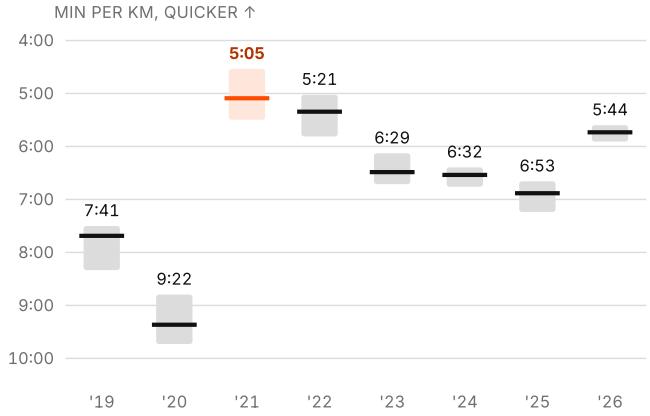
14.7 min
a walking km

20.4 min
a hiking km

EVERY OUTING BY PACE



TREADMILL PACE, YEAR BY YEAR



The typical walk grew.

My walks got longer. From 2021 to 2024, about half of them were short, under 3 km. In 2025 that started to change, and now almost every walk is a proper outing of many kilometres. In September 2026 I walked 22.8 km on a Sunday in Dar es Salaam, and it felt like an ordinary weekend walk.

THE WALK, 2021 AGAINST 2026

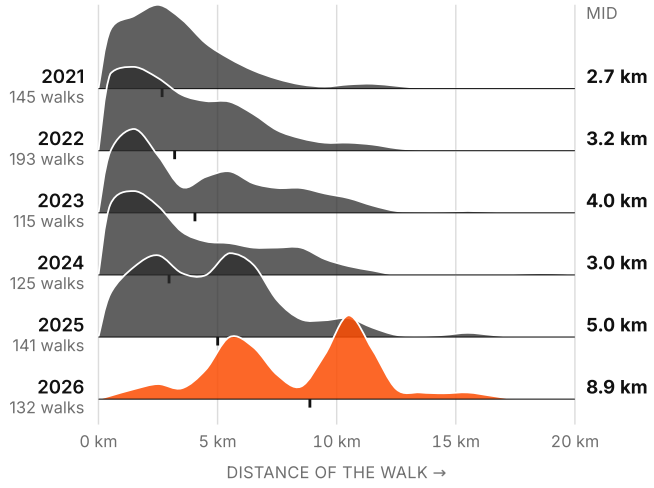
2.7 km
the median walk of 2021

8.9 km
the median walk of 2026 so far

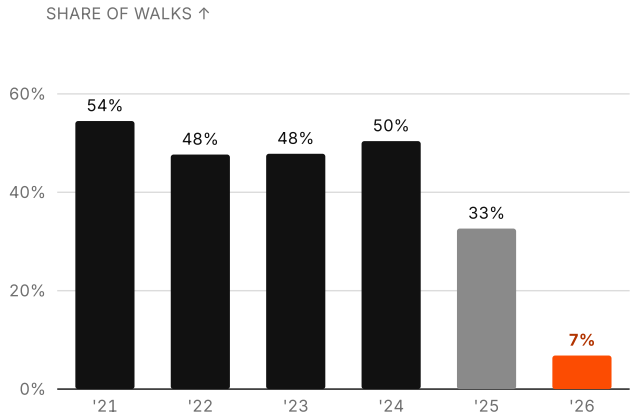
54%
of 2021 walks under 3 km

7%
of 2026 walks under 3 km

EVERY WALK BY DISTANCE, YEAR BY YEAR



SHARE OF WALKS UNDER 3 KM



Long days moved outdoors.

Long days used to mean the treadmill. Before my first half marathon outside, 22.7 km on the trails of Morogoro in 2023, every long day in my log had been indoors. Now most of them are outside, on roads, trails and long walks. Only the marathon, run indoors in 2022, is still longer than any of them.

HALF MARATHON OR LONGER

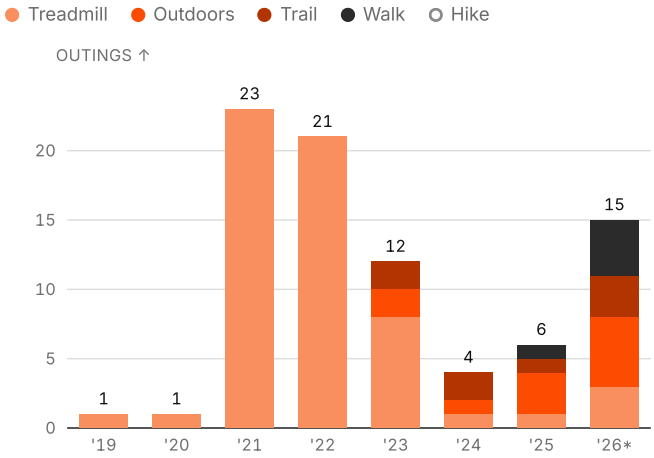
83
outings of 21.1 km or more

71%
of them on a treadmill

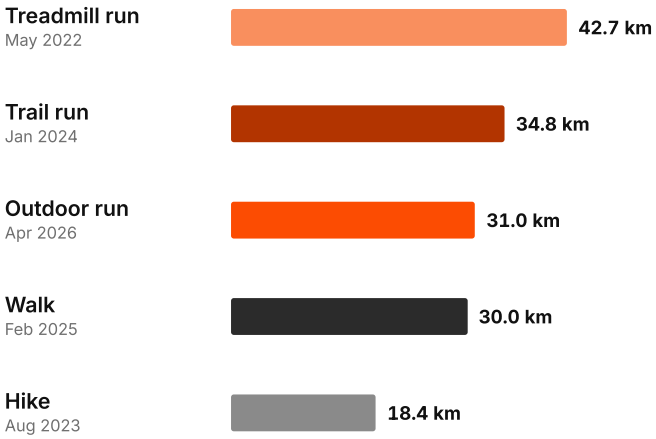
15
in 2026 so far

12
of those 15 outside

OUTINGS OF 21.1 KM OR MORE, YEAR BY YEAR



THE LONGEST OF EACH



Hikes climb the most.

Climbing is slow work for me, and it happens on foot. My 629 treadmill runs together climbed nothing at all, and one hike in Morogoro climbed almost 2,000 m in 16 km. Between those two are my walks, which with 30% of my distance did 43% of my climbing.

METRES CLIMBED FOR EACH KILOMETRE

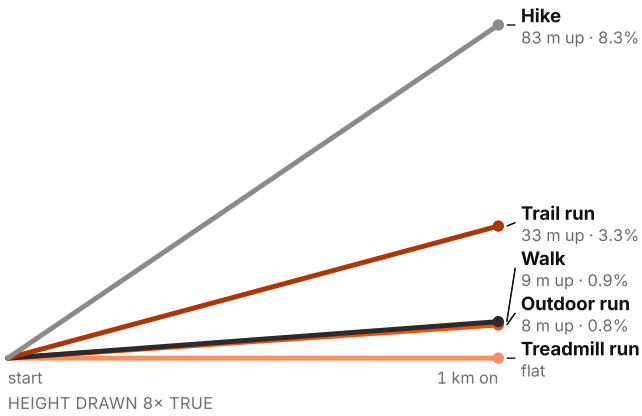
83 m
per km on a hike

33 m
per km on a trail run

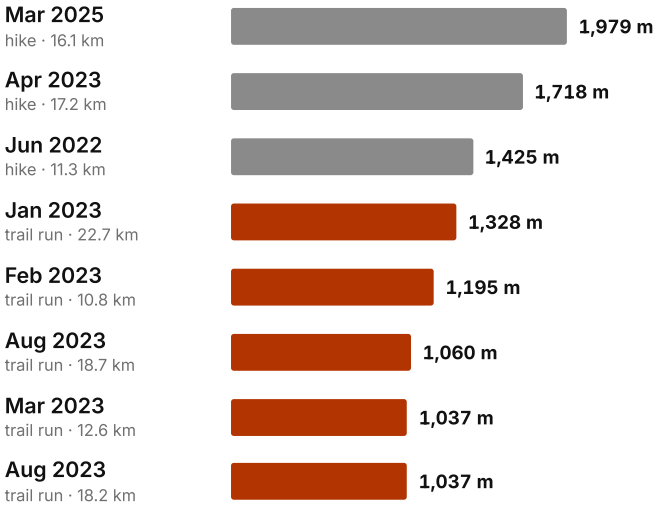
9 m
per km on a walk

1,979 m
my biggest single climb

IF EACH SPORT WERE A ROAD



THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS



I drew the slopes steeper than they really are.

Treadmill runs at night.

Each sport has found its own place in my day. The treadmill is busiest at 7am and again late in the evening. Walks come around 5pm, after the working day. Outdoor runs start early, around 6am, or in the late afternoon. Trail runs and hikes need a free day, so they wait for the weekend.

HOURS AND DAYS

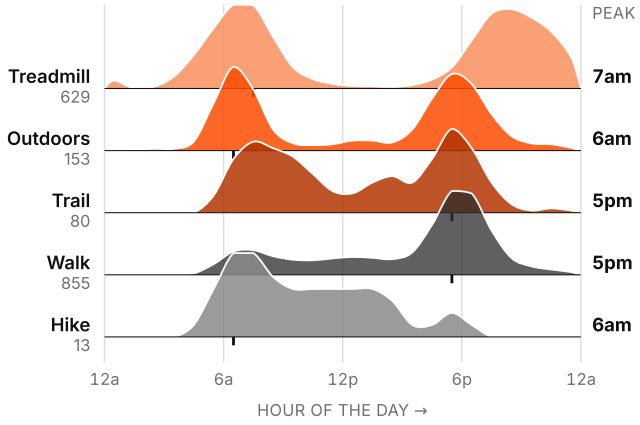
37%
of treadmill runs after 8pm or before 5am

48%
of walks between 4 and 7pm

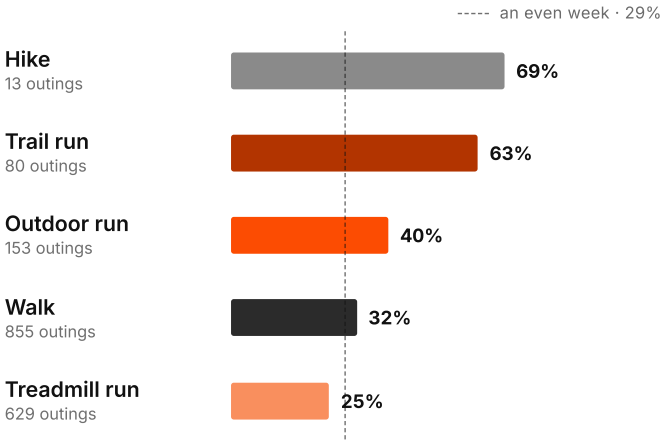
63%
of trail runs at the weekend

25%
of treadmill runs at the weekend

THE HOUR EACH OUTING STARTED



SHARE OF EACH ON A SATURDAY OR SUNDAY



A run and a walk, hours apart.

As the habit settled, I stopped splitting my days. In the early years I often did two things in one day, a run in the morning and a walk in the evening, and only 14 pairs were less than half an hour apart. Now one longer outing usually takes their place.

DAYS WITH BOTH

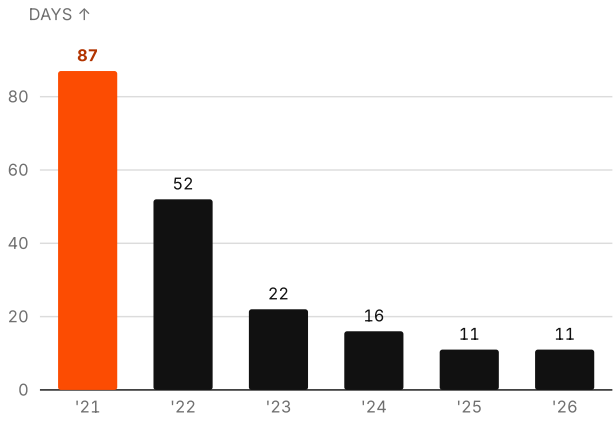
199 days
with a run and a walk

65%
of them with the run first

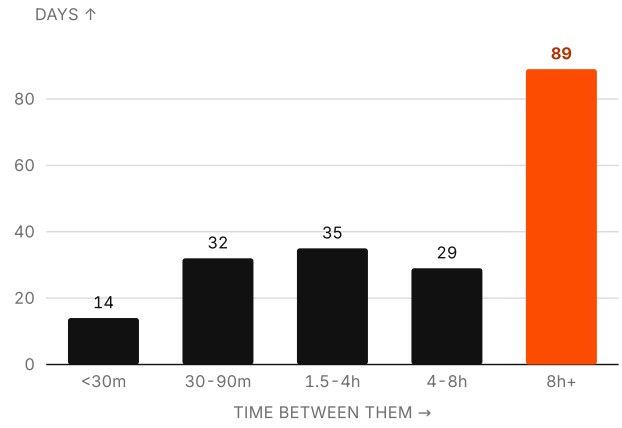
6.5 h
between them, the median

87 days
in 2021, the most

DAYS WITH A RUN AND A WALK, YEAR BY YEAR



TIME BETWEEN THE TWO



Treadmill runs work hardest.

What people cheer and what my heart feels are different things. The people who follow me cheer the trail runs most, and my most cheered outing is the Kilimanjaro Half of 2023, with 125 kudos. Per hour, my heart works hardest on the treadmill and least on a walk. Relative effort is Strava's score for how hard my heart worked.

EFFORT PER HOUR, KUDOS AND RECORDS PER OUTING

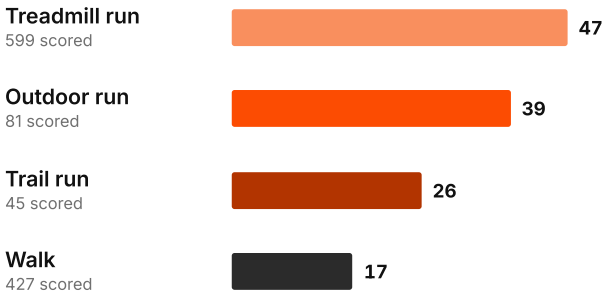
47
effort per hour, treadmill run

17
effort per hour, walk

51
kudos per trail run

1.5
personal records per outdoor run

RELATIVE EFFORT PER HOUR MOVING



KUDOS PER OUTING



Longer runs, quicker km.

Two small findings surprised me. On the treadmill, my longer runs were quicker per kilometre. My usual 5 km went at 6:28 a km and my usual 21 km at 5:18. And running and walking never fought for my time. A big running week did not mean less walking.

FOUR NUMBERS FROM THE FITS

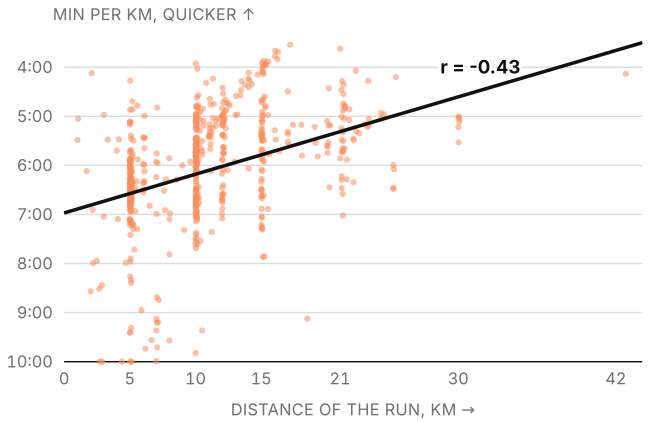
−0.43
treadmill distance against pace

5 s
quicker per km for each extra km

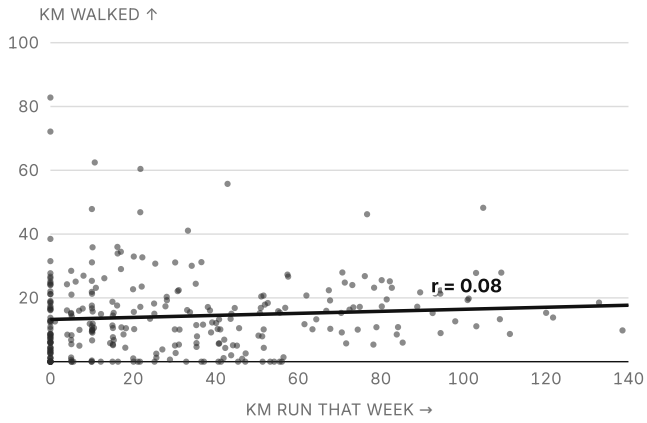
69 s
per km quicker at 21 km than at 5 km

0.08
weekly running km against walking km

TREADMILL RUNS: DISTANCE AGAINST PACE



EACH WEEK: KILOMETRES RUN AGAINST WALKED



Each sport's biggest day.

TREADMILL RUN

42.7 km

the longest, a marathon indoors

1 MAY 2022

OUTDOOR RUN

31.0 km

the longest on the road

19 APR 2026

TRAIL RUN

34.8 km

the longest, with 841 m of climb

13 JAN 2024

WALK

30.0 km

the longest, with 833 m of climb

19 FEB 2025

HIKE

1,979 m

climbed in 16.1 km, the most of any outing

29 MAR 2025

RUNNING STREAK

45 days

in a row with a run or trail run

31 OCT 2024 TO 14 DEC 2024

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“If you do it, you will feel better when it is over. If you do not, you will feel worse. So go do it.”

CHAPTER 4

04 Records

My longest, highest and hardest days

Only my own records, measured against myself.

THE DISTANCE RECORD

Against my own longest.

Records come quickly at the start, and then they slow down. In the early years the distance record moved again and again: 10 km on my second day, a half marathon a few months later, 30 km in August 2021. Then came the marathon on the treadmill, and nothing has beaten it since.

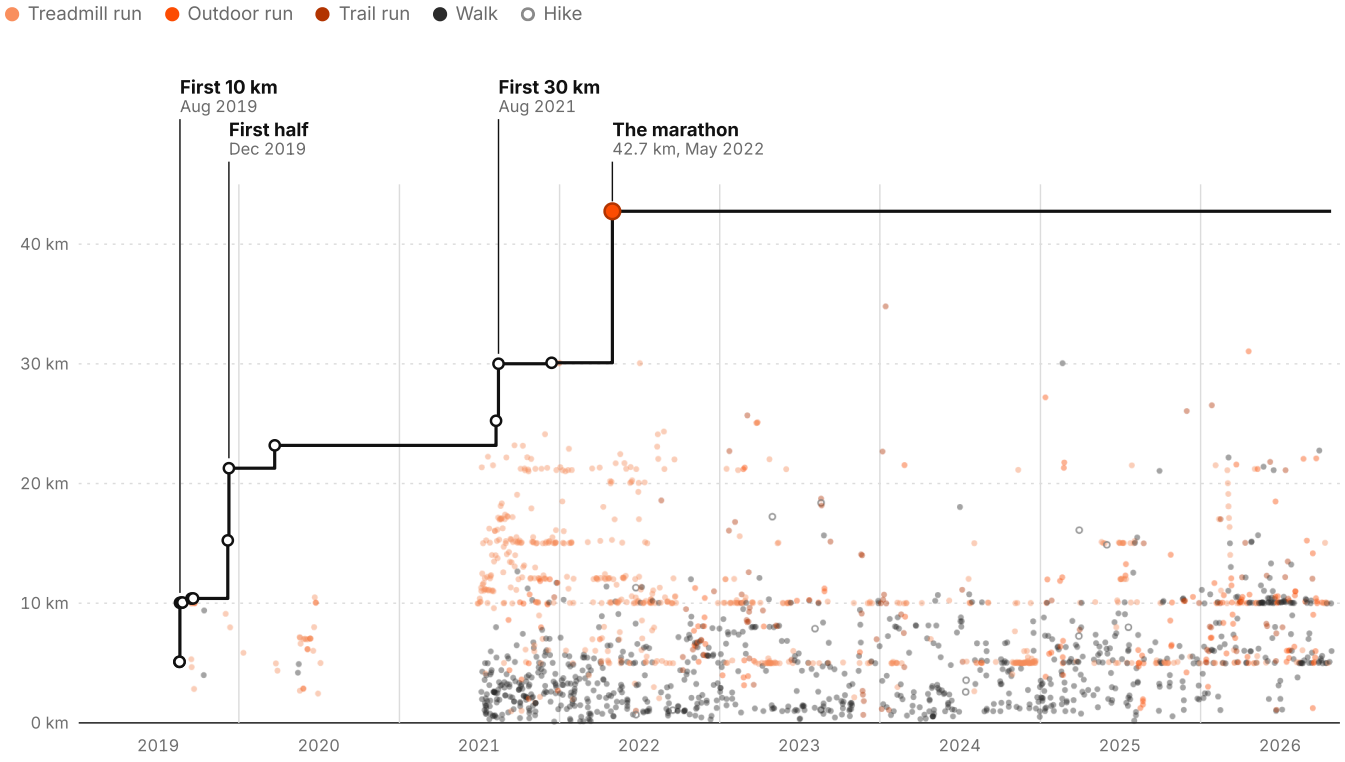
THE LONGEST OUTING ON FOOT

14
times the record broke

42.7 km
the record now

1,638 days
it has stood

1,218
outings since, none longer



The longest days.

My long days moved outside. All my runs past 30 km on the treadmill came between Aug 2021 and Jul 2022. Since then every long day has been outside, and the longest of them is 34.8 km on the trails of Kilimanjaro, with more than 800 m of climbing.

LONG OUTINGS ON FOOT

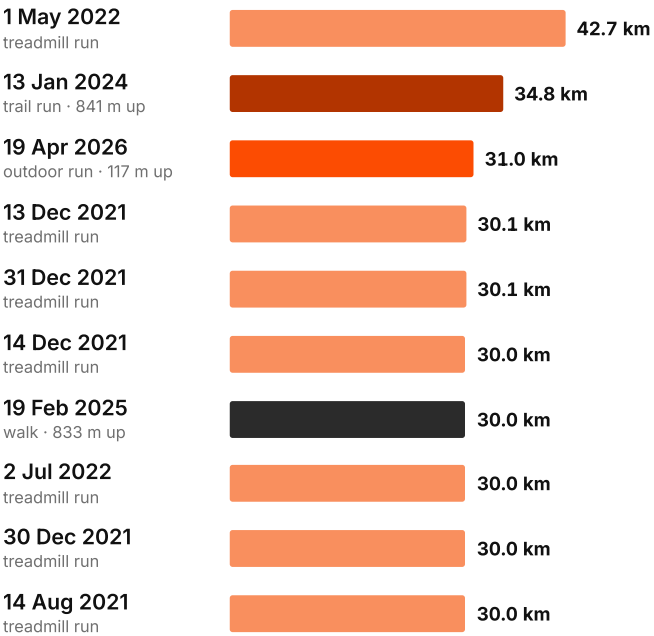
83
outings of 21.1 km or more

10
outings past 30 km

7
of those on a treadmill

30.0 km
the longest walk

THE TEN LONGEST OUTINGS



THE BIGGEST DAYS ON FOOT



From walks to hikes.

My climbing records needed bigger and bigger mountains. The first ten were all walks, and the biggest of them was only 665 m. After that the hikes took over, up to almost 2,000 m in one day in Morogoro.

THE BIGGEST CLIMB ON FOOT

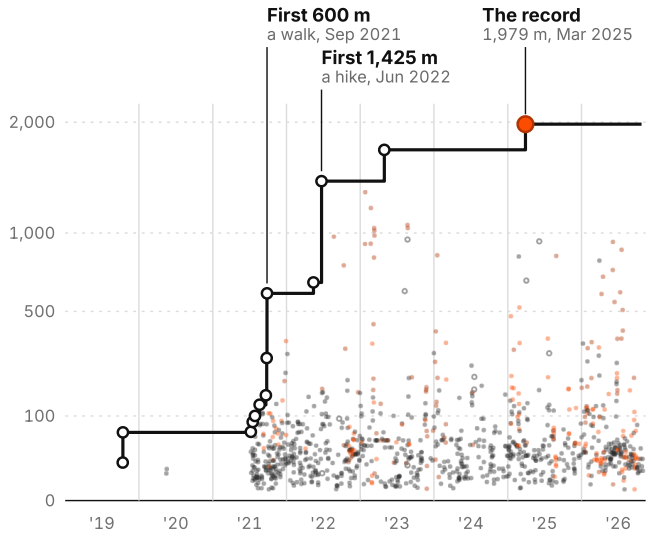
13
times the record broke

1,979 m
the record now

575 days
it has stood

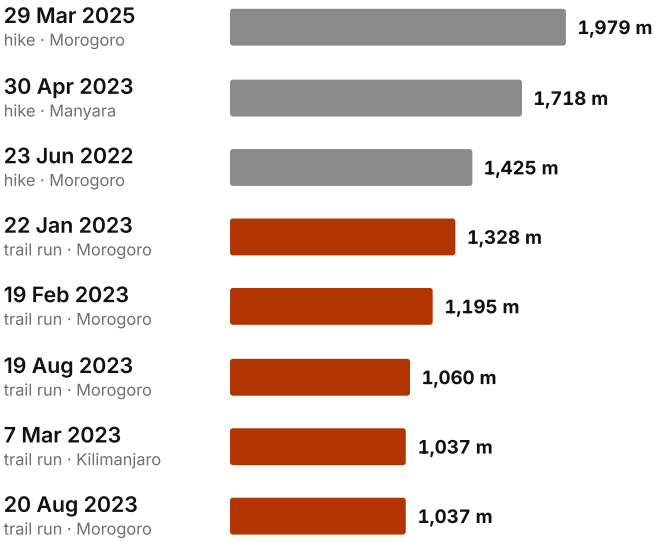
2,074 m
in one day, 19 Aug 2023

THE CLIMBING RECORD OVER TIME, IN METRES UP



The bottom of the scale is stretched so the small climbs show.

THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS



March 2023 climbed the most.

Distance and climbing came in different seasons of my life. In August 2021 I covered more than 550 km and climbed almost nothing, because most of it was on the treadmill. In March 2023 I climbed more than 5,000 m from less than 300 km on foot, most of it in Kilimanjaro.

THE BIGGEST STRETCHES

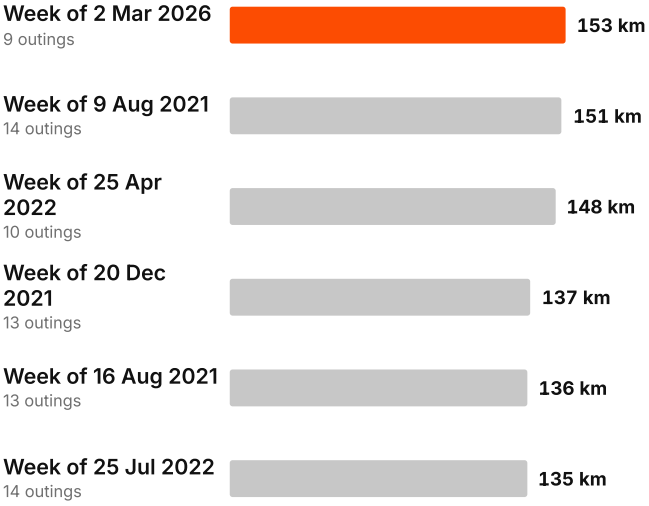
153 km
in the week of 2 Mar 2026

559 km
in August 2021

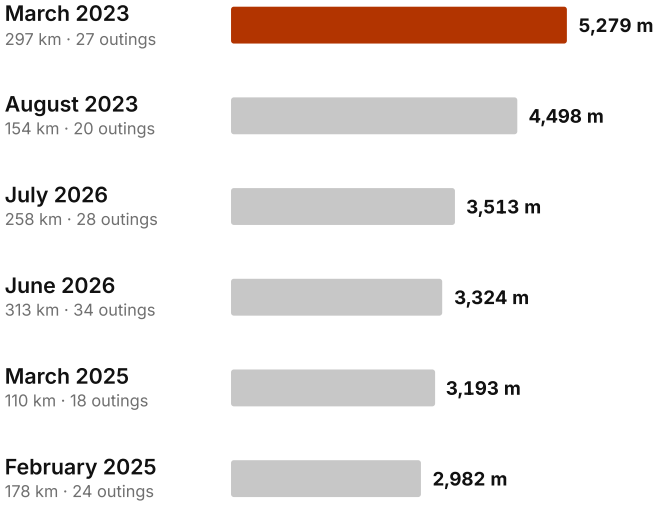
5,279 m
climbed in March 2023

60%
of an Everest in that month

THE BIGGEST WEEKS BY DISTANCE



THE BIGGEST MONTHS BY CLIMB



The kilometres came faster.

Pole pole ndio mwendo, slowly is the way. The kilometres come faster now than they used to. The first 1,000 km took me two years, with the long gap inside them. The last 2,500 km took about a year, and each Everest of climbing now comes much quicker than the first.

THE RUNNING TOTALS

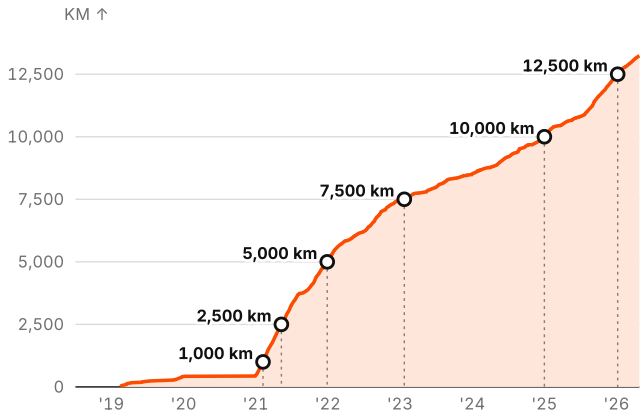
13,237 km
on foot in all

9.5
Everests climbed

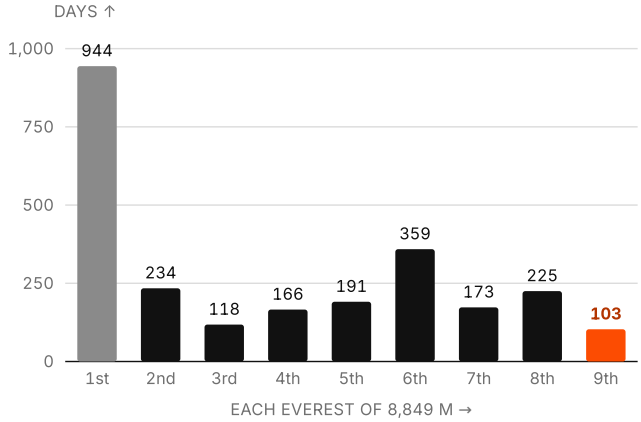
944 days
for the first Everest

103 days
for the ninth

KILOMETRES ON FOOT, ADDING UP



DAYS TO CLIMB EACH EVEREST



Beating my own times.

Personal records come from going back to the same road. The Kilimanjaro Half gave me 18 in one morning in 2023, and I matched that on the same course in 2025 and again in 2026. A personal record here means I beat my own earlier time on a Strava segment, a short timed stretch of road or trail. The treadmill gives almost none, because segments need GPS.

SEGMENT BESTS ON FOOT

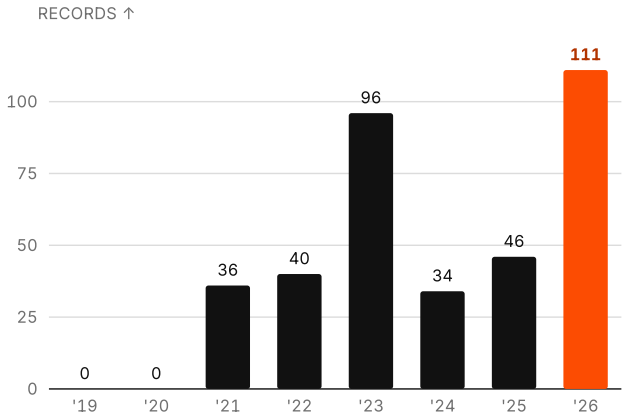
363
personal records in all

118
outings that set at least one

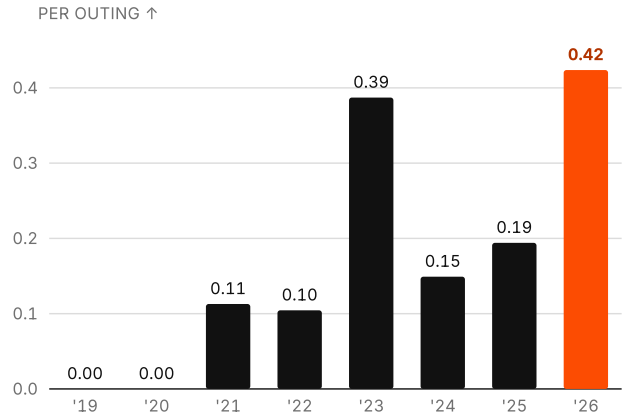
111
in 2026 so far

0.42
per outing in 2026

PERSONAL RECORDS, YEAR BY YEAR



PERSONAL RECORDS PER OUTING



Every day since Dec 2025.

I do not take the streaks for granted. Every week since September 2023 has had an outing, more than three years now. The other side of my record is the long gap, from July 2020 to June 2021, when I did not go out at all.

IN A ROW

301 days
with an outing, still going

162 weeks
with at least one outing

45 days
running in a row

353 days
without one, the longest gap

THE EIGHT LONGEST RUNS OF DAYS



THE BEST STREAK OF EACH KIND



Morogoro has my big climbs.

Every big climb in my log meant a trip, to Morogoro, Kilimanjaro or Manyara. At home the ground is fairly flat. The hike in Manyara went up more than 1,700 m, my record at the time.

CLIMBS BY REGION OF TANZANIA

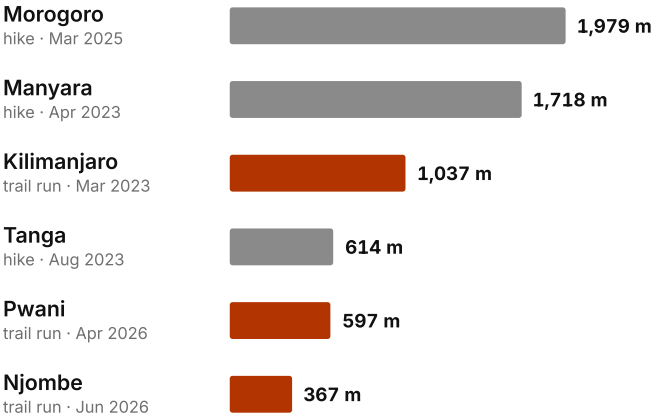
12
of the top 20 climbs in Morogoro

1,979 m
the biggest, in Morogoro

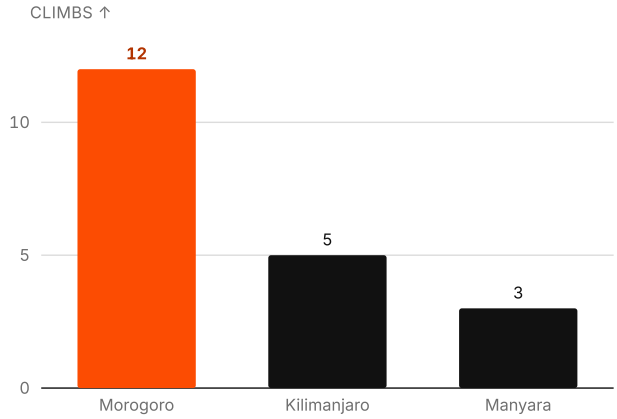
1,718 m
the biggest in Manyara

1,037 m
the biggest in Kilimanjaro

THE BIGGEST CLIMB IN EACH REGION



WHERE THE 20 BIGGEST CLIMBS STARTED



More records than chance.

My records were not only luck. If my outings had come in a random order, the distance record would have broken far fewer times than it did. Slowly, I was going further. The marathon has now stood for more than four years.

RECORDS AGAINST CHANCE

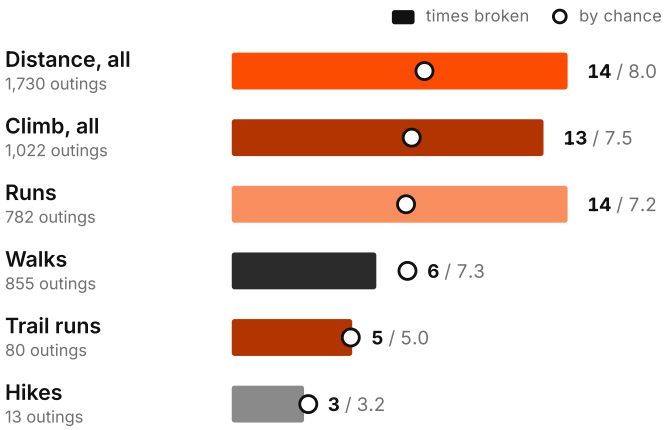
14
times the distance record broke

8.0
times chance would give

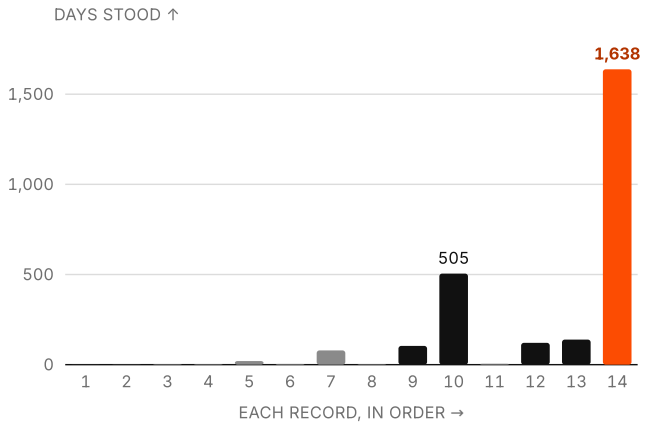
1.9×
chance, for runs alone

30%
chance the record would stand this long

TIMES EACH RECORD BROKE, AGAINST CHANCE



HOW LONG EACH DISTANCE RECORD STOOD



My record book.

LONGEST OUTING
42.7 km
a treadmill run
1 MAY 2022

BIGGEST CLIMB
1,979 m
a hike of 16.1 km
29 MAR 2025

BIGGEST DAY OF CLIMB
2,074 m
from four outings, 39.4 km
19 AUG 2023

BIGGEST WEEK
153 km
from nine outings
WEEK OF 2 MAR 2026

BIGGEST MONTH
559 km
from 59 outings
AUGUST 2021

LONGEST STREAK
301 days
in a row, still going
FROM 29 DEC 2025

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Something is better than nothing. Do what you can.”

CHAPTER 5

05 Where

Five countries. Seventeen regions.

ACROSS AFRICA

94% began in Tanzania.

I do not travel much, and when I do, the trips are short. Most of my trips across the border came in 2024, the year I travelled the most. Three outings abroad I count as others.

THE OUTINGS BY PLACE

5
countries with an outing

1,082
outings in Tanzania

73
outings outside Tanzania

906
outings with no GPS start

AFRICA, BY OUTINGS



less more outings none

EACH COUNTRY, BUSIEST FIRST

1,082 Tanzania
5,843 km on foot · 81,374 m up · 888 days
first on foot Aug 2019

32 Kenya
98 km on foot · 1,625 m up · 25 days
first on foot Dec 2022

23 Malawi
49 km on foot · 586 m up · 19 days
first on foot Oct 2024

13 South Africa
17 km on foot · 288 m up · 8 days
first on foot Apr 2024

2 Rwanda
15 km on foot · 281 m up · 2 days
first on foot Aug 2024

3 Others
4 km on foot · 71 m up · 3 days
from Apr 2024

Three places carry most of it.

Dodoma is where the habit took hold. I started going out there a few weeks after I came back, and it is where I have spent the most days out. Dar es Salaam is my other home, and in 2026 it is where I go out most. Kilimanjaro and Morogoro are where I go for the hills, and the other regions came mostly from trips.

INSIDE TANZANIA

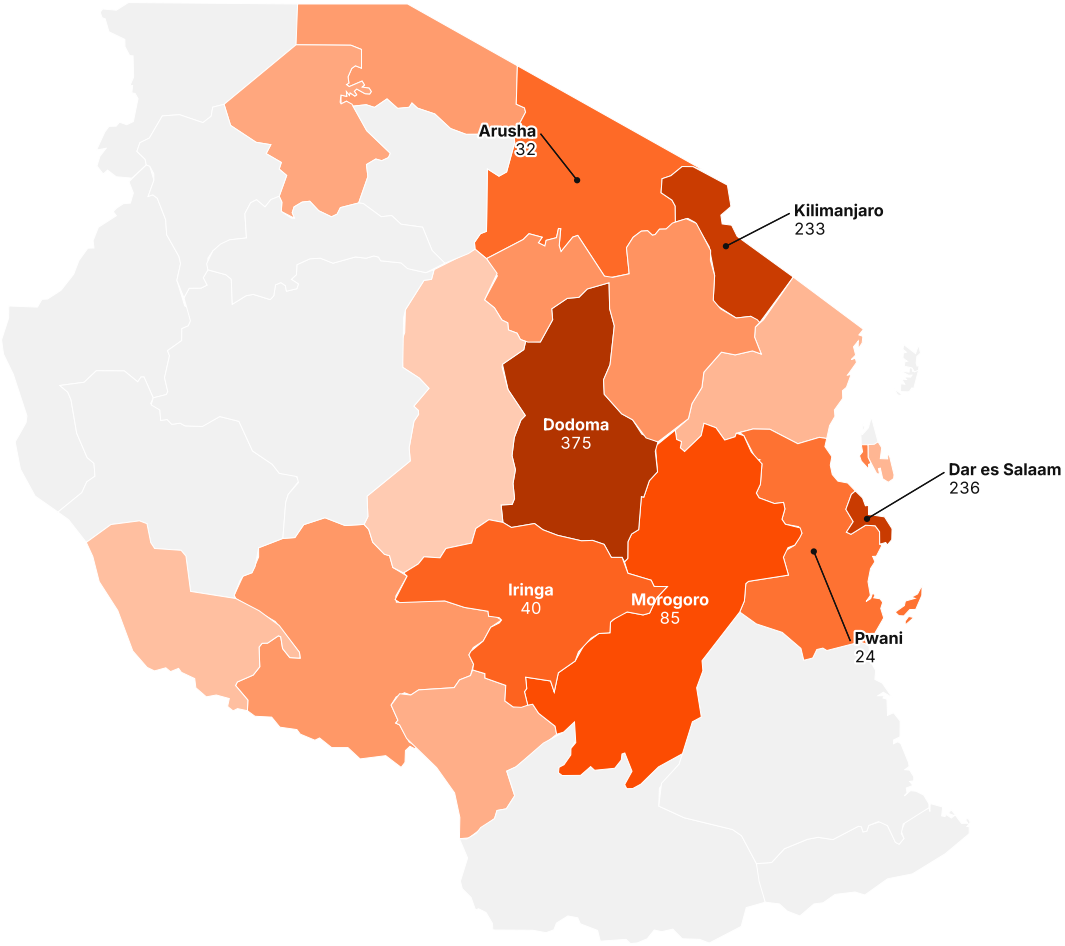
17
regions with an outing

35%
of the outings in Dodoma

37%
of the climb in Kilimanjaro

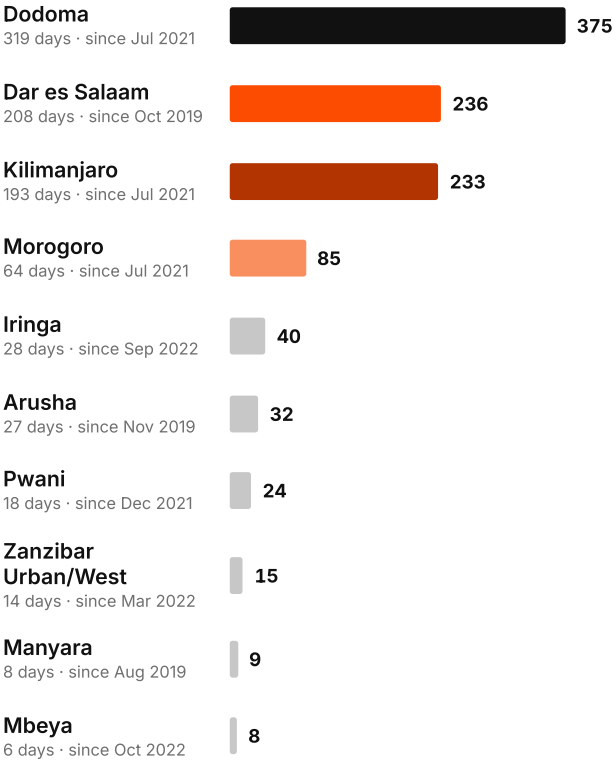
888 days
out in Tanzania

TANZANIA, BY REGION

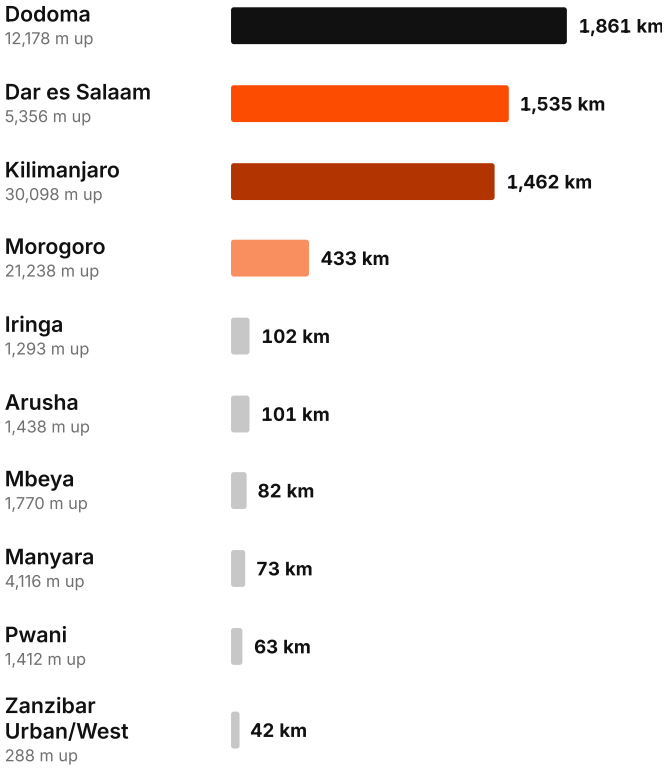


less — more outings — none

OUTINGS BY REGION



KILOMETRES ON FOOT BY REGION



The climbing is in two regions.

To climb, I have to travel. In Dar es Salaam I climb about 3.5 m for every kilometre. In Morogoro it is 49, so one kilometre there climbs as much as 14 at home. Most of my trail runs and hikes, 64 of them, started in the hilly regions I travel to.

METRES CLIMBED FOR EACH KILOMETRE

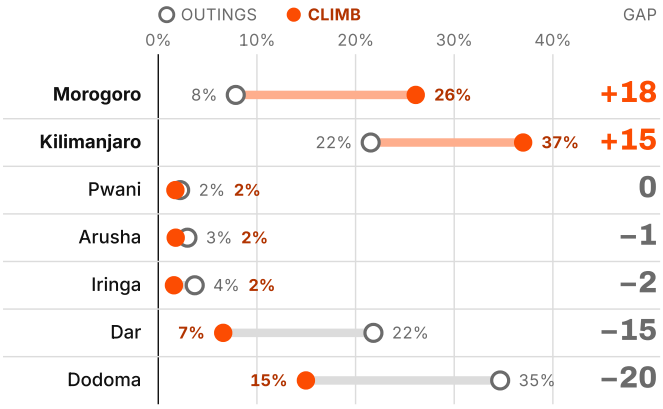
49 m
per km in Morogoro

21 m
per km in Kilimanjaro

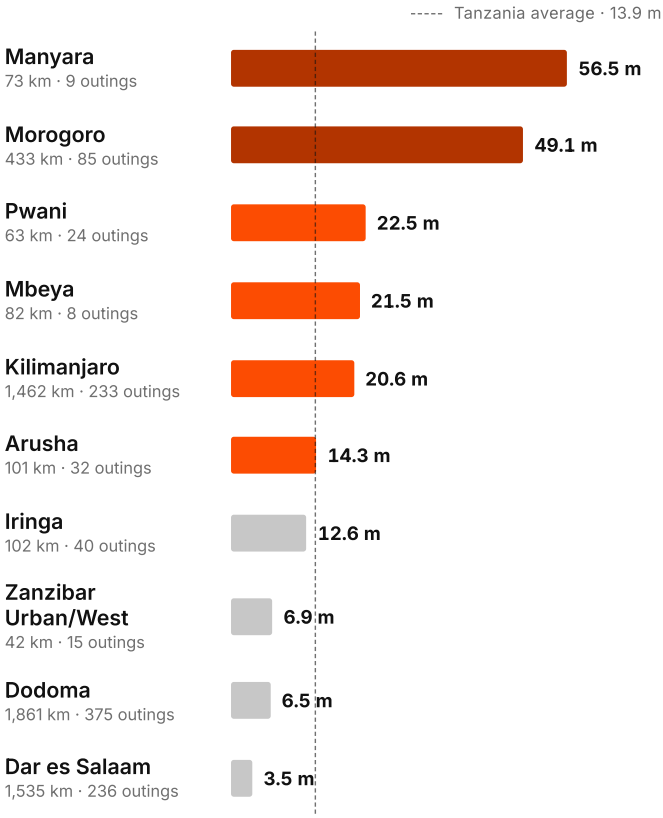
6.5 m
per km in Dodoma

3.5 m
per km in Dar es Salaam

SHARE OF THE OUTINGS AGAINST SHARE OF THE CLIMB



METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE, BY REGION



Dodoma led for four years.

Where I live decides where I go out. From 2021 to 2024 I went out most in Dodoma. In 2025 it was Kilimanjaro. In 2026 it was Dar es Salaam.

THE LEAD, YEAR BY YEAR

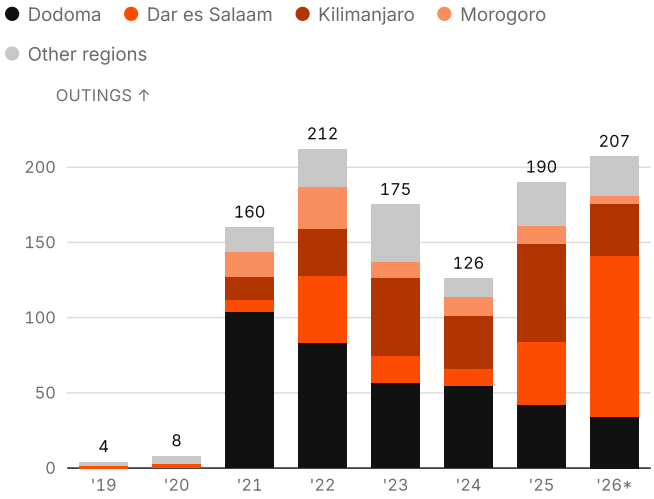
33%
Dodoma in 2023

44%
Dodoma in 2024

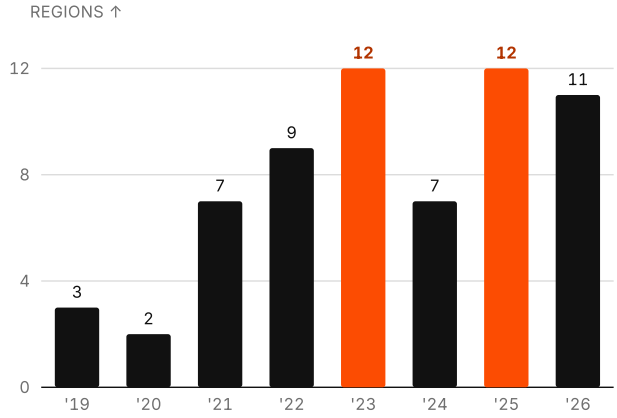
34%
Kilimanjaro in 2025

52%
Dar es Salaam in 2026 so far

OUTINGS IN TANZANIA BY REGION, YEAR BY YEAR



REGIONS VISITED EACH YEAR



17 regions in 7 years.

Every new region came with a trip, and they came in bunches, in the years I travelled. The latest is Singida, my seventeenth. There is still a lot of Tanzania to see.

NEW REGIONS

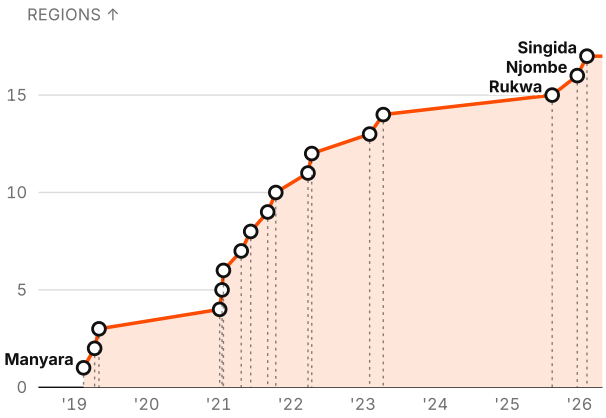
17
regions of 30 with an outing

5
new in 2021, the most

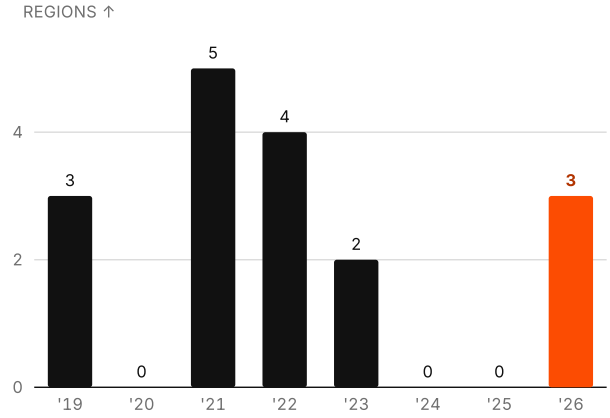
3
new in 2026 so far

13
regions still blank

REGIONS WITH AN OUTING, ADDING UP



NEW REGIONS EACH YEAR



73 outings outside Tanzania.

The habit travels with me. Even on a trip of a few days, I still go out. In Malawi I went out 23 times in two months. Kenya was the first, in July 2020, and I have been back a few times since. The other three I count as others.

OUTSIDE TANZANIA

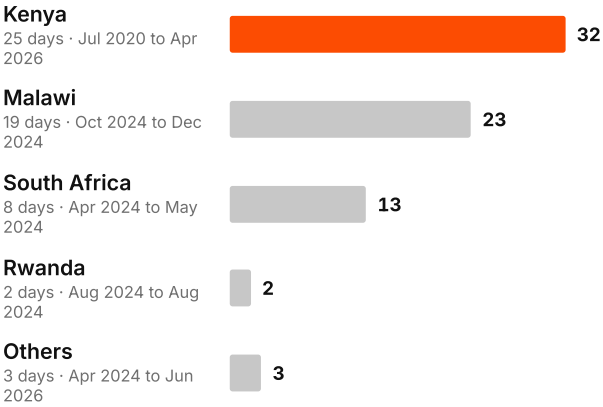
73
outings outside Tanzania

4
other countries

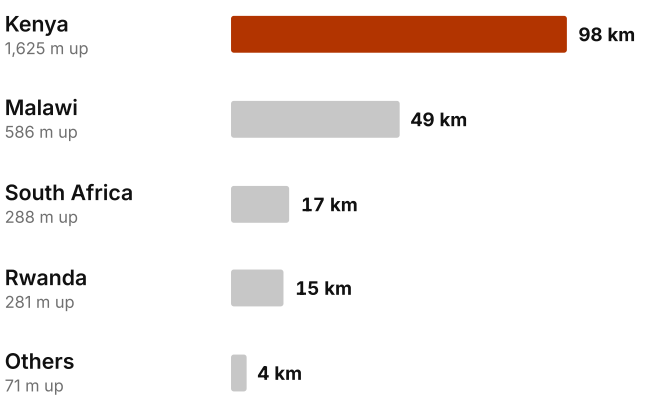
184 km
on foot abroad

57 days
out abroad

OUTINGS IN EACH COUNTRY



KILOMETRES ON FOOT IN EACH COUNTRY



Fewer outings without GPS.

As I moved outside, the maps filled in. My indoor outings, most of them treadmill runs, have no start point, and in my first year almost everything was indoors. Each year since, they have been a smaller part.

OUTINGS WITH NO GPS START

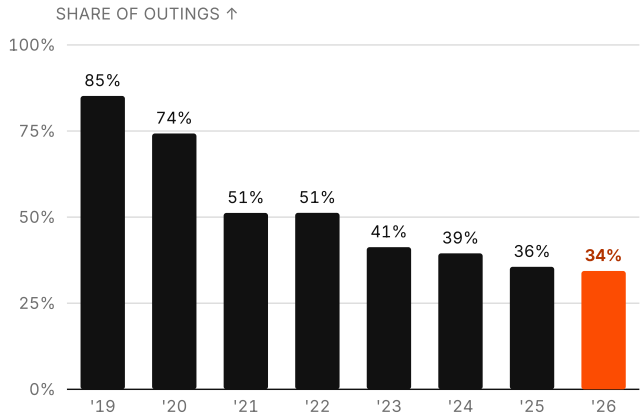
906
outings in all

646
treadmill runs

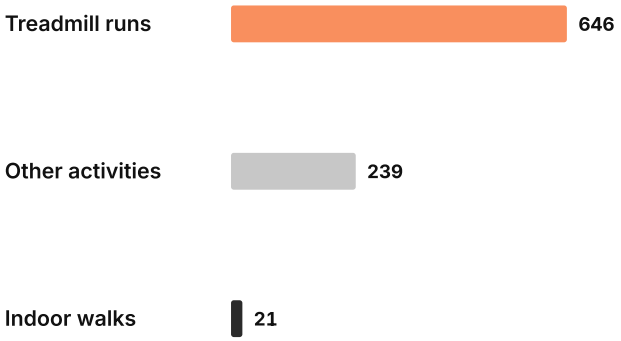
85%
of 2019 outings

34%
of 2026 outings so far

SHARE OF EACH YEAR WITH NO GPS START



WHAT THE OUTINGS WITH NO PLACE WERE



How widely they spread.

My outings are more spread across Tanzania than they used to be. To measure it I used the effective number of regions: if a year counts as four, it is as if my outings were shared equally between four regions. In my narrowest year, Dodoma had 65% of my outings. Later years spread out as I travelled and as my home base moved.

HOW THE OUTINGS SPREAD

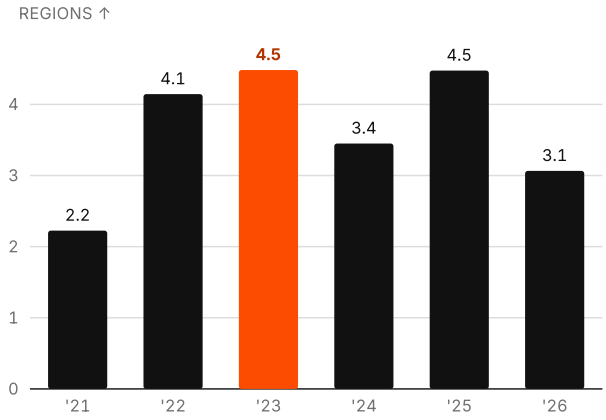
4.5
effective regions, all years

4.5
in 2023, the widest

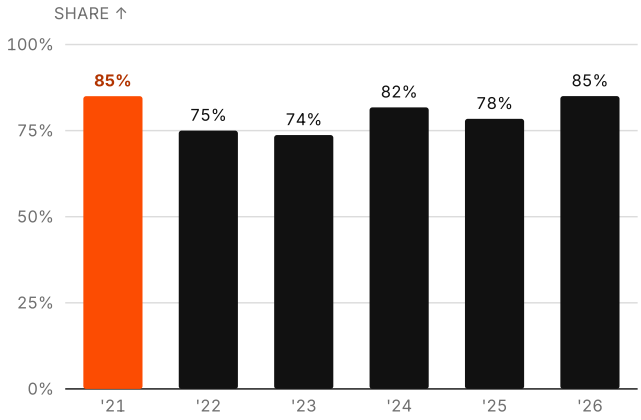
2.2
in 2021, the narrowest

78%
of outings in the busiest three

EFFECTIVE NUMBER OF REGIONS, YEAR BY YEAR



SHARE OF THE OUTINGS IN THE TOP THREE REGIONS



Years with fewer than 50 outings in Tanzania are left out.

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Taking ownership of your life is not easy, and living a life of discipline is not easy. In fact, it is hard. That is why it works.”

IV

The long view

Everything in the order it happened, and the targets I set myself each year.

06 **Timeline** 07 **Goals**

CHAPTER 6

06 Timeline

From my first upload to now

AUG 2019 TO OCT 2026

No long gap since then.

A habit gets easier the longer you keep it. The first 500 outings took me almost three years. The last 500 took eighteen months. My 2,000th outing was also my fiftieth trip to Ras Kilomoni, the target I set for this year. I was happy when the two landed on the same day.

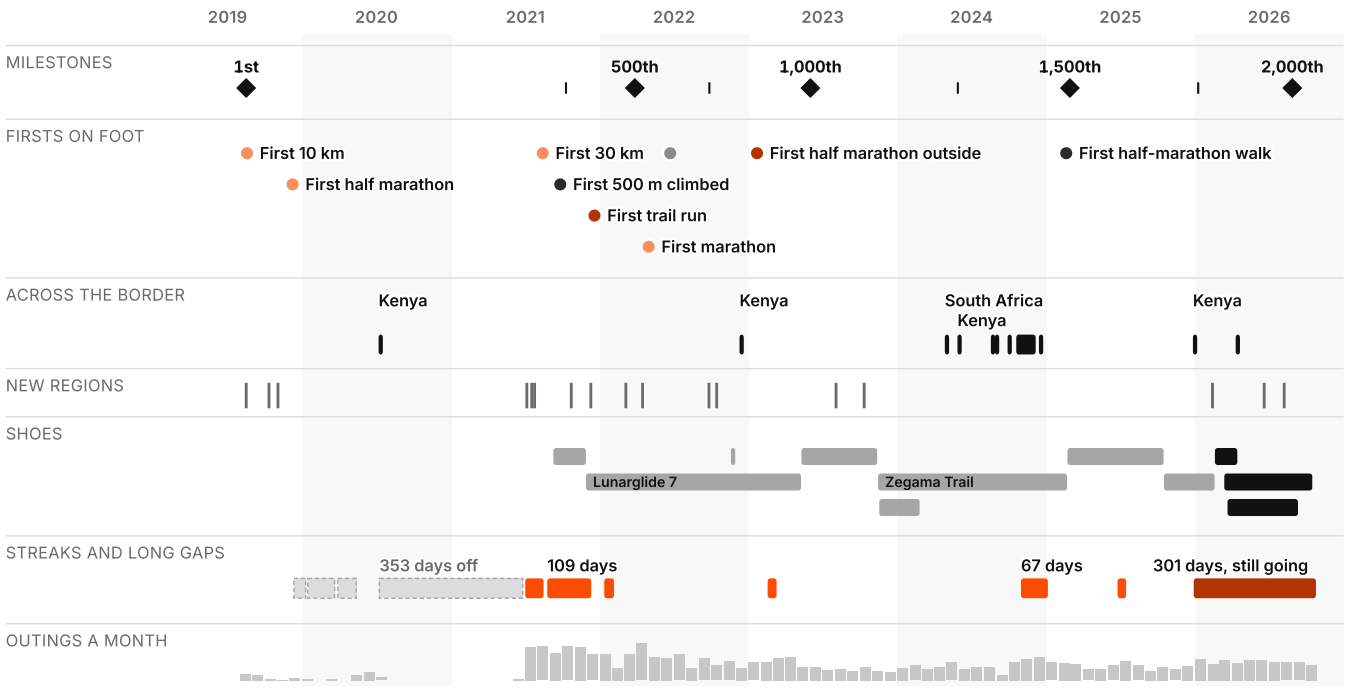
THE RECORD IN TIME

2,627 days
from the first outing to the latest

2,061
outings in that time

353 days
the silence, Jul 2020 to Jun 2021

10 days
the longest break since



◆ every 500th outing, ticks every 250th · ● treadmill run · ● outdoor run · ● trail run · ● walk · ○ hike · ▬ a trip across the border

▬ a pair of shoes, black while still in use · ▬ 20 days or more in a row · ▬ 30 days or more without an outing

Shorter breaks.

Once the habit settled, the gaps closed. The first 250 outings took me more than two years, with the long gap inside them. Since then every 250 has come in less than a year, and the breaks between outings got shorter too. In 2026 so far there has been no break at all.

EVERY 250 OUTINGS

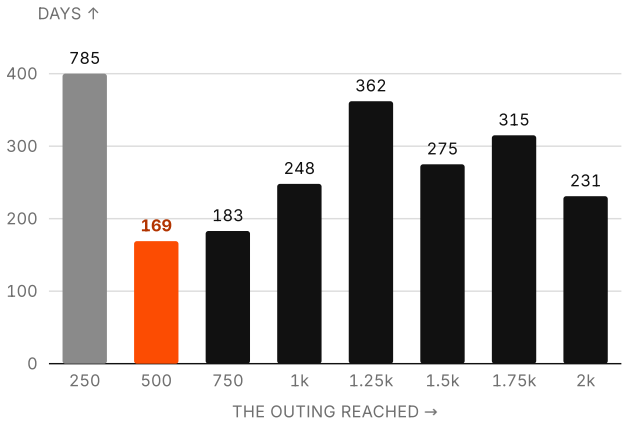
785 days
to the 250th

169 days
the quickest 250, to the 500th

362 days
the slowest since, to the 1,250th

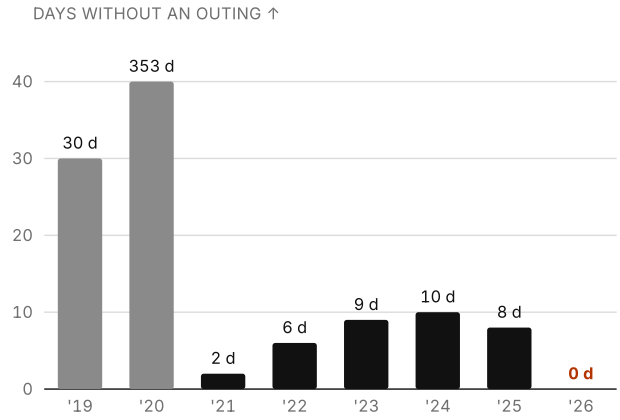
231 days
to the 2,000th, the latest

DAYS TO EACH 250 OUTINGS



The first bar includes the long gap, so it is cut off.

THE LONGEST BREAK EACH YEAR



From the treadmill to the hills.

New firsts are harder to find now, and that is fine. My distance firsts, the 10 km, the half marathon, 30 km and the marathon, all came on the treadmill. The later ones needed a trail, a hill or a long walk outside. Each one asks for a longer day or a steeper hill, so they come slowly.

FIRSTS ON FOOT

10
firsts on foot

4
of them on the treadmill

3
in 2021, the most in a year

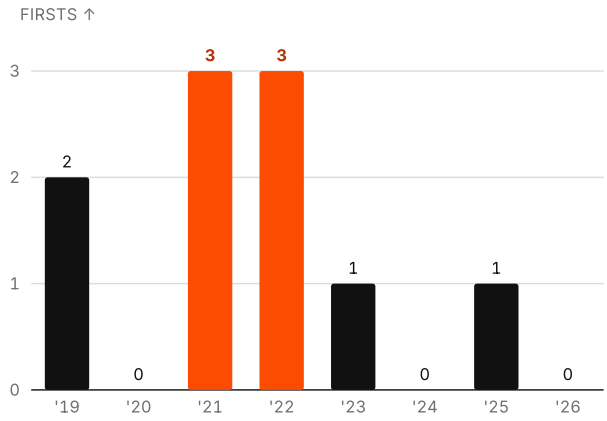
5.5 years
from the first to the latest

HOW LONG EACH FIRST TOOK

Treadmill run · Outdoor run · Trail run · Walk · Hike

First 10 km 10.0 km · day 3	Aug 2019
First half marathon 21.3 km · day 115	Dec 2019
First 30 km 30.0 km · day 729	Aug 2021
First 500 m climbed 600 m up · day 772	Sep 2021
First trail run 10.5 km · day 856	Dec 2021
First marathon 42.7 km · day 989	May 2022
First 1,000 m climbed 1,425 m up · day 1,042	Jun 2022
First hike 11.3 km · day 1,042	Jun 2022
First half marathon outside 22.7 km · day 1,255	Jan 2023
First half-marathon walk 30.0 km · day 2,014	Feb 2025

FIRSTS EACH YEAR



54 moments in eight years.

2019

17 Aug · MILESTONE
My first outing
where my log starts

12 Oct · NEW REGION
Dar es Salaam
region 2 of 17 so far

17 Aug · NEW REGION
Manyara
region 1 of 17 so far

3 Nov · NEW REGION
Arusha
region 3 of 17 so far

19 Aug · FIRST ON FOOT
First 10 km
10.0 km

9 Dec · FIRST ON FOOT
First half marathon
21.3 km

2020

15 Jan · SILENCE
67 days without an outing
until 21 Mar 2020

7 Jul · FIRST TRIP TO
Kenya
1 day out on that trip

9 Jul · SILENCE
353 days without an outing
until 26 Jun 2021

2021

2 Jul · STREAK
A 46-day streak begins
ends 16 Aug 2021

25 Jul · NEW REGION
Morogoro
region 6 of 17 so far

9 Sep · NEW SHOES
Air Zoom Pegasus 37
1,204 km in them

28 Nov · NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 7
1,778 km in them

6 Jul · NEW REGION
Kilimanjaro
region 4 of 17 so far

14 Aug · FIRST ON FOOT
First 30 km
30.0 km

26 Sep · FIRST ON FOOT
First 500 m climbed
600 m up

10 Dec · NEW REGION
Pwani
region 8 of 17 so far

18 Jul · NEW REGION
Dodoma
region 5 of 17 so far

25 Aug · STREAK
A 109-day streak begins
ends 11 Dec 2021

23 Oct · NEW REGION
Mwanza
region 7 of 17 so far

19 Dec · FIRST ON FOOT
First trail run
10.5 km

2022

6 Mar · NEW REGION
Zanzibar Urban/West
region 9 of 17 so far

1 May · FIRST ON FOOT
First marathon
42.7 km

26 Sep · NEW REGION
Iringa
region 11 of 17 so far

28 Mar · MILESTONE
My 500th outing
169 days after the 250th

23 Jun · FIRST ON FOOT
First 1,000 m climbed
1,425 m up

15 Oct · NEW REGION
Mbeya
region 12 of 17 so far

16 Apr · NEW REGION
Mara
region 10 of 17 so far

23 Jun · FIRST ON FOOT
First hike
11.3 km

19 Nov · NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 6
25 km in them

2023

22 Jan · FIRST ON FOOT
First half marathon outside
22.7 km

4 Aug · NEW REGION
Tanga
region 13 of 17 so far

18 Nov · NEW SHOES
Pegasus Trail (ZoomX)
127 km in them

11 May · NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 5
140 km in them

12 Oct · NEW REGION
Zanzibar Central/South
region 14 of 17 so far

2 Jun · MILESTONE
My 1,000th outing
248 days after the 750th

15 Nov · NEW SHOES
Zegama Trail
697 km in them

2024

27 Apr · FIRST TRIP TO
South Africa
8 days out on that trip

31 Oct · STREAK
A 67-day streak begins
ends 5 Jan 2025

18 Aug · FIRST TRIP TO
Rwanda
2 days out on that trip

20 Oct · FIRST TRIP TO
Malawi
16 days out on that trip

2025

19 Feb · FIRST ON FOOT
First half-marathon walk
30.0 km

17 Oct · NEW SHOES
Everun XT 900
588 km in them

22 Feb · NEW SHOES
Charged Impulse
1,027 km in them

29 Dec · STREAK
The 301-day streak begins
still going

28 Feb · MILESTONE
My 1,500th outing
275 days after the 1,250th

2026

13 Feb · NEW REGION
Rukwa
region 15 of 17 so far

22 Mar · NEW SHOES
Juniper Trail
180 km in them, and still wearing them

28 Aug · MILESTONE
My 2,000th outing
231 days after the 1,750th

19 Feb · NEW SHOES
Zoom Winflo 5
520 km in them, and still wearing them

20 Jun · NEW REGION
Njombe
region 16 of 17 so far

25 Oct · MILESTONE
2,061 outings
my latest on record

14 Mar · NEW SHOES
Comfort Footbed
565 km in them, and still wearing them

8 Aug · NEW REGION
Singida
region 17 of 17 so far

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Ease is a greater threat to progress than hardship.”

DENZEL WASHINGTON

CHAPTER 7

07 Goals

What I aim for each year

THREE TARGETS, EVERY YEAR SINCE 2021

Both 1,000 km rings closed.

Simple targets work best for me. Every year I aim for the same three: 1,000 km walking, 1,000 km running and 24,000 m of climbing on foot. Climbing is the one I have never reached. Most of my outings are on flat ground and the hills are far, so it is the hardest of the three for me. My first running ring closed on 10 September 2021, and five years later, to the day, my first walking ring closed.

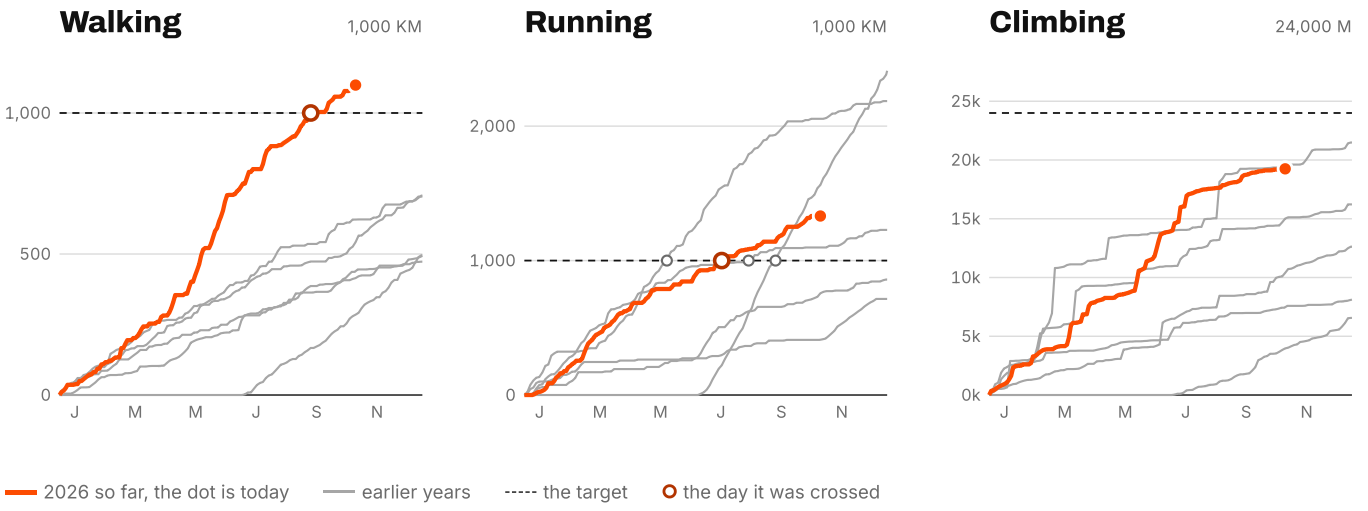
2026 SO FAR

1,099 km
walked, 110% of the target

1,331 km
run, 133% of the target

19,248 m
climbed on foot, 80% of the target

67 days
left in 2026



Running closed four times.

The rings follow my story. Running was strongest at the start: in 2021 I ran more than twice the target. As walking took over, running fell short in 2024 and 2025, while my walking stayed under 800 km a year until 2026. The climbing came closest in 2023, at 90%.

RINGS CLOSED, 2021 TO 2026

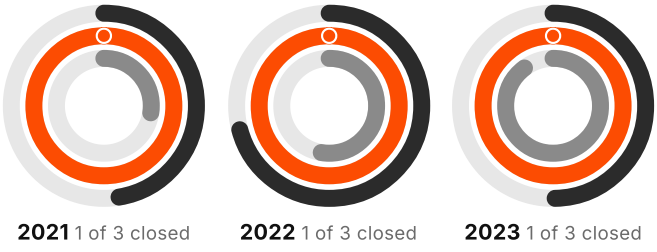
4
running, best 2,412 km in 2021

1
walking, best 1,099 km in 2026

0
climbing, best 21,490 m in 2023

1
years with both 1,000 km rings closed

EACH YEAR AS THREE RINGS



2021 1 of 3 closed

2022 1 of 3 closed

2023 1 of 3 closed

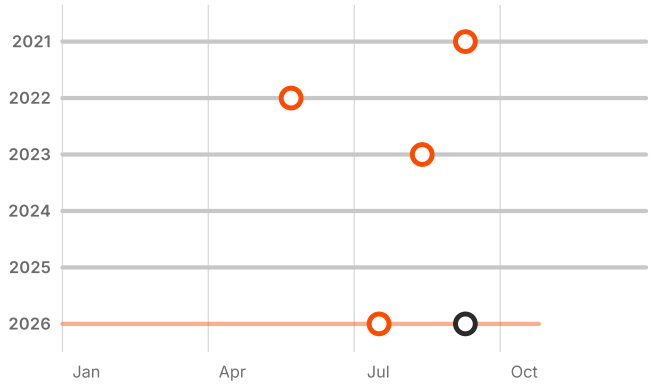
2024 0 of 3 closed

2025 0 of 3 closed

2026 2 of 3 closed so far

● outer ring, walking 1,000 km ● middle ring, running 1,000 km
● inner ring, climbing 24,000 m

THE DAY EACH RING CLOSED



Close, but not yet.

If I keep to my average, I will finish just short. I played out the rest of the year many times, using my own days of 2026 picked at random, to see how often it gets there. What worries me is my recent pace. Since 1 August I have climbed only 22 m a day.

THE CLIMB, 2026

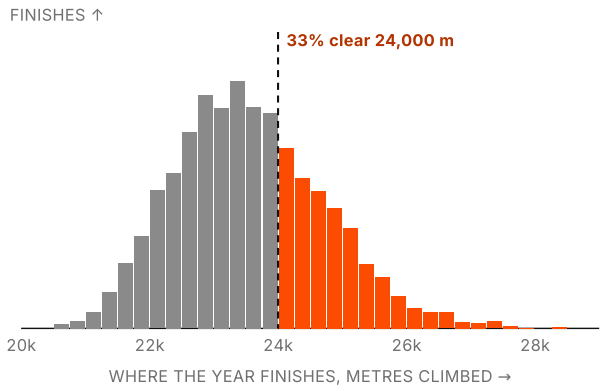
4,752 m
still to climb in 67 days

71 m
a day needed from here

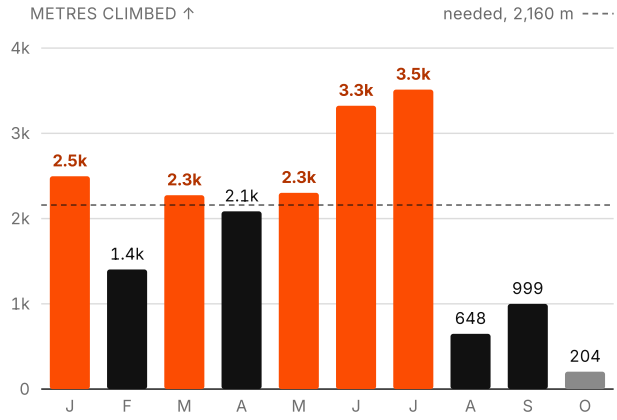
65 m
a day so far in 2026

33%
of 4,000 replays close the ring

WHERE 4,000 REPLAYS OF THE YEAR FINISH



METRES CLIMBED EACH MONTH OF 2026



A little faster each time.

Most of the time I saved on this race came from stopping less. In 2023 I stood still for 32 minutes during the Kilimanjaro Half. In 2026 it was less than seven.

FOUR EDITIONS OF ONE RACE

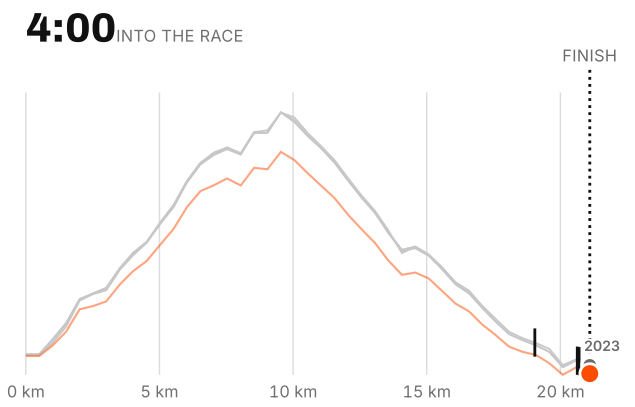
22.6 min
quicker in 2026 than in 2023

26 min
less time stopped than in 2023

2.1 km
2023 behind when 2026 finished

125
kudos in 2023, the most of any outing

ALL FOUR EDITIONS, RACED AT ONCE



2026	2025	2024	2023
3:38	**3:42**	**3:43**	**4:00**
the quickest	0.4 km behind when 2026 finished	0.5 km behind when 2026 finished	2.1 km behind when 2026 finished

MOVING AND STOPPED, EACH EDITION



Fifty trips to Ras Kilomoni.

Bandu bandu huisha gogo, chip by chip finishes the log. In 2026 I set myself a different kind of target: to reach the headland at Ras Kilomoni fifty times. I counted the trips in Roman numerals, I to L, 34 walks and 16 runs. For the first three months I kept a steady count. Then June came with 14 trips, and after that the target was within reach.

RAS KILOMONI

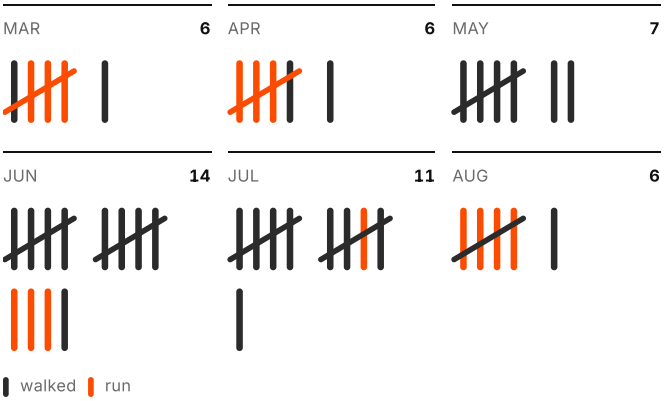
50
trips, the target met exactly

173 days
9 Mar to 28 Aug

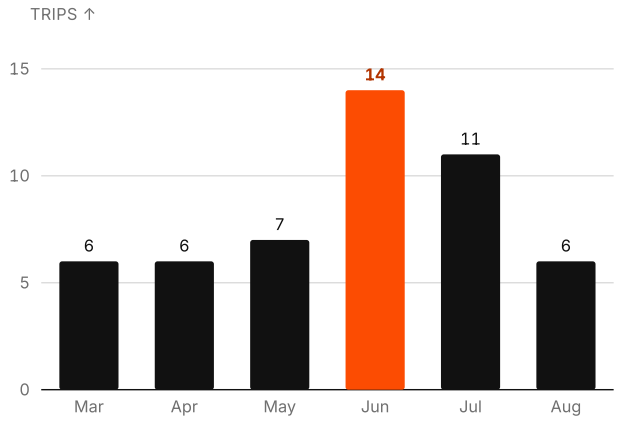
535 km
there and back, 10.7 km a trip

2,000
outings in the record after trip L

EVERY TRIP, KEPT AS A TALLY



TRIPS EACH MONTH



5 · A GOAL I NEVER SET

Every month since Jun 2021.

I never set this one as a target. It came on its own, from going out week after week. Even in the quiet months of the year, I went out at least once.

EVERY CALENDAR MONTH

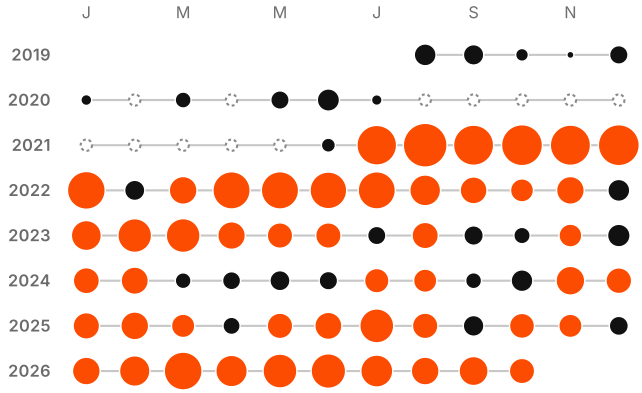
65 months
in a row with an outing, since Jun 2021

49 months
with 100 km or more on foot

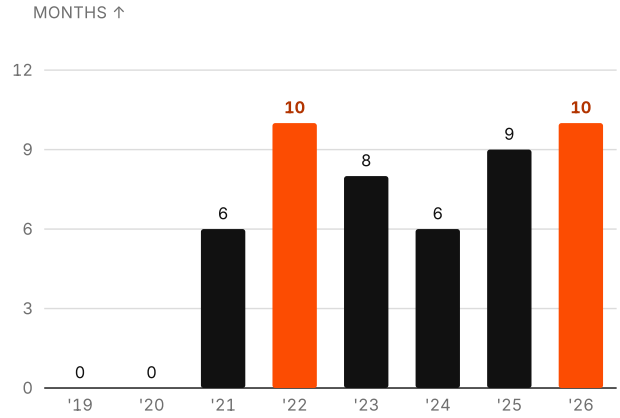
10 of 10
months of 2026 past 100 km

12 months
with no outing, all before Jun 2021

EVERY MONTH AS A BEAD



MONTHS PAST 100 KM, EACH YEAR



6 · ALL MY GOALS

Met, and still open.

RUNNING RING

4 times
closed, best 2,412 km
2021, 2022, 2023 AND 2026

WALKING RING

1 time
closed, 1,099 km in 2026
ON 10 SEP 2026

CLIMBING RING

80 %
of 24,000 m in 2026 so far
33% CHANCE IT CLOSES

THE MARATHON

2:56:44
42.7 km in under three hours, on the treadmill
MAY 2022

THE STAGE RACE

100.3 km
in four days back to back, 25.1 km a day
24 MAR TO 27 MAR 2023

KILIMANJARO HALF

3:38
the quickest of four, 23 min under 2023
2026 EDITION

RAS KILOMONI

50 trips
535 km, target met exactly
9 MAR TO 28 AUG 2026

MONTHS IN A ROW

65 months
with at least one outing, still going
SINCE JUN 2021

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“I wanted to show that it is beautiful to be strong, to have drive, to have will, to not fail, to give it your all.”

KERSTIE ENNIS

V

The lessons

What I think seven years of logging have taught me.

CHAPTER 8

08 What It Means

What I have learned from it

I am not an expert. These are only my own lessons.

SEVEN YEARS, READ BACK

It costs time.

It is not much in one day, about the time of a long lunch, but it adds up. Most of it is walking and easy running, nothing heavy. These are the lessons I took from it.

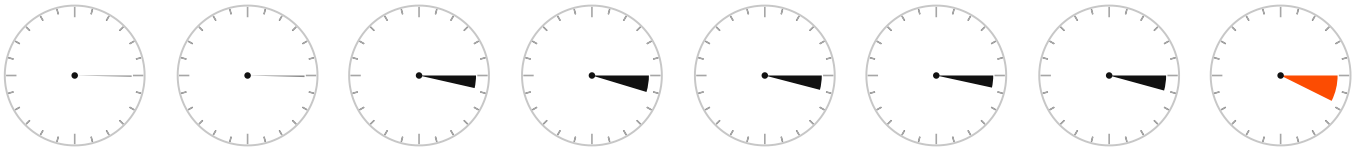
WHAT IT COST

2,382 hours
on the move since the first upload

99 days
if those hours ran end to end

71 min
a day since 2021, rest days included

106 min
a day in 2026



5 min
2019

7 min
2020

52 min
2021

68 min
2022

59 min
2023

50 min
2024

62 min
2025

106 min
2026 SO FAR

A full circle is one day.

Keep the days.

If I could keep only one thing, I would keep the days. In 2024 I covered less than half the distance of 2022, and the long days almost disappeared, but I still went out on 234 days. When the distance came back in 2026, the days were already there to build on.

2022 AGAINST 2024

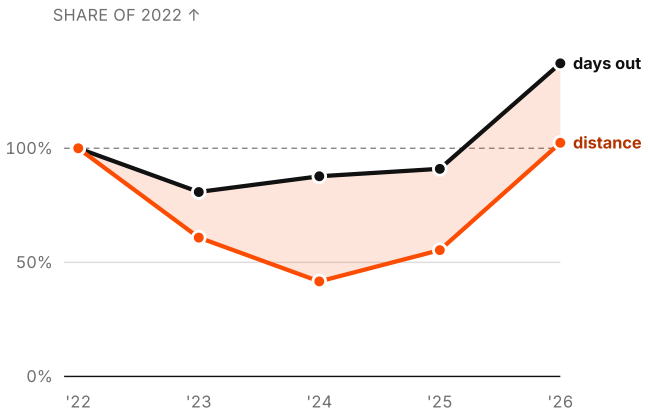
58%
less distance per day

12%
fewer days out

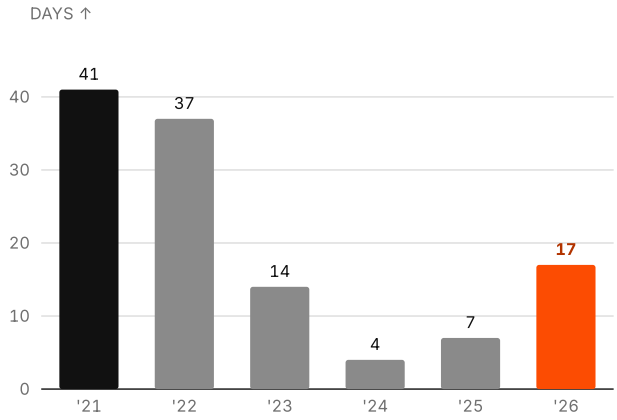
4 days
of 21 km or more in 2024, from 37

298 of 298
days out in 2026 so far

DAYS OUT AND DISTANCE, AGAINST 2022



DAYS OF 21 KM OR MORE ON FOOT



The small days count.

Haba na haba hujaza kibaba, little by little fills the measure. Many of my days were small ones, less than 2 km on foot. They add almost nothing to my distance, but I logged them all the same. Later the numbers showed me why they matter: after a small day, I was much more likely to go out again than after a full rest. On a bad day, I try to do a small version.

SMALL DAYS SINCE 2021

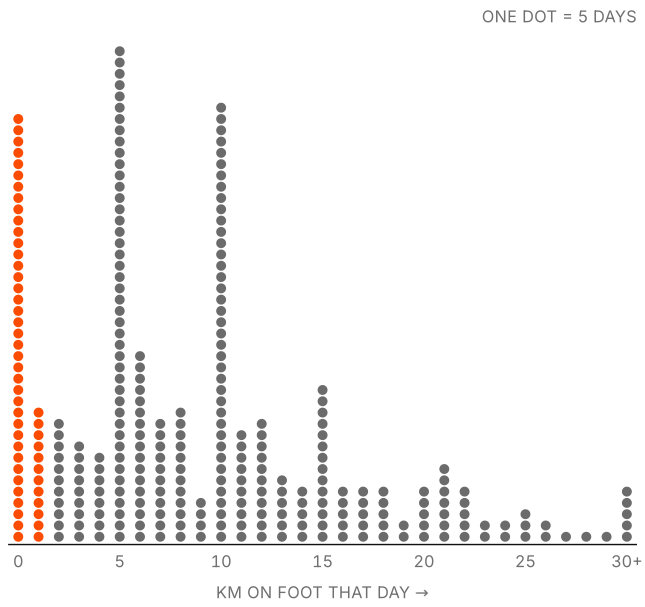
246 days
under 2 km on foot

17%
of all my days out

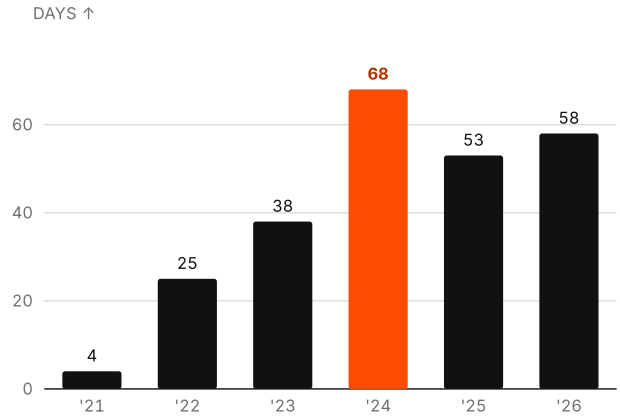
76%
out again the next day

50%
out again after a full rest day

EVERY DAY OUT SINCE 2021, BY ITS DISTANCE



DAYS UNDER 2 KM EACH YEAR



Keep a floor.

My big weeks have not changed much over the years. What changed is the quiet weeks. From 2022 to 2025 some weeks slipped very low. In 2026 none has, and the middle half of my weeks are between 41 and 72 km. If the bad weeks are not too bad, the year takes care of itself.

WEEKS ON FOOT

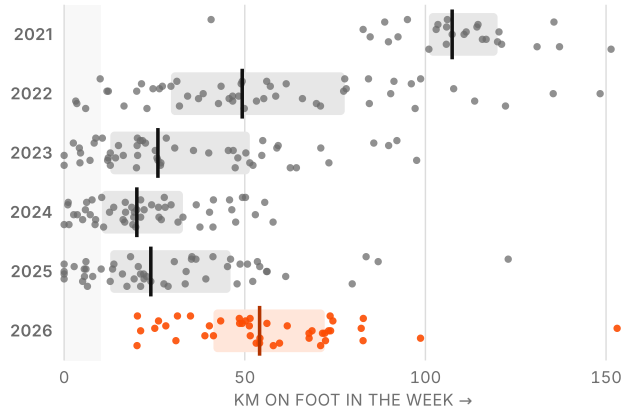
20 km
my lowest week of 2026

0 weeks
under 10 km in 2026

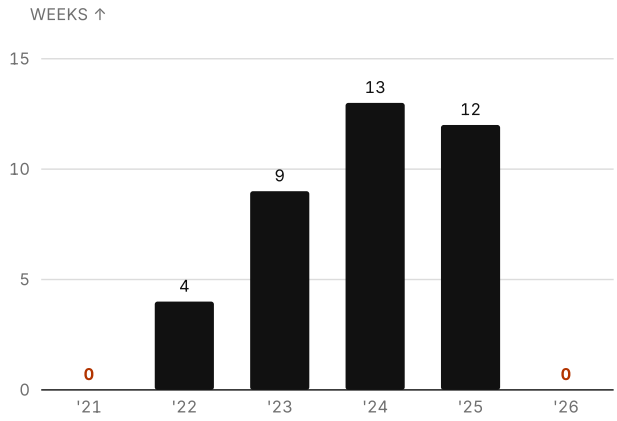
38 weeks
under 10 km, 2022 to 2025

8.2 km
a day in 2026

EVERY FULL WEEK, BY ITS DISTANCE



WEEKS UNDER 10 KM EACH YEAR



Long days come in bunches.

My long days do not come alone. The day after one, I usually go out again, and further than normal. The three days before are bigger than usual too. So for me the long days come in the middle of a busy time. After a long run, a full rest the next day is rare.

DAYS OF 21 KM OR MORE SINCE 2021

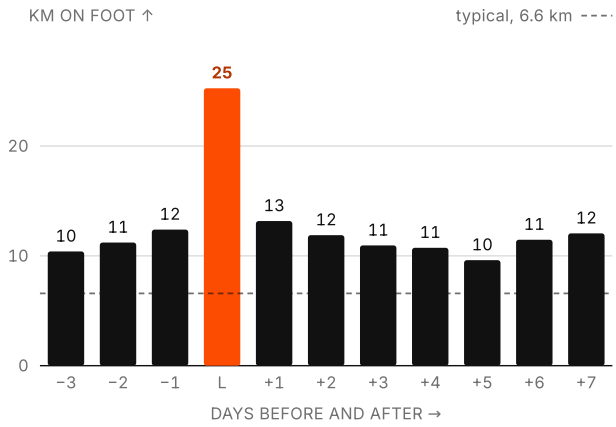
120 days
of 21 km or more on foot

90%
followed by another day out

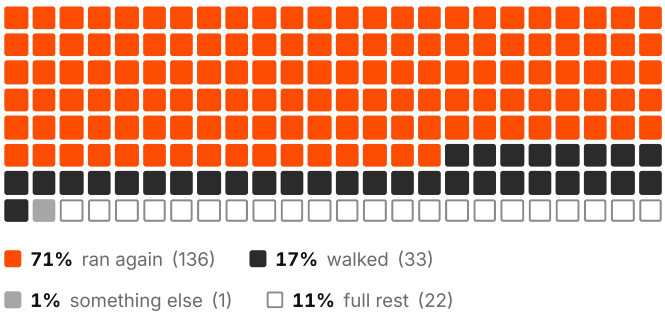
13.2 km
the next day, against 6.6 km on a typical day

11%
full rest after a 15 km run

THE DAYS AROUND A LONG DAY



WHAT CAME THE DAY AFTER A 15 KM RUN



5 · DAYS AND DISTANCE

How a year adds up.

A year's total is just two things: how often I go out, and how far I go each time. 1,000 km a year is a short outing every day, or about 4.1 km on two days in three. I have done it both ways. 2021 was a year of long days on about half the days. 2026 is a year of going every day, shorter each time. 2024 was low on both, and it became my lowest year since the habit started.

THE TWO LEVERS

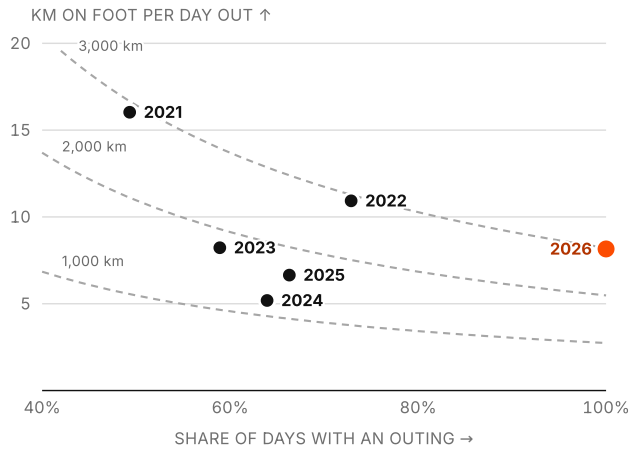
2.7 km
a day makes 1,000 km a year

16.0 km
per day out in 2021, the longest

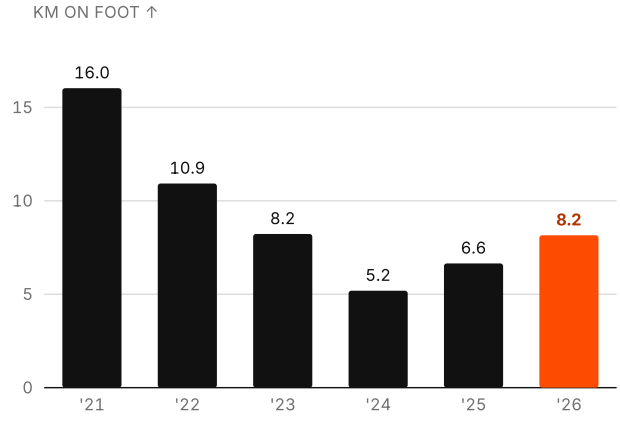
100%
of days out in 2026 so far

1,214 km
in 2024, low on both

EACH YEAR BY ITS TWO LEVERS



DISTANCE PER DAY OUT



6 · WHAT I WOULD TELL YOU

If you are starting out.

That is what seven years of logging say to me. Nothing here is special. It is about an hour a day, a small version on the bad days, not letting a week get too thin, and long days in the middle of busy weeks. There are 67 days of 2026 left. Kesho tena, tomorrow again.

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Break the long challenges into increments, things you can do right now that add up over time.”

DAN CNOSSEN

Epilogue

The last activity in this edition is from 25 October 2026. I am on 301 days in a row, and the habit that started in 2021 has now lasted 1,947 days.

None of these totals came from one big effort. They came from 2,061 ordinary outings, most of them short, early in the morning or in the evening, on days like any other. The log will keep growing, and the next edition will have the new numbers.

I will be out tomorrow.

Gerald Tesha

ANNEX A

How this book was made

This book started as a website, My Strava Journey, where I laid out my Strava history so anyone could read it. None of the figures are typed in by hand. They are all worked out from my activity log, which I refresh every week.

Each week I pull my latest activities from Strava through an MCP server. MCP, the Model Context Protocol, is an open standard that lets an AI assistant connect to other tools and data. Here it connects to my Strava account and gives back every activity in one raw CSV file.

A set of Python scripts then rebuilds everything from that file: the activity log, the totals on foot, the places, the streaks, the records and the tables behind each chart. Before anything is published, activity names, Strava IDs and exact GPS points are taken out. Then the checks run and the site goes live with the new numbers. This edition has 2,061 activities, up to 25 October 2026.

I built it with Claude, Anthropic's AI model, helping with the code and the analysis. I decided the questions, the design and how it should read. Claude wrote the code, dug through the data and checked each number against the log before it went into the text.

DATA SOURCE	My Strava activity history, pulled weekly through an MCP server
PIPELINE	Python, standard library only: rebuild, foot-only totals, derived tables, privacy pass
DATA STORE	32 CSV tables that every number comes from
SITE	React 18 and Vite 5, React Router with hash links, PapaParse to read the CSVs
CHARTS	Drawn by hand in SVG and canvas, without a chart library
TYPE AND COLOUR	Archivo and Inter on a simple grid, with Strava orange kept for the data
QUALITY	Data validation, tests, an axe accessibility audit and layout checks at phone widths
HOSTING	GitHub Pages, from the repository github.com/hpgerald/my-strava-journey
BOOK	The site printed through headless Chromium to an A4 PDF

The weekly pipeline

01 Strava
Every outing I record lands in my Strava account.

02 MCP pull
Each week the latest activities come out through an MCP server, as one raw CSV.

03 Build
Python scripts rebuild the activity log and every table derived from it.

04 Privacy
Names, Strava IDs and exact GPS points are removed, and places are kept to country and region.

05 Checks
The data rules, tests, accessibility and phone layouts are checked.

06 Site
The site reads the tables in the browser and draws every chart from them.

07 Book
The same pages print as this book, and I make a new PDF with each refresh.

ANNEX B

About the data

Where the numbers come from

Every activity comes from my Strava export: the date and time, sport, distance, moving and elapsed time, climb, heart-rate effort, kudos and personal records. Places come from each activity's GPS start point, kept only to country and region.

Distance and climb only count the four sports on foot: runs, walks, trail runs and hikes. Everything else counts as other activities. Those still count as outings and days out, but they add no distance or climb, and I do not name them.

A treadmill run is one that Strava marks as done indoors. Those have no GPS, so they never show up on a map and set almost no segment records.

Relative Effort	Strava's score for how hard a session was, based on the time spent in each heart-rate zone. The higher it is, the harder my heart worked.
Kudos	A thumbs-up from someone on Strava, the same idea as a like.
PR	Personal record: my best time on a segment or over a set distance.
Achievement	A badge Strava gives on a segment, for a top-10 time or a personal best.
Elevation gain	All the metres climbed in an activity, added up over every uphill stretch.
Moving time	The time I was actually moving, with the pauses taken out. Elapsed time includes the stops.
Trainer	An indoor session, like a treadmill run, as marked by Strava. These have no GPS.

THE AUTHOR

Get in touch.

I am Gerald Tesha. I work in monitoring, evaluation and data, and this book is what I did with my own numbers. If you would like something like this made from your own data, or would like to work together, I will be happy to hear from you.

EMAIL
hpgerald@gmail.com

PHONE
+255 763 453 400

LINKEDIN
linkedin.com/in/gtesha

STRAVA
strava.com/athletes/gtesha

GITHUB
github.com/hpgerald

WEBSITE
hpgerald.github.io/my-strava-journey

Strava is a trademark of Strava, Inc. This is a personal project, not affiliated with or endorsed by Strava.

2,061 outings. 13,237 km on foot. One habit.

SHOWING UP · GERALD TESHA